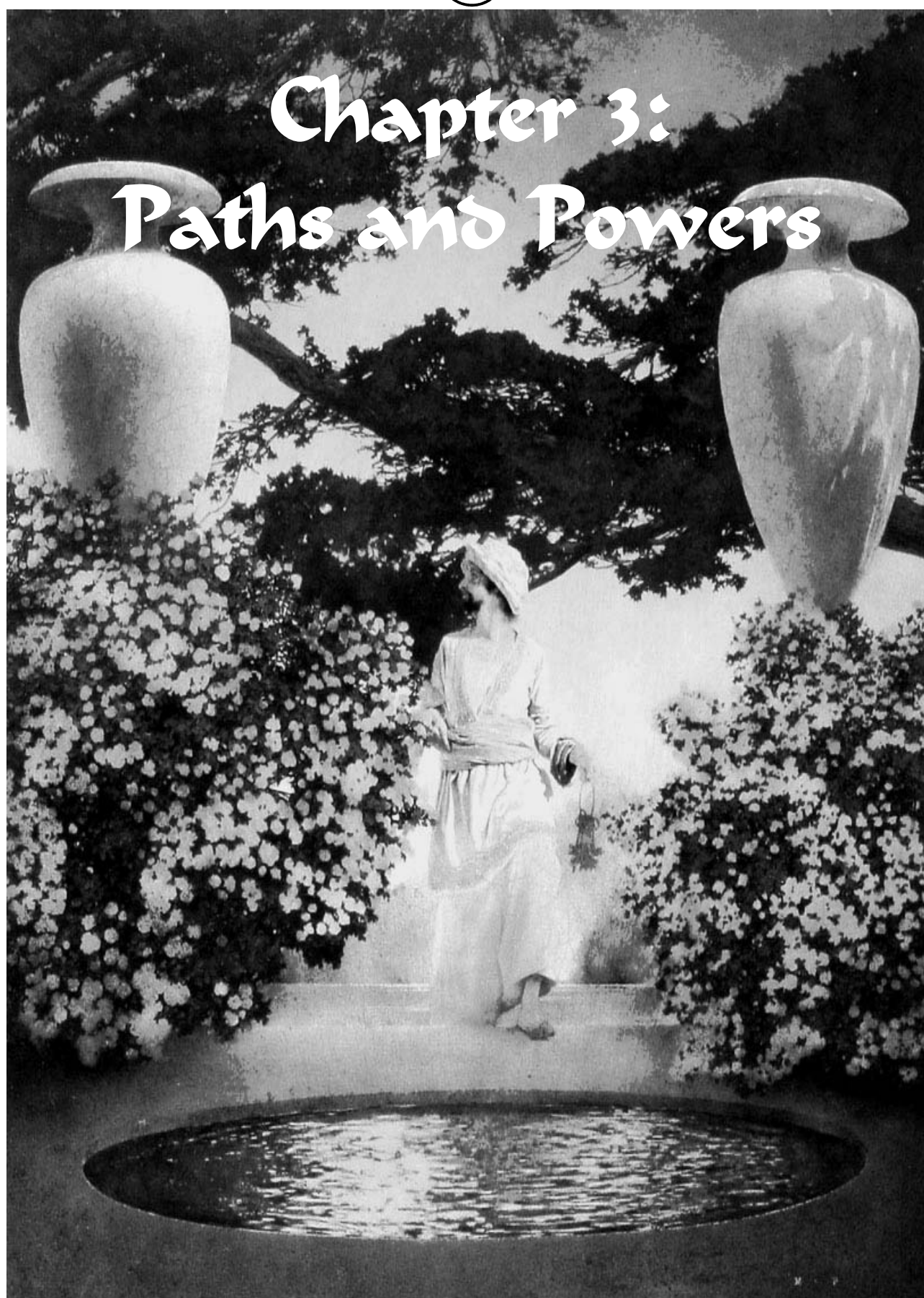
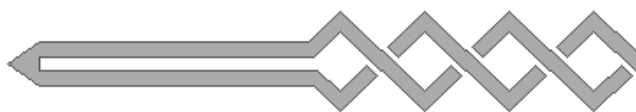




ECLIPSE: THE CODEX PERSONA





The following sections present chains of abilities for different kinds of campaigns. High-powered campaigns might allow characters to take any of these, while low-powered ones might restrict casters to Witchcraft only. Different powers present different kinds of challenges for Game Master and player alike, so feel free to experiment.

Although the abilities presented here often only list one specific requirement, they do indeed demand the character have all the preceding abilities along the chain. Fortunately, we've provided handy flowcharts where needed.

Channeling

Channeling taps into powers of creation and destruction, of life and death - more commonly known as positive and negative energy. It's one of the more primal paths available.

Positive energy can repel or even destroy the undead, hearten or inspire living beings, counter or neutralize negative energies, and reveal or disrupt various occult effects.

Negative power, as might be expected, has opposing effects. It can awe or command undead, inspire fear or hopelessness in living beings, reveal or disrupt a variety of occult effects, and counter or neutralize positive energy effects.

Channeling effects have an Intensity, indicating the maximum level of effect which can be produced or hit die which can be affected, and a Magnitude, indicating the scale of the effect which can be produced or the total number of hit dice which can be affected. Unfortunately, since Channeling involves spontaneously tapping into extradimensional power sources, both are subject to random influences (*i.e.*, a d20 roll).

Basic Channeling simply involves buying some uses per day. Intensity, Magnitude, and exotic enhancements are optional, but useful. Basic Channeling can only directly affect spirits sustained by pure positive or negative energy, such as undead and any positive-energy entities the Game Master brings into play. Creatures who also draw strength from alignment forces (outer-planar outsiders: good ones are normally linked with positive energy, evil ones with negative energy), elemental forces (most inner-planar outsiders), chemical sources (most material plane creatures), or other energy forms either cannot be affected or have an effective +20 Turn Resistance at the option of the Game Master. Creatures partially sustained by raw magic, such as Liches and Vampires, are more resistant than usual to Channeling - an ability expressed as Turn Resistance.

Creatures which are affected (Intensity greater than or equal to their effective hit dice) can be Turned (Magnitude equal to their hit dice) or Destroyed (Magnitude equal to twice their hit dice or more) if the

energy type opposes their own. If it matches, they can be Rebuked (Magnitude equal to their hit dice), Bolstered*, or Commanded (Magnitude of 2x hit dice or more).

*Gaining either Turn Resistance equal to [Intensity - their level] or Positive Levels (see page 86) equal to [Intensity - their level]/2 for ten rounds.

Buying Channeling

Uses Per Day: 1 (3 CP), 3 (6 CP), and +(Cha Mod) (3 CP the first time, 6 CP for each succeeding time). Characters may elect to channel either positive or negative energy, not both. In general, evil characters must pick negative energy and good characters must pick positive energy.

Base Intensity = User Level. +2/4/5/6/7/8 for +3 CP per step. The actual Intensity equals the base Intensity modified by a d20 check on the chart below. While it is possible to work without a "holy" or "unholy" symbol to focus the energy, this results in a -10 penalty on Intensity.

Channeling Intensity Checks

1d20 +		1d20+	
Cha Mod	Intensity	Cha Mod	Intensity
0-	Base -8	13-15	Base -3
1-3	Base -7	16-18	Base -2
4-6	Base -6	19-21	Base -1
7-9	Base -5	22-25	Base
10-12	Base -4	26+	Base +1

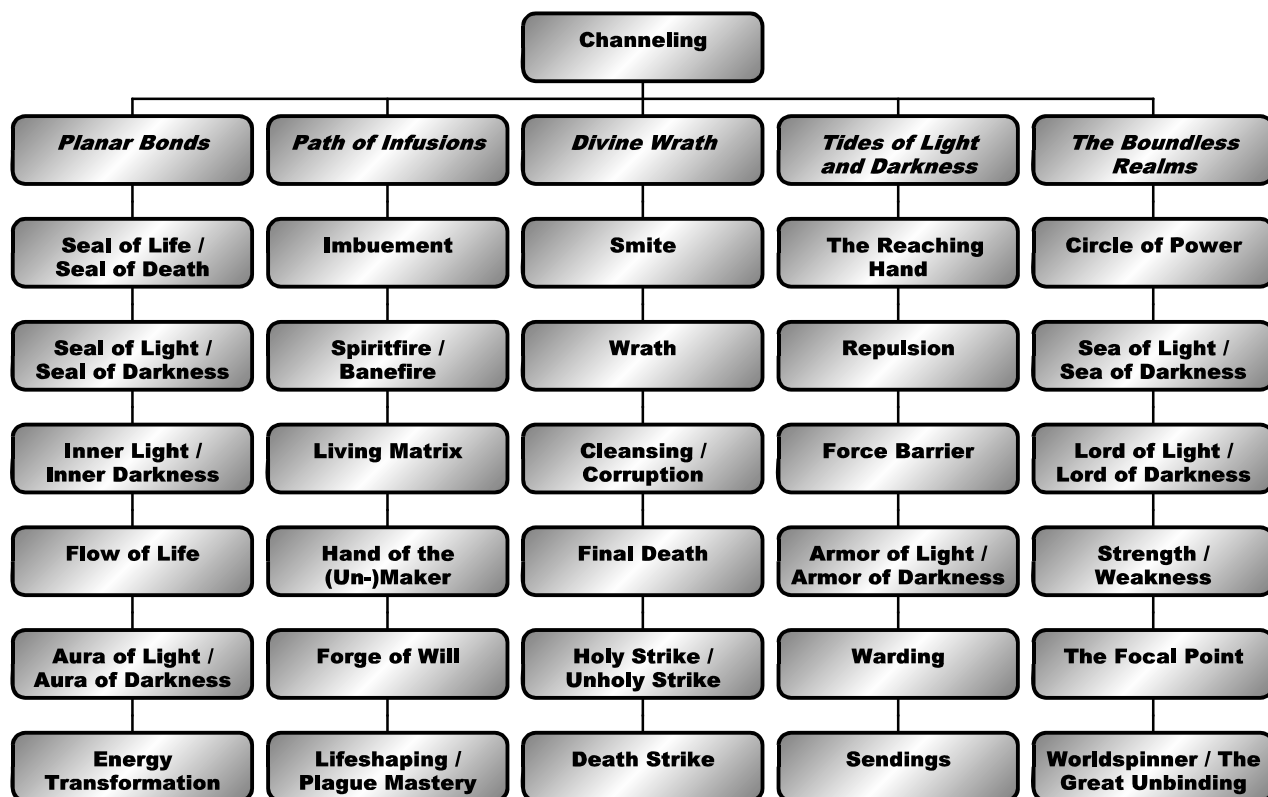
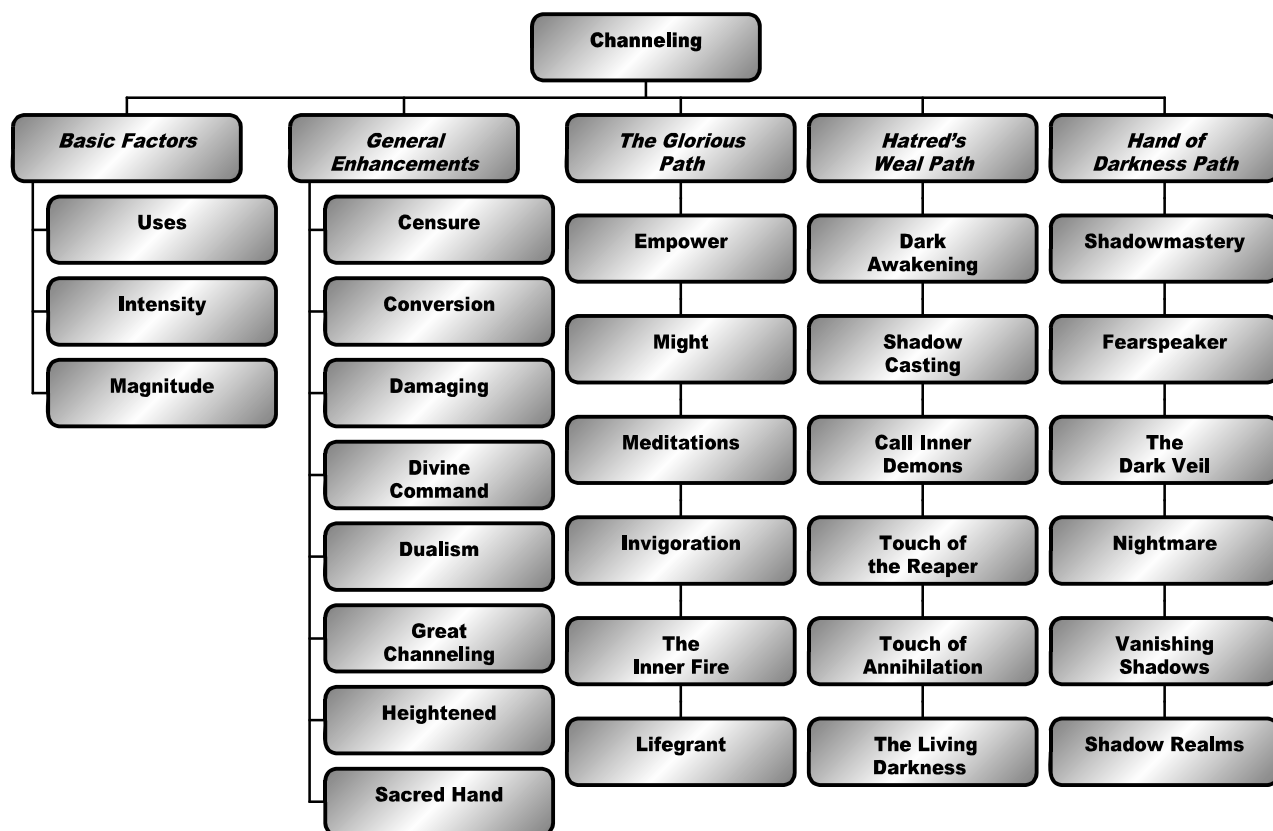
Base Magnitude = 2d6 + Cha Mod + User Level. Add +1d6 per +3 CP to a maximum total of +8d6 for +18 CP.

Base Range = 60 Feet. This normally radiates from the user, but may be projected in a cone if this is desired.

Basic Upgrades

Censure (6 CP). You may lace your Channeling effects with additional energies, allowing you to affect an additional category of targets. Common categories include good and evil outsiders, elemental pairs, animals, or plants. In the case of elementals or outsiders, you bolster an allied type while rebuking its opposite (for example, rebuking fire elementals while bolstering water). Animals and plants are Bolstered through positive energy and Rebuked by negative. You may take Censure multiple times to affect multiple groups.

Such creatures are considered to have a base Turn Resistance equal to one-half their Spell Resistance, if any. Characters who opt to buy Channeling which only affects creatures of a specific type may apply the *Specialized* modifier.



Conversion. You may convert the positive or negative energy from a Channeling attempt into a single divine spell effect (chosen when this ability is selected) appropriate to the energy type of up to level 2/3/5/6 for 3/6/9/12 CP. For an additional +3 CP you may select a group of four spells related to a particular theme. Gods and epic-level characters may go up to ninth level spells at a cost of 18/24/30 CP for levels 7/8/9.

Note that this may be used to power an "Add Metamagic" spell like the Metamagical Rods, adding +2 metamagic levels per 3 spell levels.

Divine Command (6 CP). You may momentarily imbue objects with life or unlife force, creating up to (Magnitude) hit dice worth of Animated Objects up to a limit of (Intensity) hit dice in size and lasting for (Intensity) rounds.

Dualism (6 or more CP, OPTIONAL). This allows use of both Positive and Negative energy. While it is possible for a character to use both negative and positive energy normally, they must buy uses, Intensity, and Magnitude modifiers separately.

Heightened (6 CP). You may reduce your base Intensity (to a minimum of zero) to add the subtracted value to your Magnitude. Alternatively, subtract dice from your Magnitude and add the number of dice so subtracted to your base Intensity. The modifier to be used must be declared before rolling.

Damaging (6 CP). In place of the usual turn/destroy result you may distribute (Magnitude) d6 of damage among any targets within range you would normally harm up to a limit of (Intensity) d6 against any one target. This is considered Divine-type damage.

Game masters may opt to make this the default system for Channeling. In this case characters may buy access to the usual turn/destroy results for +6 CP.

Great Channeling (6 CP). You may expend two turning attempts in a single action to double your total Magnitude.

Sacred Hand (6 CP). You no longer suffer a -10 Intensity penalty if you don't have a holy or unholy symbol to work through.

Glorious Touch (Positive energy wielders only)

● **Empower** (6 CP). You expend a Channeling attempt to imbue a weapon, shield, or tool, with (Cha Mod) "plusses," whether in the form of enhancement bonuses or special functions, for (Magnitude) rounds. The combination of abilities may be varied from use to use, but no single special ability may have a value of more than (Intensity/3) "plusses."

● **Might** (3 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to grant yourself, or anyone you touch, one of the following Sacred bonuses (chosen when this ability is selected): +2 to Str, Dex, or Con, +2 to all Saves, +10' move, or +10 HP. For each +3 CP an additional effect may be selected up to a maximum of 36 CP and twice for any individual effect. The total number of effects applied may not exceed (Intensity/2) and the duration is (Magnitude) rounds. For +3 CP you may split this duration between multiple targets.

● **Meditations on the Divine** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to throw off the effects of any form of mental control, including induced fear, possession, charm and dominate effects.

● **Invigoration** (6 CP). You may spend a Channeling attempt to gain (Intensity) temporary HP and Fast Healing 1 for (Magnitude) rounds. For +3 CP you may opt to apply this to an ally instead.

● **The Inner Fire** (6 CP). You may spend a Channeling attempt to fill yourself with sacred flames, burning away all parasites, diseases, and toxins. You gain fire resistance of (Intensity/3) and can inflict 2d6 fire damage with unarmed attacks for the next

(Magnitude) rounds. For +3 CP you may opt to apply this to an ally instead.

● **Lifegrant** (6 CP). You may spend a Channeling attempt to breath life into lifeless matter. For the newly (less than an hour) dead, this equates to *Resurrection*. Plants and Animals can be *Awakened*. Relatively formless items, such as stones, generally become elemental creatures. Items with reasonable forms, such as a statue, become living things and may or may not (at the user's option) be transformed into flesh. Using this ability normally costs 1 XP per 10 pounds of material affected.

Yes, this will allow you to make new species or to bring back extinct ones. Use with caution.



You want a blessing? I'll give you such a blessing...

Hatred's Weal (Negative energy wielders only)

- Dark Awakening (6 CP). You may gradually infuse one or more corpses with negative energy, transforming them into undead with a maximum Challenge Rating equal to (Intensity) and a Hit Die total equal to (Magnitude). This process requires at least three days, but does provide some influence over such creations: the user may employ social skills such as Diplomacy to influence undead created in this fashion and they have a base attitude of Neutral towards him or her.

As a note, this ability also allows the user to return as an undead three days to a week after being killed. The user must sacrifice character levels to apply an undead template of his or her choice.

- Shadow Casting (6 CP). You may give up 1 HP (which cannot be regained until the shadow is destroyed) and 100 or more XP to create a shadowy copy of yourself. Such copies have an effective XP total of 10x the amount given up to create them (not to exceed the creator's remaining total). They can become incorporeal as a Free Action and can possess helpless characters and creatures who are already under their creator's control and are a lower effective level than themselves.

- Call Inner Demons (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to project your own inner darkness as a physical entity - an *Astral Construct* of level (Intensity/2). While you can have only one such construct in existence at a time and suffer 3d6 damage if it's destroyed, whenever it kills someone you gain 1d6 temporary hit points (+30 max), one Mana point (+6 above normal maximum), and +1 effective Caster Level (+6 max). It can remain in existence for up to ten minutes, plus ten minutes per sentient being it kills.

- Touch of the Reaper (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to drain two levels with a touch attack. These take 12 hours each to return and never result in permanent level loss.

- Touch of Annihilation (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to inflict *Disintegration* with a touch attack. The saving throw is at DC (15 + Chr Mod).

- The Living Darkness (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to manifest an astral construct (as per Call Inner Demons) around yourself. You gain its Strength if it's higher than yours, it takes damage and makes saves before you do (you don't need to save if it succeeds), and you gain access to all of its other abilities.

Hand of Darkness (Negative energy users only)

- Shadowmastery (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to fill an radius of up to (2 x Intensity) feet with utter darkness for (Magnitude) rounds. While normal darksight and light-producing spells of less than 7th level will not penetrate this darkness, within it you have Shadowsense - the ability to pinpoint the location of anything within your darkness - and suffer no penalties for being unable to see.

- Fearspeaker (6 CP). You may spend a Channeling

attempt to gain Frightful Presence (Will save DC 10 + ½ character level) for (Magnitude) rounds, affecting those with (Intensity) or fewer levels in a 60 foot radius.

- The Dark Veil (6 CP). You may become a forgotten part of the greater darkness. No one will remember your origin, your name will persist in only the most obscure references, and even the rumors of your doings will become vague and confused. You may expend a Channeling attempt to erase all memories of yourself from any single creature within 60 feet, although this may be resisted with a DC 18 Will save.

- Nightmare (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to invoke a *Phantasmal Killer*, a horrific *Major Image*, to *Suggest* some dreadful or paranoid thought, or to simply inflict foul dreams and troubled nights on up to (Magnitude) targets within (Intensity) miles.

- Vanishing Shadows (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to erase up to (Intensity) specific thoughts and/or memories of your choice from up to (Magnitude) individual targets within 60 ft. Affected individuals - those who fail a DC 18 Will save - are likely to accept any suggestion you make in place of their missing memories.

- Shadow Realms (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to move to or from the Plane of Shadows or to enter or depart a dream. The sleeper may attempt to resist your entry to his dreams with a DC (10 + Intensity) Will save and you may remain there, causing trouble, for up to (Magnitude) minutes.

The following Channeling paths all have positive and negative forms, with appropriate effects and targets. Where opposing forms exist characters with Dualism must learn each form separately if they want both. The opposing forms can usually cancel each other out.

Planar Bonds

- Seal of Life/Death (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt as a Swift Action to invoke a *Death Ward* (or similar protection from positive energy effects).

- Seal of Light/Darkness (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt as a Swift Action to charge yourself with (Magnitude) d6 of sacred or profane damage. Until the supply is exhausted or (Intensity) minutes pass you may expend up to three dice of damage against any creature which strikes you in melee combat or which you hit with a touch attack.

- Inner Light/Darkness (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to take on the Half-Celestial (positive energy) or Half-Infernal (negative energy) template for (Magnitude) minutes with an effective "level" for the purposes of using their innate spells equal to (Intensity). Using this ability does, however, tend to result in being called on for services by Celestial or Infernal powers. For an additional +6 CP (Legacy) you may pass on such a template to your offspring, if any.



- **Flow of Life** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to provide 3d6 hit points and one Positive Level (page 86) to all of your allies within 60 feet (Positive Energy). Negative energy drains 3d6 hit points from all of your enemies in a similar radius while granting you up to 12d6 temporary hit points at two dice per enemy affected. In either case, there is no effect on characters whose level exceeds the effects' Intensity and no more than (Magnitude) characters can be affected in total.
- **Aura of Light/Darkness** (6 CP). You constantly radiate an aura of energy in a 15' radius with a normal Magnitude but a -10 penalty on its Intensity. For an additional +6 CP you may add a first-level divine spell effect relevant to positive or negative energy which you can use as an Immediate Action on anyone within your aura. It cannot affect any single character more than (Cha Mod) times per day and requires a Intensity check with a result of one or better after the -10 penalty to take effect.
- **Energy Transformation** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to become an incorporeal being of pure positive or negative energy, gaining the Incorporeal ability, Flight 60', (Intensity +10) resistance to positive and negative energy effects (as per Spell Resistance) and a touch attack inflicting either 3d6 profane damage (for negative energy wielders) or your choice of 2d6 healing or sacred damage. Your Channeling-based abilities will continue to affect material creatures normally. You may maintain this state for (Magnitude) rounds

Path of Infusions

- **Imbuement** (6 CP). You may infuse items or areas with energy. You may expend a Channeling attempt to bless a holy or unholy item, to create holy or unholy water, or to *Consecrate* or *Desecrate* an area. Given a few days for the ceremonies, and several Channeling attempts, you can *Hallow* or *Unhallow* a structure.
- **Spiritfire/Banefire** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to neutralize (negative energy) or generate (positive energy) simple physical energies, such as heat, cold, and electrical forces within a 60 foot radius. The user may inflict or negate up to (Intensity, 30 maximum) points of damage to up to (Magnitude) targets.
- **Living Matrix** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to supply (positive energy) or drain away (negative energy) three spell levels' worth of magical energy. For an additional +3 CP you may expend two attempts to supply or drain up to six levels' worth of magical energy. For +6 CP you may expend three Channeling attempts to supply or drain up to 12 spell levels' worth of energy. In either case, this can be treated much like the effects of a Rod of Absorption, although the user is not restricted to personally-directed spells.
- **Hand of the (Un-)Maker** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to create (positive energy) or destroy (negative energy) up to (Magnitude) cubic feet of inanimate material. Unfortunately, creation costs 1 XP

per 5 GP value of the materials created above 25 GP to make real and permanent items. If the required amount is not spent created items persist for only [Intensity] hours. Attempting to entrap a creature allows a save. Attacking a creature with negative energy acts as a *Disintegration* spell with an effective Caster Level of (Intensity/2). Using positive energy on a creature provides the effects of *Regeneration* and *Greater Restoration* at Caster Level equal to (Intensity) and heals (Magnitude) points of damage. All of these effects have a range of 60 feet and targets may make a Reflex save (DC 15 + Cha Mod) if this is relevant.

- **Forge of Will** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to temporarily augment (positive energy) or neutralize (negative energy) the powers of a magical item within 60 feet. Neutralization affects an item with a Caster Level of up to (Intensity) and renders it effectively non-magical for (Magnitude) hours. Augmentation effectively doubles the effectiveness of an item (e.g., the Caster Level of a wand, the "plusses" of a magical weapon, the amount of work done by a Lyre of Building) but only lasts for (Intensity) minutes or (Magnitude) total uses, whichever comes first.
- **Lifeshaping/Plague Mastery** (6 CP). Positive energy wielders may expend a Channeling attempt to duplicate the effects of *Polymorph* or *Baleful Polymorph*, but with a range of 60 feet and an instantaneous duration. Negative energy wielders may inflict new and hideous plagues (in general as per *Contagion*, original afflictions must be approved by the Game Master but their effect should be related to the Intensity) on up to (Magnitude) creatures. In either case a Fortitude save at DC (18 + Cha Mod) negates the effect.

Divine Wrath

- **Smite** (6 CP). Once per round you may expend a Channeling attempt as a Free Action to add (Cha Mod) to one of your attack rolls and (Intensity) Sacred or Profane damage to the damage it inflicts. A Smite attempt may be held ready for up to (Magnitude) rounds.
- **Wrath** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to add (Magnitude) Sacred or Profane damage to a touch attack.
- **Cleansing/Corruption** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt and touch a target to either cure (positive energy) or inflict (negative energy) various forms of insanity, including obsessions, delusions, and lack of self-control. Secondly this can either cast out (positive energy), or open the way for (negative) a wide variety of possessing entities. The Intensity and Magnitude must be high enough to affect a possessing entity to cast it out. Inflicting or removing madness may be resisted with a Will save versus a DC of (10 + Cha Mod + User Level/2).
- **Final Death** (6 CP). Relevant targets (living creatures for negative energy, undead for positive energy) cannot return to life or unlife if you either kill them personally

or ritually dispose of the body. This preempts regeneration, a vampire's ability to reform in its coffin, a lich's phylactery, and even common resurrection magic, although a *Wish*, *Miracle*, or any measures specified by the Game Master will still work. Extraordinary and Unique Returning override this (presuming the target's weakness isn't Final Death), but Final Death may delay the Returning.

- **Holy/Unholy Strike** (6 CP). As a Free Action you may expend a Channeling attempt to add either (Magnitude) points of Sacred or Profane damage to one of your successful attacks or to add a Sacred or Profane bonus of +(Intensity) to a single attack roll.

- **Death Strike** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt when you successfully attack an appropriate target (undead if wielding positive energy, living creatures if wielding negative energy) to add (Magnitude x 5, 200 maximum) points of damage to the attack. Creatures slain or destroyed by this attack can only be restored via a *Wish*, *Miracle*, Unique Returning, or divine intervention. There is no saving throw, but a Death Strike only affects creatures with an effective level of less than (Intensity).

Tides of Light and Darkness

- **The Reaching Hand** (6 CP). The base ranges of your Channeling abilities double (to 120 feet in most cases).

- **Repulsion** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to create a wave of force which can sweep away up to (Magnitude) targets weighing up to (Intensity x 100) pounds apiece, depositing each up to 60 feet further away. This can also be used defensively as an Immediate Action to protect a 15 foot radius from a flight of arrows, breath weapon, *Fireball*, or other massive attack.

- **Force Barrier** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to create a wall, dome, sphere, or other simple form of pure force within your range. Such creations must fit within a cube (Intensity) feet on a side and last for (Magnitude) rounds. In other ways they are similar to a *Wall of Force*.

- **Armor of Light/Darkness** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to create simple physical equipment from pure force. You may create up to (Intensity) individual pieces (complex items, such as a suit of plate armor, may count as up to six items at the option of the Game Master) which will last for up to (Magnitude) minutes. Such items are effectively unbreakable and, where relevant, have a +(Cha Mod) Sacred or Profane bonus.

- **Warding** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to counter or command a spell. This requires an Intensity of (2x Spell Level + the caster's relevant attribute modifier) and a Magnitude equal to the Caster Level to counter, deflect, or neutralize an incoming spell and twice that to control, retarget, or redirect it.

- **Sendings** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to create a quasialemental servant out of positive or negative energy. Such servants can be treated as *Astral Constructs* created with an effect of spell level (Intensity/3), remain for up to (Magnitude) rounds, and their attacks are treated as Holy (positive energy) or Unholy (negative energy) weapons.

The Boundless Realms

- **Circle of Power** (6 CP). Your single-target Channeling effects may be expanded to affect an area of up to [1+ CM]*5 feet provided that they can affect others. Personal-only techniques remain personal-only.

- **Sea of Light/Darkness** (6 CP). You may enhance the radius of basic Channeling effects by +60 feet, and may even increase this by an additional +10 feet per +3 CP up to a limit of +120 feet. Sadly, using this ability costs an extra Channeling attempt.

- **Lord of Light/Darkness** (6 CP). The base Magnitude of your Channeling attempts changes from (dice + Charisma modifier + user level) to [(dice + user level) x Charisma modifier] with respect to basic Channeling functions. This may be taken more than once, each time adding an additional (Cha Mod -1) to the multiplier. As a side effect, the total hit dice of undead that a negative-energy channeler can control is similarly multiplied.

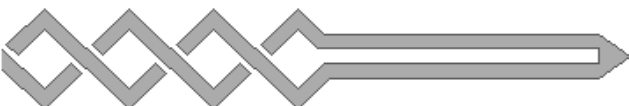
- **Strength/Weakness** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to provide +2 Positive Levels (with positive energy or negative energy to undead, page 86) or to inflict 2 negative levels (positive energy versus undead or negative energy versus normal creatures) on up to (Magnitude) allies OR enemies (not both) within your Circle of Power. No single target can have its effective level increased above (Intensity). Unfortunately the effect fades after (Cha Mod) rounds.

- **The Focal Point** (6 CP). You may direct and focus the efforts of other channelers. The net Intensity of such a combined effort is rolled by the user with a +1 bonus on the roll per assistant. The net Magnitude is equal to the total Magnitude of all the attempts combined.

This isn't all that useful for affecting resistant targets, but it is very useful when smiting swarms of lesser creatures.

- **Worldspinner/The Great Unbinding** (6 CP). You may expend a Channeling attempt to create a private world similar to that created by a Rod of Sanctuary. Such a pocket dimension can accommodate up to (Intensity) creatures and has a base duration of (Magnitude) days. Characters using negative energy can temporarily suppress planar traits in a radius of (5 x Intensity) feet for up to (Magnitude) rounds.

Physics-minded Game Masters may opt to allow the suppression of other natural laws and aspects of reality. Those running dimension-hopping games may opt to allow characters using positive energy to create other types of pocket dimensions. This can be entertaining either way, but is entirely at your own risk.



Dominion and Divine Ascension

Gaining Dominion

The Dominion ability (6 CP) allows users to gather, store, and expend Dominion Points. Dominion points, or DP, contain the psychic energy of those who trust in the character and bow to his or her orders, will, or plans. No individual contributes even one single DP, but a kingdom can greatly empower its ruler.

Characters with Dominion may accrue up to (Charisma/3) Dominion points per month, and may hold up to (Charisma x 4) in reserve. Control of a village, well-settled estate, minor guild, or small temple adds 1 Dominion point per month. Major positions of authority, such as controlling an army or city, are worth 2 DP. Running a major guild, church, or magical society is worth 1-6 DP per month depending on its size. Ruling a city-state, nation, or empire is worth from 2-8 points a month, depending on the size and power of the nation. Happy, proud citizens are “worth” much more than weak, apathetic ones. Conversely, empires built on the backs of terrified slaves also arrive at the upper end, as fear and pain are also rich sources of power.

Dominion grants no easy method of gaining points; the character must develop that on his or her own, and must maintain good (or bad) rule carefully. Not only does this provide the GM with a great source of new plots and adventures, actually roleplaying leadership can be quite rewarding.

Some domains might seem quite odd. A character might, for example, adopt a forest and its creatures and spirits as his or her domain or become leader of a strange dimension or elemental plane. Whatever the source of a character’s power, this is his or her *realm* and many Dominion-based powers will only work inside it.

Dominion makes a good background element, but it’s most interesting if at least one player character has it. Dominion works best in games built around it, where most characters are rulers or have other powerful abilities. Dominion generally requires an excuse to take, which easily comes in a specialty campaign. The character, for example, might need to be descended from the last King or be given the rights to Dominion as a special gift by a deity.

If all the player characters are of royal blood, or rule fiefdoms, it gives the campaign a unique flavor. Plus, no one character necessarily dominates events.

Personal Dominion

Characters may spend DP on themselves to enhance their abilities or techniques for a time.

- **Boost.** A Dominion point adds a +5 unnamed bonus to any single skill, save, or attack roll. Two will add +8, and three will add +10, the upper limit.
- **Defense.** Dominion points may be spent to avoid damage. Each DP stops 4 points of damage, regardless of type (hit point, attribute, or whatever), *after* applying damage reduction or immunities.
- **Metamagic.** A Dominion point may be spent to add +3 levels of metamagic to a spell. The character need not actually know the metamagical technique in question, but only one DP may be spent to enhance a spell.
- **Replacement.** Dominion Points may be given up in place of attribute points which would otherwise be lost to old age, ability drains, or ability damage.

Political Dominion

Characters may also spend DP to achieve political ends, changing the workings of government to their liking. This includes the following options:

- **Bestowal.** A Dominion Point may be used to bestow a public office or knighthood, to invest a regent, to confirm a heir (a confirmed heir will inherit a character’s DP if and when the character dies), or to grant other public appointments. The recipient gains a whopping 15 CP of new abilities - but the GM get to pick out three Disadvantages!

Unfortunately, characters can only benefit from one office at a time - and you can’t give offices to yourself.

The disadvantages of an office usually revolve around its responsibilities, political opposition, and the attention paid a public figure. While some of the extra CP usually go to perks, special privileges, and whatever resources the office makes available, quite a few fantasy offices carry special powers as a part of the package.

- **Inspiration.** You may Inspire (see page 85 for the Mystic Artist ability) masses of your followers for one day per DP point used. This covers an entire battlefield, construction project, or expedition - usually up to 10,000 people.
- **Scale.** You can modify large events which are occurring within your realm or under your direction. This includes rolls to raise armies, revise government bureaucracies, diplomatic negotiations between states or cities, and establishing new trade routes. Each DP expended adds or subtracts 1 (or 5%) on the roll as appropriate. You can also spend DP to modify events occurring in neighboring realms, but the effect is halved.
- **Spellcasting.** You may use the Battlemagic metamagic feat even if you do not possess it by spending 1 Dominion point per level of the spell cast. If you know how to use Battle Magic normally, this ability reduces the casting time to 5 rounds.



Advanced Dominion



It's good to be the king.

Advanced Dominion abilities allow the user to direct the energies of his or her followers in more sophisticated ways.

The Way of the Lands

Landrule (+6 CP, requires Dominion). Lords with Landrule may sense disturbances in their home realms. Aside from that, you may use *Commune with Nature* at any place within it at will.

Spirit Speech (+6 CP, requires Landrule). Spirit Speech allows you to communicate with natural beings who dwell within your realm. While it doesn't guarantee cooperation, few creatures attempt to eat or attack something talking to them, and if you keep the peace within your realm most Nature Spirits will assent to everyday requests. This doesn't allow you to contact Realm Spirits, such as the spirits of mighty rivers, storms, or whole forests unless you spend 5 DP to make contact and more to influence them. See page 168 for a description of Nature and Realm Spirits.

Spirit Call (+6 CP, requires Spirit Speech). You may now contact all Nature Spirits, even Realm Spirits, as long as they are within your realm, no matter how far away you are. Realm Spirits will normally consider you a youthful peer.

Spirit Channeling (+6 CP, requires Spirit Call). You may spend 1 DP to tap into the power of any special magical resources which are a part of your realm. Inanimate resources, such as a healing spring or enchanted forest, can be tapped automatically. Living creatures, such as Nature Spirits, must consent to your use of their power. In any case, you may use the power you've called upon as many times as you can manage within one minute or for up to an hour for ongoing effects.

Naturally enough, what can be accomplished through Spirit Channeling depends on how many power sources a realm contains and how cooperative its spirits are.

One with the Earth (+6 CP, requires Spirit Channeling). You become a Realm Spirit and gain the template found on page 169.

Congratulations, you just retired!

More seriously, you don't actually need to take on the template until you die physically. In the meantime, you will automatically feel injuries to, and disturbances of, your realm, may spend your vitality (HP) to enhance its health and fertility, and may expend 5 DP and a relevant spell to cast a spell on the Battle Magic/Epic scale - enchanting your realm for a month, raising a small army of summoned creatures, raising a fortress, healing injuries to the land, surrounding your realm with a wall of fire or an impenetrable mist, or some similar feat. While this bypasses the usual "10,000 GP worth of gear" requirement, casting such a spell still requires a full month.

The Way of Omnipresence

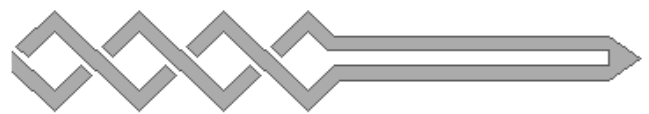
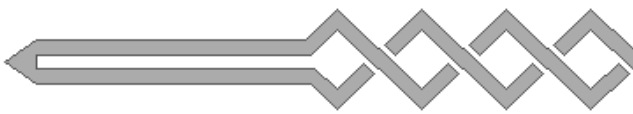
Ears of the Wind (+6 CP, requires Dominion). With Ears of the Wind, you may hear a snippet of conversation every time you are mentioned anywhere in the plane. You can turn this ability off. This is identical to the Path of the Dragon ability, but does not meet any other prerequisites for progression along that path.

Multitasking (+6 CP, requires Ears of the Wind). You may use whatever divination, clairvoyance, or similar powers you possess to watch up to (character level) events, locations, or situations at once. You take no penalty for this, and may still act normally. In other words, you can easily focus as much mental effort as is needed on any one problem, without fragmenting your mind.

Characters without clairvoyant powers may still listen to multiple sets of advisors, read several reports at once, keep an eye on the children, and practice fencing, all at the same time.

Seal of Silence (+6 CP, requires Multitasking). This impressive ability allows you to enforce silence on a location, topic, or person, so that none within your realm may speak on that subject and divinations fail. While





expensive, it effectively controls public discourse by denying opponents the ability to communicate ideas.

2 DP per month wards an area the size of a city block, which also protects it from scrying or sensing magic. 3 DP per month wards a group of people up to 100 members from such scrying and prevents anyone from talking about the group. You may specify whether the group members may talk about it. For 1 Godfire point, you may enforce silence on an entire idea or topic. This lasts for 6 months in all cases.

Know the Flock (+6 CP, requires Multitasking). With Know the Flock, you automatically sense all major influences on your followers, including influential people and ideas. Furthermore, you know if any powerful or important magical item, sentient or otherwise, currently impacts your loyal subjects. You have a good idea of what your followers are doing. This can extend beyond your realm, but only where a large number of your subjects dwell.

The Spark Within (+6 CP, requires Know the Flock). Favored by deities, the Spark Within allows you to send omens, visions, and to speak with your followers at will. You are not limited by range or dimension.

Revelation (+6 CP, requires The Spark Within). Revelation is used for large-scale conversion of groups to your cause or religion. It does not compel individuals, but the effects are noticeable on a grand level involving thousands. First, you must select a target, usually a society, class, or subculture of no less than 500 people and no more than 5000. You spend 6 DP, and roll percentile dice. The dice indicate the percentage of followers you convert.

Note that doing this is an open invitation to reprisals from other lords, and the individuals in question will not at first be particularly loyal or faithful. If you don't deliver better conditions or otherwise please the targets, they will revert to their original attitudes.

The Way of Valour

Voice of Command (+6 CP, requires Dominion). People will obey you whenever you give out orders appropriate to the situation. This doesn't help you against enemies, but anyone who is looking for a leader, is confused, is simply used to following orders and has no urgent reason to disobey, or is in need of aid, will gladly follow you. There is no save unless a given individual sees him- or her- self as a competitor.

The Rightful King (+6 CP, requires Voice of Command). Portents and signs cause everyone to recognize you as a True King. Not only may you now describe how glorious you look whenever you want, but everyone must acknowledge that you are truly meant to rule.

Add +2 to your level when determining how many levels you have to allocate to your followers if you have Leadership. Their maximum level does not increase.

Heroism (+6 CP, requires The Rightful King). With Heroism, every 10 DP you spend allows you to gain +1 hit point, permanently. At best, this can increase your pool of hit points up to what you could have had if you rolled the maximum on each hit die. In effect, this ability can maximize each hit die retroactively - given the DP.

Epic Heroism (+6 CP, requires Heroism). You may temporarily awaken your latent abilities. Pick a template worth up to +4 ECL when you select this ability. You may take it on for the 24 hours by expending (2 x ECL) DP. You may also spend 2 DP when they're conceived to pass the template in question on to your children.

Warband (+6 CP, requires The Rightful King). Choose a circle of up to five close allies and trusted friends. For every 5 character levels you have over an individual, he or she gains +1 Positive Level (page 86).

Gift of Tongues (+6 CP, requires Voice of Command). You now understand all languages, from everywhere, including ones not subscribing to a mode of thought or reality akin your own. No code, misstatement, or encryption can fool you. Lies can.

Wrath of the Overlord

Curse (+6 CP, requires Dominion). You may spend DP to shape the destiny of those who oppose you. 2 DP creates a minor curse, 4 DP fashions a major curse, and 6 DP fashions an awesome curse. These curses work on groups or family lines, not individuals - unless that individual is powerful enough to personally count as a major factor in world affairs. Curses on individuals are normally handled by simple spells. Curses have three rules, listed below.

- They must be vague. You cannot describe an exact effect, only a general idea. "-6 Con Score" is not acceptable. "The Curse of Wasting" is good.
- Curses can produce backlash and cause you trouble now and then. Normally, this means you'll share the curse for a while or have bad luck for a few weeks for calling one.
- All curses have an escape hatch. You must think up a particular method by which the curse can end, and if that escape hatch closes, you get to think up another one.

True Aspect (+6 CP, requires Curse). You may spend DP to increase your powers, putting into action things you've merely been practicing. Each DP you spend (up to a limit of 3) adds 12 temporary CP for the next hour. Since this represents things you're working on, you must permanently purchase at least two-thirds of the abilities so employed within the next (one level per DP spent).



The Path of the Pharaoh

Manipulation (+6 CP, requires Dominion). This triples the bonuses received from the *Scale* basic ability.

Sphere of Influence (+6 CP, requires Manipulation). You begin to embody some aspect of the universe. You gain a Divine Portfolio and automatically sense related major events. Select a relevant domain to grant to your priests. You can grant spells of up to spell level 3 while on the material plane. Increase this to level 9 if you withdraw to the outer planes, a personal astral domain, or another game-appropriate plane. Any magic cast which touches upon your Sphere of Influence costs -1 spell level for you to accomplish.

Bored, retiring, or dying gods may opt to merge with one of their Spheres of Influence, becoming an eternal part of the fabric of the universe. Such gods are beyond mortal or even normal divine concerns, although they may use a point of Godfire to elevate a successor and give their remaining store to him or her on the way out.

Godfire (+6 CP, requires Sphere of Influence). You gain the ability to hold, manipulate, and focus Godfire. This feat opens up a whole new chapter in your power and status. You are now considered a true god, if a minor one. See **Godfire** (page 76, below) for more details on this wonderful ability.

Like Dominion, it usually takes special circumstances to gain Godfire, such as being initiated by another god, being infused with the power of an ancient relic, having divine blood, or some mighty ritual.

Divine Attribute (+6 CP, requires Godfire). You can temporarily embody a Sphere of Influence you possess. This causes you to lose control of your character; the GM takes over, while you become a force of nature, freely wielding the powers of one of your Spheres of Influence. This often makes you unkillable ("How can you kill the Sea?") and grants a wide range of powers which need little game description: they either are appropriate to what needs to be done or they aren't. This may well result in you attacking or hindering the party, or even eliminating your own home, friends, or magic items. Be cautious.

Transcendence (+6 CP, requires Godfire). You may now purchase abilities as if you had no purchase limits imposed by character level or attribute requirements.

Minions (+6 CP, requires Godfire). You gain 2d12 supernatural followers, outside of any Leadership feats you have. These followers are competent administrators and have challenge ratings of 2/3'rds your level. Aside from this, you gain a small horde of messenger spirits or other minor helpers, useless in combat but very useful for organizing and directing your followers. While reasonably bright, they aren't powerful at all.

Gateway (+6 CP, requires Godfire). You may open a *Gate* to summon your minions through or travel to a known location. You may use this ability (Con Mod)+1 times per day.

Creation (+6 CP, requires Godfire). You have created a permanent divine realm (and presumably an afterlife) for yourself and your followers. Once you reach this level, pretty much everyone accepts you a deity, with all the good and bad that entails.

Divine Infusion (+6 CP, requires Creation). Every level after taking this ability, you gain a number of CP equal to your (Cha Mod). This is good. However, the Game Master allocates these points to conform to your followers' beliefs, tales, and ideas about you. While rarely a bad thing overall, the character often gets points in abilities he or she doesn't use or has little interest in, general attribute enhancements, strange relics, and weird minions. Much of it is likely to wind up in Endowment, below.

Soulshield (+6 CP, requires Godfire). Soulshield protects your followers after they die. In other words, when one of them dies, their soul is automatically drawn to your divine realm. It cannot be trapped or held on the material plane or by a spell of less than 9th level. Any creature, item, or spell that does so is immediately brought your attention, so that you may rip the offender into tiny pieces for having the effrontery to insult you so.

Sanctify (+6 CP, requires Soulshield). Select a non-attack area-effect spell of up to 6th level. You may use that effect at will and may set it as a constant effect over your chosen holy city, in all temples dedicated to you, or on another suitably limited set of locations as you prefer. Such sites are automatically Hallowed or Unhallowed as appropriate as well.

Endowment (+6 CP, requires Godfire). You grant 1 CP worth of abilities to all your priests and devoted followers, everywhere. The ability applies to any priest of an order or temple devoted to you, as well as laymen devoted to your service and exemplifying your principles. You may take this feat as many times as you please. Go ahead. Your followers will love and worship you for it.

Endowments based on adherence to principles and traits are discussed further on page 153.

Greater Endowment (+6 CP, requires Endowment). Greater Endowment causes any 1 CP from Endowment to apply to all followers everywhere, including those not exceptionally faithful. As long as they do believe and are moderately loyal, they gain the 1 CP. You may take this ability as many times as you please up to the number of times that you've taken Endowment.





Godfire

Godfire is that fraction of the energies of masses of believers and worshipers than a single entity can focus, channel, and direct. It may be the greatest and most versatile power source in the universe.

Sadly, it isn't very easy to get. Most of that massed energy isn't really focused on the deity. It's focused on temples and religious sites, on priests and champions of the faith, on the afterlife, on the needs of the worshipers and on the visible aspects of the church. Only the smallest, purest portion of it can be harvested as Godfire. Even the most powerful gods rarely get more than two points per month.

There are other ways to manipulate the energy of believers. For example, characters with Godfire can create realms, bless their worshipers, and otherwise become an all-around great deity. These are handled simply by taking the appropriate Dominion feats. Godfire has many awesome uses on its own, however. Gods don't really need anything except the will to use it.

Even Godfire cannot completely break the laws of nature though. If the GM decides that Time Travel isn't possible in the campaign, even Godfire can't do it. On the other hand, Godfire can mimic any ability that does exist, and allows events and actions which can't otherwise occur. Godfire has further limits in that it must reflect one of the user's Spheres of Influence, or the task must remain generic enough to apply to every god. Any God can raise a temple out of thin air. The God of the Oceans can't summon a meteor (unless one's already handy and he or she just needs to give it a shove), because that has nothing to do with the ocean.

Even a God can only hold up to (Cha Score) Godfire points. Mortals can be imbued with a single point of Godfire, but the god who grants it must specify, at least in general, what it can be used for when granting it.

Note that Godfire Points are *not* referred to as GP to avoid confusion. In fact, do not abbreviate Godfire in any way. It doesn't like it.

Gaining Godfire

Being worshiped is the classical way to get Godfire, but it takes a lot of worshipers to do it. While it's easier to join an established pantheon (at the "State Religion" level or better) then it is to found your own religion, that will only get you one Godfire Point per year. Note that "Being worshiped by..." bonuses don't stack; you only get the best - and nobody's found anything bigger than "an inter-dimensional religion" yet.

Being worshiped by...	provides...	Godfire per Year
A modest cult		1
A major movement		2
A state religion		3
A great regional religion		4
A planetary faith		5
A multi-planetary faith		6
An inter-dimensional religion		7

The spirits in your afterlife can generate up to seven points of Godfire per year for you. Yes, this does include captured enemy spirits and similar victims, but trying to populate an afterlife that way is far more trouble than it's worth.



Number of spirits in Afterlife	Godfire per Year
1,000	1
10,000	2
100,000	3
1,000,000	4
10,000,000	5
100,000,000	6
1,000,000,000 or more	7

It doesn't get any better than that. After you're getting 7 Godfire a year, your afterlife just can't provide it more rapidly.

A few special events and accomplishments can also supply Godfire. These include:

Becoming a God. You gain one free point just for taking the Godfire feat. If you can find a way to do this more than once you're very clever. If you can find a way to do it more than once AND keep your Godfire in between you're even more clever.

Gaining Experience. You gain +1 Godfire per four experience levels gained after taking the Godfire feat.

Divine Gifts. A gift of a god; if the character cannot normally use Godfire, the point must be pre-specified for a specific task.

Epic Triumphs. You achieve some vast goal, such as introducing your religion to an entirely new region or plane. Doubling the home ground of your religion or defeating your ancient arch-nemesis would count. This is worth +2 points of Godfire.

Heroic Triumphs. When one of your chosen champions succeeds in a mighty quest or task which notably changes the world you get a point of Godfire. If this constitutes an Epic Triumph for you as well, you get both awards.

Holy War. Whenever you start a major crusade or jihad against another deity or an organization of equal or larger size than your church you gain +3 points of Godfire. You lose them again if you give up or settle the matter peacefully. If you don't have enough points you lose whatever you do have and the basic Godfire feat permanently, or at least until you buy it again.

This is extremely dangerous even if no other deity is involved. If you've declared a jihad against another god, they're quite certain to declare one back - and if your position looks really bad, so will their allies. After all, that's 3 "free" Godfire points!

Fame and Infamy. Being hailed and celebrated as a great hero or reviled and despised as an unholy terror is worth one point of Godfire. The first time. OK, maybe once each if the Game Master is feeling generous.

Optional Godfire Rules

The Game Master may opt to allow a few other ways to gain Godfire. Possibilities here include:

- **Dominance.** Gods gain +1/2/3 Godfire Points per year if they control 1-2/3-6/7+ uncontested spheres of influence.
- **Gathering Power.** You gain +1 Godfire Point per 6 personal CP expended.

Regular ritual sacrifices, or the consumption of some form of mystical resources, can supply Godfire Points using the same scale as the "Being worshiped by..." table - but exploiting this too much may well drive your followers into looking for another god!

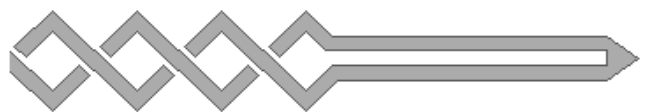
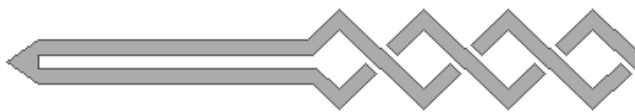
- Minor sacrifices, such as food and livestock, building small temples, or small tithes of mystical materials such as adamantium provide (Scale-3) points per year. A great regional religion making such sacrifices would thus provide one extra Godfire Point each year. Most cultures will accept this without too much fuss.
- Notable sacrifices, such as regularly raising statues to you, building mighty cathedrals, small tithes of magical items, or spending large amounts of time in ceremonial worship provide (Scale-2) points per year and tend to put a bit of a strain on things.
- Major sacrifices, such as large tithes of magic items, occasional sentient beings, massive amounts of magical materials, or having mages drain magical nexi to channel their power to you, provide (Scale-1) points per year and usually won't be acceptable unless there's a war on or some such justification.
- Grandiose sacrifices, such as lots of sentient beings, most of the energies of the realms arcane spellcasters, or the labor of much of the population are worth (Scale) points per year, but usually can't be sustained for long.

Using Godfire

Godfire avoids many restrictions on time and space. A deity may use it outside of time, or even after "dying," which ensures that truly killing one is very difficult. If a group of the deity's servants survive his or her death, they can even supply him or her with more Godfire, which he or she may use to reawaken someday. (Most dead Gods wait even longer, to build up a decent reserve).

Godfire takes no time or components to use, never produces side effects, never goes wrong, and places no strain on the user; he or she does not lose experience, hit points, or even suffer from fatigue. The DC to avoid a Godfire effect or any spell backed with Godfire is 28 + (deity's Con Mod) + (deity's Int Mod). While some grandiose acts may require multiple Godfire Points to accomplish, common uses of Godfire include:





- **Acceleration.** A Godfire Point equates to three month's work with all mundane materials and tools supplied (free!) and all d20 checks treated as rolls of natural 30's.

No, that's not a typo. Natural "30's" it is. We said that Godfire could do things which were otherwise impossible, and we meant it!

- **Bestowal.** You or a target gains +6 CP worth of special abilities up to a lifetime maximum of +24 CP.

- **Counter.** You may automatically counter the effects of another point of Godfire provided that you spend it at the same time as your opponent. Undoing something that's already taken place may be considerably harder.

- **Creation.** You may create mundane and/or magical items worth a total of up to 60,000 GP or up to 120,000 GP if the item or items are closely tied to your Sphere or Spheres of Influence (creating a personal palace or temple always is). You may create artifact items, or add to existing ones, if you possess the appropriate item creation feat or already have a similar power to the one you wish to imbue.

- **Duplication.** You duplicate or create and cast any spell up to level 12 within one of your Spheres of Influence, up to level 8 outside of that, or up to level 4 in an opposing Sphere.

- **Empower Champion.** A mortal target receives a full rewrite of their character if they desire, and can provide you with more Godfire by accomplishing Heroic Triumphs. This also allows a god to give special training as he or she pleases in an instant on the target (see page 18). Up to three Gods (usually close allies) may give such a bonus to any one character, but this is very rare.

- **Grant.** You may bestow an inherent bonus of +2 on any attribute, +1 per additional point of Godfire expended to a maximum of +6. This affects you or any target which possesses the attribute.

- **Life.** You create a living being. You can define appearance and form, traits, levels, and abilities up to 5 levels below your character level (counting racial ECL). You can only give the new creature abilities which you already possess however. Existing creatures may be changed or simply enhanced up to the same limits - which is why such a high percentage of divine offspring go on to become gods, mighty heroes, or legendary monsters themselves.

- **Spellpower.** A spell backed by Godfire gains +25 to overcome Spell Resistance and the target's saving throw. The God also applies +12 levels of any metamagics he or she wishes, even if he or she does not normally know how to use them. Battle Magic cast with Godfire activates immediately, needs no other materials, and can reach the highest limit of effect. Antimagic effects do not block or cancel a spell cast in this manner and no spell below its own level (after modification by metamagic) may counter it.

Side Effects of Godfire

Using Godfire does cause side effects, though they're not what anyone would consider bad for the most part.

- Gods do not age and are immune to attribute losses from disease (although they may carry diseases). They do not die of old age or natural causes.

- Gods are fertile with virtually anything. This often leads to unwanted divine offspring.

- Gods have an Awe (or Horror) score equal to their current store of Godfire if they choose to use it. Anyone who sees a god and fails a Will save against his or her Awe score becomes stunned for 2d4 rounds.

- Gods can recover from Petrification and Polymorph effects in (20 - Current Godfire reserve) rounds. At reserve 20 this is instantaneous and takes no actions.

PC's, NPC's, and Godfire

The Godfire rules present a good reason for why and how those great heroes can face off against Gods. Sure, the God might be more powerful, but they've sunk a lot of points into buying those dominion and deity abilities. The hero has put all of his or her points into buying personal power. Since Godfire points are really valuable, deities don't spend them just to avoid embarrassment. They save them for major tasks and awesome miracles. Therefore, characters can take on and "defeat" Gods, without those deities being in serious danger.

Similarly, there's nothing wrong with a few player-character gods running about. In fact, if you want to use some horrific encounters, it's a great failsafe; if you get it wrong and score a total party kill they can recover without Game Master intervention. In practical terms, it's a bit like letting the characters have a Ring of Wishes. A sensible group will save it for extreme emergencies.

The Dominion-Godfire system is set up to represent ascending demigods and the fallible gods of ancient mythology in a playable fashion, rather than having the easily-fooled and impatient Thor get an automatic 45 on all Int checks and Craft skills - including Embroidery. Secondly, it was designed to leave gods dependent on their worshipers.

If you want your senior gods to be more independent, simply assume that they can tap into some primal power source exclusive to them. Perhaps something left over from the creation of the world?

If you want the greater gods to be truly immortal and near-omnipotent within their spheres simply assume that they've merged with their spheres via Divine Attribute but still take some interest in less cosmic entities.

Finally, if you want a truly supreme being in your cosmos, just put one in. You don't need rules for that, since any such entity probably wrote them in the first place.

Hexcrafting

This magic system works best with story-driven games, since determining its effects falls heavily on the Game Master. It requires a deck of rune, tarot, totem, or other symbol cards for each Hexcrafter. While each character needs their own deck, they need not all use the same type. Ideally, each deck should consist of at least 60 clearly-distinct cards.

To use a Hex, you announce which of your cards you're calling on, and the effect you're trying for. A card can be used to invoke any effect appropriate to the symbol it portrays. For example, a Bear Totem card could be used to invoke a berserk rage, sink into hibernation, perform a feat of strength, frighten creatures, or to heal someone (since Bear is a healing totem), among other things. Then either mark off a free invocation or discard one or more of your available cards (this need not include the one you're calling on for the spell effect) to power the spell. Hexcraft abilities refresh on a per-session basis, not on a per-day basis.

The maximum level of effect a Hexcrafter can produce is shown under Hexcrafting Invocation, below.

Hexcrafting Invocations

Caster Level	-----Maximum level of effect for:----- Invocation	One Card	Three Cards
1-4	Trivial	Minor	Common
5-8	Minor	Common	Major
9-12	Minor	Common	Major
13-16	Common	Major	Grand
17-20	Common	Major	Grand
21-24	Major	Grand	Epic
25+	Major	Grand	Epic

An extra card can be spent to bypass Spell Resistance or to cast a defensive spell as an Immediate Action.

"Free" Invocations cost 3 CP each.

Card Slots cost 8 CP each. Each adds one slot to your Hand. While cards are normally drawn randomly from your deck at the beginning of each session, characters may spend an extra +2 CP to designate a slot as "Fixed" when they buy it, in which case they simply put that card in their hand at the start of a session. The Game Master may require that each Hexcrafter's first Card be fixed.

Characters with spellcasting attributes of 12+ receive an extra slot (provided that they qualify for any at all). Those with an 18+ receive two extra slots.

Characters using exceptionally versatile or broad-based decks may have to pay 10 CP per card slot. Those using more narrowly-focused decks, such as a deck only of totem animals, may only need to pay 6 CP per slot. In either case, the Game Master must rule on it.

Caster Levels have their usual 6 CP cost, but may be Specialized if applicable only to Hexcrafting.

Saving Throws against Hexes use the base DC listed for each level of Hex plus the character's spellcasting attribute modifier.

Divine Hexes must be appropriate to the user's divine patron, but may be used while wearing armor. Arcane Hexes may not be used while wearing armor. Otherwise they work about the same way.

Level Drained characters lose a random card from their Hand for each level drained.

Hex Levels

Assigning levels to hexes is straightforward; the Game Master simply assigns a level to a proposed effect. The following list of benchmarks is suggested, but each Game Master is free to make up their own.

Trivial Effects are often mistaken for skills or a bit of sleight-of-hand. Causing a lock to open, stopping bleeding, producing a small item, blocking a blow, making a shadow deep enough to hide in, and such all qualify, as does surrounding yourself with an glowing aura and speaking in a "voice of prophecy," making a creature hesitate, and so on. These equate to cantrips and have a base save DC of 10.

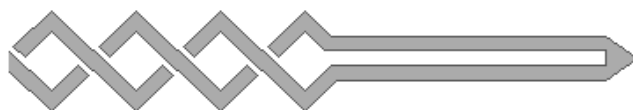
Minor Effects include breaking some bowstrings, small amounts of healing, complex small-scale illusions, simple spells of "charm" and confusion, modest mystical bolts and shields and so on. These equate to L1 spells and have a base save DC of 12.

Common Effects include casting several ordinary guards into sleep, a sphere of invisibility, taking animal form, sealing a portal, summoning a minor entity to bargain with, telekinetically moving sizable items, dispelling spirits, suppressing inherent abilities, and localized area effects. These equate to L2 and L3 spells and have a base save DC of 14.

Major Effects include single-target "death" spells (in various forms), transforming someone, teleportation, summoning fairly potent entities to bargain with or compelling lesser ones, very large-area but fairly minor attacks, binding beings to service, and so on. These equate to L4-L6 spells and have a base save DC of 16.

Grand Effects include taking on powerful shapes, shattering the defenses of a castle, resurrecting a deceased friend, spheres of death which distinguish between friends and foes, warding cities, ancestral curses, and so on. Relatively little literary magic falls into this category - unless you count effects with a very heavy price. These equate to L7-L9 spells and have a base save DC of 20.

Epic Effects include banishing cities across the dimensions, transforming entire armies, summoning a legion of undead, summoning gods, calming volcanoes and other legendary acts of magic. These equate to epic spells and are VERY rarely seen; after all, the world is still mostly here. If it matters, they have a base save DC of 24.



Always keep one up your sleeve.

Hexcrafters get relatively few, but extremely flexible, spells. As a rule, the Game Master should be reasonably generous about what they can do, since they won't get to do it all that often. Remember that their magic is per game session, not per day. If a session covers a six-month trip they won't be using magic except at crisis points. This fits in nicely with most tales of epic fantasy.

Game Masters who want to vary things may want to import a spell list. After all, there are plenty of games out there with extensive lists of spells split up by level of effect. To convert one to a benchmark list, simply multiply the levels it assigns to its spells by (the number of levels in the system/12). Then, if it doesn't include level zero spells, subtract 1. Anything that winds up at level 10+ is Epic, other spells will fall into appropriate levels. Players will inevitably propose effects which are not on the list, but it provides benchmarks from which to start.

"World Laws" - assigning a level modifier to types of spells - can be used in either case. As an example, if the Game Master feels that "Teleportation" effects make things too easy, he may simply rule that all such spells are subject to a +5 level modifier - making even short-range effects near-prohibitive. Reductions - making a field of magic easier to work with - are also possible, but should generally be smaller and handled with caution. A field with such an advantage becomes VERY powerful. Localized versions do make a good way to portray "Mystic Nexi," "Places of Power," or alternate dimensions.

Martial Arts

The Martial Art skill is a method of building specific martial arts as skills, rather than as a series of specialized feats. While characters can usually purchase abilities with CP directly, the Martial Arts system here allows them to buy many combat-related abilities with Skill Points instead. It doesn't require any other Point Buy options and thematically fits into many specialized d20 games. This path has nothing to do with the Martial Arts feat; characters may have both, either, or neither.

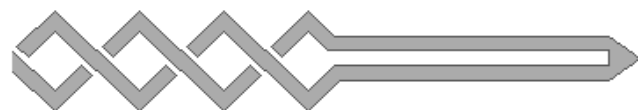
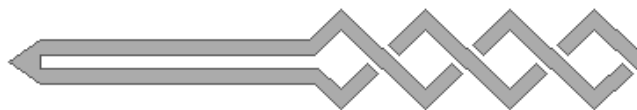
In reality, combat techniques are often specialized. This isn't reflected in d20 outside of a very few feats; most characters become equally skilled with a variety of weapons. These rules change this, allowing characters to specialize in a relatively few armed or unarmed techniques. While this system does include a variety of legendary-to-mythical skills, it does make a major concession to reality; given near-equal training, a character with a weapon is much more dangerous than a character without one.

While most people think of eastern styles (such as Kung-Fu, Karate, and Judo) when thinking of Martial Arts, remember that distinct styles exist and existed all over the world. European Knights studied several forms of martial arts, Filipino Escrima teaches advanced club-fighting, and Zulu warriors were rightly feared for their spear techniques. Japanese Kyudo, a favorite advanced martial art of the royal court, focuses solely on one particular style of longbow. Even just considering unarmed styles, you have Greek Wrestling, French Savate, Brazilian Capoeira, and Malaysian Pentjak-Silat. In other words, players have many different styles and themes to play around with.

GM's need to consider how they want to allow players to purchase abilities. Should they replace the normal Combat Enhancements? While good for a game of high-stakes martial-arts action, with many competing schools (of which players might well master several apiece), it is somewhat too restrictive for normal play.

[Martial Art], the Skill

In standard d20, Martial Arts is a class skill for the Barbarian, Bard, Fighter, Monk, Rogue, Ranger, and Paladin. The Fighter should receive an extra skill point per level for learning Martial Arts. Monks already have a good number of skill points, and receive many abilities free, so do not gain any extra skill points. For all other classes, this remains a cross-class skill. In normal d20, the student must have Improved Unarmed Strike, Weapon Focus, or Weapon Finesse, depending on the style, to take the skill. Naturally enough, weapons-based styles default to using the weapon while unarmed styles default to unarmed strikes.



Characters receive a basic technique at skill level 1, and obtain a new ability every odd skill level thereafter. At even-numbered skill levels they may come up with an impressive name for one of their techniques. The “Seven Thunders Kick” is much more impressive than “I use the Kwan style and boot him.” Martial arts do not stack; only one applies at a time, although characters may change their applicable martial arts package, if they have more than one, as a Free Action on their turn.

Martial Arts skills start off with no key ability score, but may get one after a few generations of development. Arts with a history in the campaign, and masters to teach them, have an innate advantage over off-the-cuff player creations.

Skill level does not have to represent character level, and in some martial-arts-based games, it might well be a good idea to ignore character level limits for martial arts skills. These are considered extraordinary abilities, assuming it ever becomes important. While martial arts have a theoretical upper limit of skill level 55 - where the allowable number of techniques maxes out - we recommend capping them somewhere in the 20's.

Basic Abilities

All apply only when using the form's default weapon (whether that's armed or unarmed) or when using a weapon kata. Each ability may be taken up to four times.

Attack	You get a +1 bonus on rolls to Attack, Throw, Grapple, and Trip opponents.
Defenses	You gain +1 bonus to AC when you are un- or lightly armored.
Power	Increase your unarmed damage by +1 or increase your weapon die type by 1 step, up to a d12 maximum. Weapons that cause multiple dice of damage increase them independently.
Strike	You may deal lethal or nonlethal damage at will without penalty. Your base damage is at least 1d4. This may only be taken once.
Synergy	You gain +2 on any related skill. Each time this is taken it applies to a different skill. Common synergies include Tumble, Heal, and Move Silently, but others are possible.
Toughness	You gain DR 1/-. This stacks with itself.



Advanced Techniques

GM's don't have to use advanced techniques. If you do allow them, characters may start taking them at skill level 7, in lieu of basic techniques. Characters may only take four of the following abilities in total.

- **Battlecry.** You may unnerve your opponents. You may use this power once per encounter with a group of enemies. It affects all opponents with 30' and forces them to make a Will saving throw at DC 10 +(Con Mod) or become shaken for 1d6 rounds. This Standard Action does not affect creatures that are higher level than you, non-sentient, deaf, or immune to fear.

- **Blinding Strike.** You may attempt to partially blind or otherwise disorient an opponent on a critical hit. The effect, whether ringing ears, blood in the eyes, or vertigo from a head wound, persists for 2d4 rounds. It imposes a 20% spell failure chance and a -2 circumstance penalty on attack rolls, AC, and saving throws. It does not affect opponents immune to critical hits or who are two size categories or more larger than you, or who make a Fort save at DC 15 +(Str Mod). The critical hit deals damage as normal.

- **Breaking.** When attempting to destroy objects, you may add your Martial Arts skill to the Strength check.

- **Crippling.** On a critical hit, you may opt to deal 1d4 temporary attribute damage rather than inflict extra injury. Select Dexterity, Strength, or Constitution when you gain this ability (it may be gained multiple times but only once per attribute). It does not affect opponents two or more size categories larger than you.

- **Instant Stand.** You may stand up as a Free Action if unarmored or in light armor.

- **Mighty Blow.** On a critical hit, you automatically trip your opponent.

- **Mind Like Moon.** You reflexively come on guard when attacked. With a DC 15 Reflex save, you avoid being surprised or flat-footed at the beginning of combat.

- **Prone Combat.** You take no penalties and opponents gain no bonuses when you lie on the ground.

- **Reach.** You add 5' to your Reach in combat. This usually represents lunging and darting in and out, but could be a mystical ability.

- **Sneak Attack.** Add +1d6, as per a Rogue's ability (unlike many point-buy abilities, this does not affect creatures immune to critical hits). This may be taken more than once, up to a maximum of +4d6.

- **Versatility.** You may change your damage with the specified martial arts weapon or unarmed attacks from lethal to subdual without penalty, and between bludgeoning, slashing, and piercing.

- **Weapon Kata.** The user may employ his or her martial art with a particular weapon (e.g., “Longswords”). This isn't relevant for dedicated weapon forms (e.g., those based on Weapon Finesse rather than Improved Unarmed Strike), although an “Unarmed Kata” might exist in an advanced weapon form.

Master and Occult Martial Arts Techniques

Master Techniques work like Advanced Techniques. These simply present odd feat-like abilities which are normally generic, but can only be used when the art is. Use the list of normal d20 feats for Master techniques. Include the following: Blind-Fight, Combat Reflexes, Deflect Arrows, Dodge, Expertise, Improved Bull Rush, Improved Disarm and Improved Trip, Mobility, Quick Draw, Rapid Shot, Sunder, and Whirlwind Attack. The character need not meet any feat prerequisites. These cannot be obtained until skill level 7, and an art may not contain a total of more than four Advanced and Master abilities.

Occult Techniques draw upon the user's life energy to surpass the limits of ordinary physical skill. They're extraordinary abilities that drain Con points to use (the cost for each is listed after its name). A martial art may include up to four such abilities, starting at skill level 11.

- **Focused Blow** (-2 Con). You may combine all your attacks against a single target into a single mighty blow made with your highest attack bonus. For example, if you normally attacked at +12/+7/+2, a focused blow would cause triple damage at +12.

Healing Hand (-3 Con). Your touch does any one of the following:

- (1) Cures 3d6 damage.
- (2) Cures 2 points of temporary attribute damage.
- (3) Provides a +8 bonus on a save versus a disease or toxin. The target gets an additional save if you use this.

- **Inner Strength**. You gain six phantom Con points with which to power your Occult Techniques. These do not add to your hit points. This can be taken twice. Phantom points regenerate like normal Con points.

- **Iron Skin** (-2 Con). You gain +4 natural armor for 1d6 minutes. This is fully effective against ghosts or other intangible creatures, and allows you to make physical contact with such entities.

- **Ki Block** (-2 Con). You may make a DC 20 Reflex check to block or dodge a single successful melee attack OR may make a second save (DC 15) against any attack which normally allows a Reflex save. If either save succeeds the effect is normal for a successful save. If both do the effect is entirely negated.

- **Ki Focus** (-1 Con). You may grant yourself a +4 Sacred or Profane (choose when this ability is taken) bonus on the effective value of a skill or attribute for 1d6 minutes.

- **Light Foot** (-2 Con). You gain +20' movement and takes half damage from falls for 1d6 minutes. You may expend a single Con point at any time to power an incredible leap (+30 bonus) or a very brief run across an unsuitable surface (such as water or grease).

- **One Finger** (-1 Con). You may launch a single melee attack at a range of up to 60'. It remains a melee attack

but is treated as force damage. When using a weapon form, your weapon either returns or is merely the focus for your attack; you don't have to go and get it back.

- **Overburden** (-3 Con). This allows you to render one enemy you hit unconscious this round unless he or she makes a Will save at DC 10 +(Wis Mod).

- **Paralyze** (-2 Con). This allows you to paralyze any one enemy you hit this round for 1d6 minutes unless he or she makes a Fortitude save at DC 10 +(Wis Mod).

- **Resist Pain** (-2 Con). You gain Damage Reduction 4/- and the ability to remain conscious and functioning up until the point of actual death, for 1d6 minutes. Any effect that relies on pain or Stun effects fail against you this period. This stacks with the basic Toughness ability.

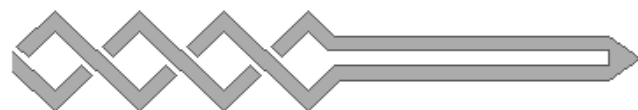
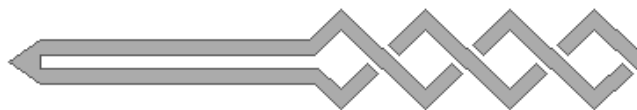
- **Serpent Strike** (-3 Con). Serpent Strike allows you to create dangerous imbalances in opponents' life essences. This allows you to deal 2d4 attribute damage to any one attribute with one attack this round. If the target fails his or her Fort save at DC 10 +(Wis Mod).

- **Touch Strike** (-1 Con). One attack you make this round is a touch attack.

- **Vanishing** (-4 Con). You may use a momentary burst of incredible speed, taking an instant one-round Move Action as if you had cast a Timestop spell.

- **Wrath** (-2 Con). Your martial blows inflict energy damage, rather than physical damage, for 3d6 rounds. You must select an energy form when taking this technique. You also gain resistance 12 to that energy type for the duration.





Sample Martial Arts Skills

The sample listings include the techniques taught by the form. Outside of the level-based restrictions on technique types the abilities can be taken in any order; different masters stress different techniques. The sample listings each offer 12-15 techniques, sufficient for skill level 23-29, regardless of how you get there. If you progress beyond that point, you'll just have to decide what other techniques fit in.

Adamantine Fist (Str)

This brutal unarmed path does one thing only: hit hard. It's not very subtle, but masters can shatter city gates into splinters. Attacks against flesh are equally vicious. If they're available, bonus techniques are based on Strength. While mildly fantastic, it works well in most settings.

Requires: Improved Unarmed Strike or equivalent point buy

Basic Techniques: Strike, Power 4 (1d12 unarmed damage), and Toughness 1

Advanced Techniques: Breaking, Mighty Blow, and Master Technique: Sunder

Occult Techniques: Inner Strength, Ki Focus (Str), Focused Blow, and Overburden

Arctic Fire Kung Fu (Dex)

This fantastic form allows its users to summon up an aura of flame or to suck the heat away from an opponent, freezing them into a block of ice. While power-intensive, it can be very useful against foes resistant to normal attacks.

Requires: Improved Unarmed Strike or equivalent point buy. Variants built around using a sword, with an "unarmed kata" available later, may also be permitted.

Basic Techniques: Strike, Power 4 (1d12 unarmed, 1d12+2 with longsword weapon kata) and Defenses 3

Advanced Techniques: Instant Stand, Mighty Blow Weapon Kata (Longsword) and Reach

Occult Techniques: Inner Strength, Wrath (fire damage) and Paralyze (freezing cold entraps opponents in ice)

Crane Style Kung Fu (Str)

A classical martial art, focusing on evasion and on fast powerful strikes. Sadly, since this is a realistic style, even advanced users may not employ the "running on water" trick normally available through the Light Foot technique. They can fight on poles and other unstable surfaces without penalty however.

Requires: Improved Unarmed Strike or equivalent point buy

Basic Techniques: Strike, Power 3 (1d10 unarmed damage), Defenses 3, Synergy (Balance), and Toughness 1

Advanced Techniques: Blinding Strike, Breaking, Crippling (Dexterity) and Master Technique: Improved Trip

Occult Techniques: Focused Strike and Light Foot

Wind Dance (Dex)

Balanced and graceful, practitioners of the mystical Wind Dance gain a balanced style with strong reflexive techniques. Masters can even summon the power of the gales of the northern wastes to strike at their enemies.

Requires: Improved Unarmed Strike or equivalent point buy

Basic Techniques: Defenses 4, Strike 1, Power 1, and Synergy (Tumble)

Advanced Techniques: Mind Like Moon, Instant Stand, Master Technique: Whirlwind Strike, and Master Technique: Deflect Arrows

Occult Techniques: Inner Strength, Healing Hand, Vanishing, and Light Foot

The Plague Winds school teaches Serpent Strike (Con) and Touch Strike instead of Healing Hand and Lightfoot.

Cloak Mastery (Wis)

Swiftly moving silken cloth can be as rigid as steel and has edges just as sharp. The swirling cloak of a master of this art is as dangerous as any sword. It's favored by elegant assassins, courtiers, and martial arts masters who like to show off.

Requires: Weapon Finesse (Cloak) or equivalent point buy

Basic Techniques: Strike, Power 2 (1d8 damage with cloak), and Defenses 4

Advanced Techniques: Sneak Attack 2, Deflect Arrows, and Reach

Occult Techniques: Vanishing, Focused Blow, and Iron Skin

OK. This is silly. But don't you now want to play a lethally (but fashionably) dressed martial arts master? +3 Vorpal cloak, anyone?

Oaken Storm (Dex)

This realistic staff art focuses on smacking anyone and everyone hostile within reach as quickly as possible while blocking their attacks. A master, whirling his or her staff at near-invisible speeds, can often deal with a considerable number of lesser opponents.

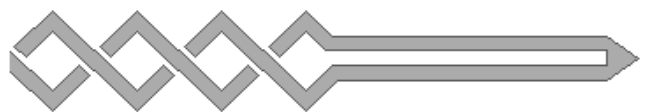
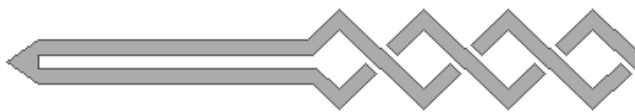
Requires: Weapon Focus: Staff or equivalent point buy

Basic Techniques: Attack 4, Defenses 4, Power 1, and Toughness 2

Advanced Techniques: Mighty Blow, Reach, Master Technique: Deflect Arrows, and Master Technique: Whirlwind Strike

Occult Techniques: Ki Block





Phantom Blade (Dex)

While the common techniques of the Phantom Blade style are conventional enough, its secret techniques use the sword as a mere focus to channel *ki* energy.

Requires: Weapon Focus: Sword (any single type) or equivalent point buy

Basic Techniques: Attack 2, Power 2, Strike, and Toughness 2

Advanced Techniques: Breaking, Reach, Master Technique: Combat Reflexes, and Master Technique: Sunder

Occult Techniques: Focused Blow, One Finger, Touch Strike, and Inner Strength

Gungnir's Flight Kung Fu (Con)

This straightforward art revolves around charging into battle and spearing things. Barbarians (and other people without patience) favor it.

Requires: Weapon Focus (Spear) or equivalent point buy

Basic Techniques: Attack 4, Toughness 4, Synergy: Survival

Advanced Techniques: Battlecry, Mighty Blow, Master Technique: Mobility, and Master Technique: Rapid Shot

Occult Techniques: Ki Focus and Resist Pain

Blood Blade Technique (Dex)

This outlawed assassin's art allows an assailant to strike in an instant, inflict potentially-lethal injuries, and vanish as swiftly as he or she appeared.

Requires: Weapon Finesse (Dagger) or equivalent point buy

Basic Techniques: Attack 3, Synergy 3 (Disguise, Move Silently, and Hide)

Advanced Techniques: Sneak Attack 3 (+3d6), and Master Technique: Quick Draw

Occult Techniques: Serpent Strike (Con), Light Foot, Vanishing, and Ki Focus

Ghost Busting Technique (Chr)

This mystical path is designed for hands-on exorcism via grabbing evil spirits and punching them out. This is usually considered either very brave or very stupid.

Requires: Improved Unarmed Strike or equivalent point buy

Basic Techniques: Attack 2, Strike, Power 3, and Synergy 2 (Knowledge: Religion, Knowledge: The Planes)

Advanced Techniques: Breaking, Instant Stand, Reach, and Whirlwind Attack

Occult Techniques: Inner Strength, Iron Skin, Ki Focus, and Wrath (Positive Energy: The "resistance" translates into reducing attribute drains and damage from negative energy by 4, reducing level drains by 2, and a +6 on saves versus undead powers)

Mystic Artist

Great art always had the power to instill emotion, to inspire, to convey messages beyond the rational, and to touch the soul. Paintings, literature, architecture, and music have had an impact on history as mighty, if more subtle, as any king or general. Can you stand within a great cathedral or view the art of Michelangelo and not feel the strength and grandeur of the artist's vision?

In d20, the "power of art" is a bit more literal.

Mystic Artists inspire or manipulate others through their art. The exact type is irrelevant. Perform abilities, like Music, Dance, and Storytelling, static media skills like Craft: Painting and Sculpture, and even Knowledge: Architecture all work. Most adventurers prefer quick and portable performance arts, but those who choose permanent arts wield a subtle and terrible power. All mystic artist skills have a basic ability (listed below), which is important in setting save DC.

Regardless of the skill used, the character gains one of the Basic Abilities at skill levels 3, 4, 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 18, 21, 24, 30, 36, 48 and 60. Abilities from any group must be taken in order (the user may skip one and only one ability from each sequence) and have a minimum skill level to use, as shown with each ability.

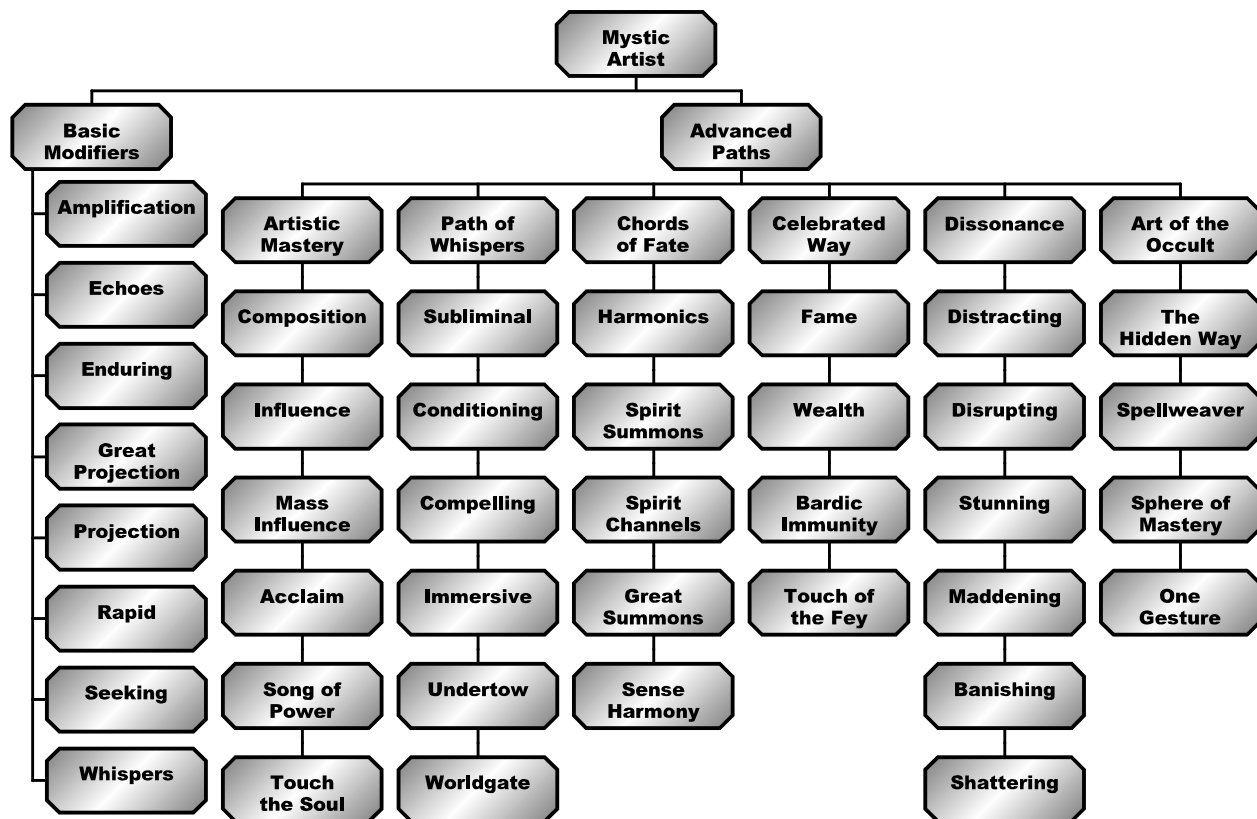
Once purchased, Mystic Art can usually be employed once per level per day and permits saves at DC (10 + relevant Attribute Modifier + half the ability skill level). The attribute modifier used depends on the type of art involved; vocal and physical performances normally use (Cha Mod), pure instrumental skills, sculpture, and hands-on crafts use (Dex Mod), design skills such as architecture use (Int Mod), and composition (literary or musical) uses (Wis Mod).

Using Mystic Artist powers is a Standard Action.

The range varies. Targets must be close enough to perceive details (musical or physical) in the work in question.

Characters using static media may activate their power once per day per character level if the art is mobile. (If a character can handily pick it up and move it, it's mobile.) Immobile art, such as large statues and buildings, is always active and affects all valid targets inside or within range outside.

All Mystic Artist abilities derived from Performance require at least one round of exposure to take effect; static media and architecture require two. No matter how many different mystic artist skills a character has, only count the highest for the purposes of getting Basic Abilities unless the character buys the Mystic Artist feat again specifically for use with another skill.



Basic Abilities

Each basic ability has a number in parentheses. This is the minimum skill you must have to acquire that particular ability. Only a character's basic rank, attribute

bonus, racial bonuses, inherent bonuses, and feats apply to meeting this requirement. Those that target creatures are mind-affecting abilities. By default the effects of performance arts last for the duration of the performance and five rounds thereafter. The effects of static arts last for up to an hour after the target leaves the affected area.



I don't play, actually. I just strike inspiring poses.

Inspiration Abilities

- **Emotion** (Skill 3). You can make everyone in the area feel any strong emotion you care to evoke for up to five rounds after you cease to perform or after they leave the area of your art. In combat you may target either allies or enemies, providing/inflicting a morale bonus/penalty of up to $(1 + \text{Skill Rank}/6)$ on saves against mind-affecting powers and on attacks and damage. Out of combat this is most useful for manipulating crowds or setting the mood for negotiations, oratory, and diplomacy.
- **Competence** (Skill 6). Competence is more like it. Now you can give someone a +2 morale bonus to any skill check, attack roll, saving throw, or AC while you use your art, albeit only one of these at a time. It only affects one character.
- **Greatness** (Skill 9). The lucky target(s) of Greatness becomes inspired to new heights. Up to $(\text{Level}/3)$ targets gain a +1 Positive Level bonus and 1d10 temporary hit points.
- **Excellence** (Skill 12). Excellence grants the target two +4 morale bonuses which can be applied to an attribute, to all their saves, to their armor class, to their attacks, or to the damage they inflict in melee combat.



- Mass Greatness (Skill 15). This works as per Greatness, except it affects (Cha Mod + Level) targets.
- Mass Excellence (Skill 18). This works as per Excellence, except it affects (artist's level/2 + Cha Mod) targets.
- (Skill 24). [No ability; this does not count towards the skipping limit.]
- Heroism (Skill 30). A target of Heroism becomes inspired to, well, heroism. The target gains a +2 Positive Level bonus.
- Mass Heroism (Skill 36). This works as per Heroism, except it affects (level/2) +(Cha Mod) targets.
- Double (Skill 48). This doubles the power of any ongoing lesser artist ability the character possesses, even non-Inspiration ones. It doubles any one numerical component, not including the save DC.

Positive Levels

A Positive Level adds +1 to the user's BAB, saving throws, and AC, and adds 6 CP to the character, which he or she may spend on any desired feats or upgrades. With Mystic Artist, the artist selects the effects of the 6 CP ahead of time and it must be the same for each character affected. Positive Levels applied to Undead work like a level drain against a normal character.

Manipulation Abilities

- Fascinate (Skill 3). People like your art. It's fascinating and mysterious and you can even interest the audience in whatever kind of art you do. Some of them might even take it up themselves. More usefully to adventurers, a Mystic Artist can Fascinate up to (Cha Mod + Level/3) targets. If they fail to save, they remain fascinated for up to (Att Mod + 2) minutes, or until a performance ends, whichever comes first.

Mystic Artists with a perform skill of 6 or more may attempt to use a *Suggestion* effect on any one Fascinated target once per round. Those with a skill of 24+ may attempt to *Suggest* something to all Fascinated targets at the same time.

- Hold Audience (Skill 6). Hold Audience allows you to keep the audience busy, and while away their time without them realizing it. Any who fail their saving throw become enchanted by your performance or art, and spend more time than they expected. Aside from its usefulness for tavern owners (whose patrons mysteriously spend more time drinking), it's a great distraction.

With sufficient attribute and DC enhancements a mystic artist with this ability could hold an entire army spellbound for hours - or even days.

- Suggestion (Skill 9). With this ability, you may make a *Suggestion* (as per the spell) to one target. Unlike the *Fascination*-based ability, the art used may be as simple as whistling a snatch of birdsong.
- Emotional Auras (Skill 12). Your art may create drastic emotional effects, inducing Friendship (as per

Charm), *Terror*, *Malaise* or *Grief* (as per *Exhausted*) in foes within range.

- Freedom (Skill 15). You can use your art to create an effect equivalent to the *Break Enchantment* spell (Caster Level equals your level). This ability functions on a single target within 30 feet or on anyone in a particular spot for static works. You can use *Freedom* on yourself, but obviously may not be able to do this if you're already magically ensnared.

- (Skill 18). [No ability; this does not count towards the skipping limit.]

- Mass Suggestion (Skill 24). This works as per the *Suggestion* ability, but affects (artist's level/2 + Cha Mod) targets. Unlike the *Fascination*-based ability, the art used may be as simple as whistling a few notes.

- Greater Summoning (Skill 30). You may attempt to call a creature to you from a known location anywhere within one mile per level on the plane you currently occupy. The affected creature travels normally to reach you and you must continue to use your art for the duration of the trip. The creature is free to dress and bring along minions if he, she, or it so desires. As a static effect this can be used to bind a creature to a location.

Alternatively, you may create a general summons, calling any creatures of a specific (and non-immune) type within several miles. These creatures won't be initially hostile, and may be negotiated with. One could, for example, call "animals" in general or opt to merely call "elephants and mammoths". The affected creatures will be drawn to the location of the art, but travel normally to get there.

- Alter Attitudes (Skill 36). Targets exposed to this art who fail their Will save adjust one attitude, belief, or opinion to match or fit with the mystic artist's desires. The effect lasts for one week. This does not change alignments.

- Puppet Master (Skill 48). Target up to (Level/3 + Cha Mod) individuals. Any target that fails to save comes under your control, and may be directed to any non-suicidal action.

Synergy Abilities

- Block (Skill 3). A mystic artist can use his or her art to counter magical effects that depend on related abilities. Music can block sonic effects (but not those that merely use incantation). Painting can block effects relying on light, shadow, or gaze attacks. Sculpture and architecture can block effects like *Turn to Stone*, *Mud to Rock*, *Rock to Mud*, *Move Earth*, *Wall of Stone* and so on.

The artist simply makes his or her skill roll as normal. All characters in a 30' radius may use that check in place of their saving throw before or after rolling. Effects which do not grant saving throws force their caster to make a Caster Level check instead, if the artist wins the ability fails within the affected area. This ability takes effect immediately, even without the *Rapid Song* feat. Creatures already affected by affected powers treat the perform check as a new saving throw each round.

Performance-dependent blocks normally last for 3d6 + (relevant Att Mod) rounds. Static media create permanent blocks.

- **Group Focus** (Skill 6). With group focus, a character may use his or her artist skill roll in place of a Concentration check for any other character, or increase the value of Aid Another actions by +2.
- **Amplify** (Skill 9). A mystic artist using this ability can add to magical abilities used nearby. All friendly spellcasters within a 30' radius receive a +2 Caster Level bonus on all magical techniques.
- **Harmonize** (Skill 12). Harmonize allows you to select two Mystic Artist powers and combine them into one. Normally you can only use one at a time.
- **Serenity** (Skill 18). This tune spreads an aura of rest and relaxation. Usable only once a week, it counts as a night's rest and refreshes uses-per-day abilities.
- **Rule the Horde** (Skill 24). Any target that notices your art within 30' of you must make a Will save or be forcibly made non-hostile. The targets are also subject to a *Suggestion* effect chosen by the mystic artist.
- **Concerto** (Skill 30). Concerto focuses the power of occultists, allowing them to accomplish more than they could alone. Up to four magic-users with compatible styles (arcane, divine, psionic) and similar levels (each must have a casting level at least two-thirds that of the primary caster) may assist another occultist in weaving a spell. The woven spell may be up to (number of aides/2) levels higher than primary caster could normally manage and gains a (number of assistants+1) Caster Level bonus. The group must collectively contribute the necessary spell levels during casting, but they may arrange that however they please and need not know the spell chosen.
- **Carrier** (Skill 36). Carrier expands single-target artist, magical, or psychic effects, including personal ones, into a 30' radius effect.
- **Dance of the Trees** (Skill 48). This ability grants the amazing power to affect inanimate objects with art. Objects are affected as if by the *Animate Object* spell cast at the user's level and the user may apply any one other basic ability to it or them - even though constructs would normally be immune to such effects. Static media create permanent animations, although they may not leave the area of effect. Of course, if you animate the art itself it doesn't need to.

Classical Bards

The classical Bard normally takes nine abilities and is entitled to ten. Of course, they'll have to take either Hold Audience or Emotional Auras as well; otherwise they'll skip too many Manipulation slots. The standard list includes:

Inspiration I (Emotion), II (Competence), III (Greatness), IV (Excellence), and VI (Mass Excellence)

Manipulation I (Fascinate), III (Suggestion), and V (Freedom).

Synergy I (Block).

Basic Ability Modifiers

Once acquired, these apply to all of the character's mystic artist abilities.

- **Amplification** (+6 CP). Your art may affect twice the usual number of targets. Add +6 CP per additional +1 multiple.
- **Echoes** (+6 CP). Your art takes effect again and again, either lingering after the performance or if the target(s) are reminded of it. You may add three minutes to the normal duration of your art's effects, either using that extra time after the effect would normally expire to extend it or it to take effect up to three times when the target(s) are reminded of your art* during the next two weeks, expending one minute of the duration each time.

For example, a mighty orator might give his or her men an inspiring speech the day before a battle, using Mass Greatness. He or she will be able to remind them of that speech (perhaps by shouting a phrase from it as a battle-cry) and inspire them for a minute up to three times during the ensuing two weeks.

**Echoes only works on creatures with memories that can be reminded of your art. It generally doesn't work on inanimate objects, although there have been reports that it does work with Dance of the Trees.*

- **Enduring** (+3/6/9/12 CP). The effects of your art persist 2x/3x/5x/10x as long as usual after the exposure.
- **Great Projection** (+6 CP). You may project the sensory aspects of your art to a new point of origin within one mile. While this is basically an illusion, it still carries the full impact of the art.

For example, a singer could project his or her voice to roam sourcelessly through the halls of a castle, while a sculptor could keep his or her work on display and safely in a vault at the same time.

- **Projection** (+6 CP). Your art may affect people at twice the usual range. +3 CP per additional +1 multiple.
- **Rapid** (6 CP). Your art takes effect immediately, without the usual round of work. This isn't usually worth bothering with for static art, but performance artists may find it very handy.
- **Seeking** (+6 CP). You may limit the effects of a given performance or piece of art to particular targets. If you wish, it will be undetectable to others.

For example, a mystic harper could play a song of summoning that no one except the target could hear or use Shattering to selectively destroy weapons in an area. An architect could design a building which only affected creatures of a chosen species.

- **Whispers** (6 CP). The exact source of your effects is difficult to determine without special senses related to sound or sight (as appropriate for your art). While not as useful for musicians (even without confirmation, it's often obvious what's being done) this can be a great help to architects or sculptors.

Modifying abilities such as Bonus Uses, Skill Focus, Skill Emphasis, Reflex Action, and Ability Focus may also be of use to Mystic Artists.

Enhanced Abilities

These abilities add new capabilities to a Mystic Artist and offer specialists whole new paths of power.

The Path of Artistic Mastery

Composition (+6 CP, requires skill rank 10 in your mystic artist skill). Your art may affect groups which do not directly experience it. Reproductions and images of your art carry half the power of the original. Unfortunately, lesser performance artists must spend a skill point to commit your composition to memory if they wish to take advantage of it.

The power of a composition does fade eventually; once it becomes a commonly-known part of the culture (or everyone in the party is thoroughly familiar with it) it will lose its special power.

Influence (+6 CP, requires *Composition*). You may shift the beliefs and attitudes of your audience on a semi-permanent basis. For example, you can foster acceptance of another race, clear up general misunderstandings about a religion, or raise support for a rebellion against a corrupt government. On the other hand, you can also spread slander, confuse issues, and make the population accepting of ill governance. Your targets will gain the benefits, or suffer the penalties, of a one-step shift in reaction rolls throughout the region. The modifier will remain in force until it's again changed, whether by another mystic artist, by public actions and explanations, or by some other means.

Mass Influence (+6 CP, requires *Influence*). Your art may permeate a city or culture, manipulating entire populations as per *Influence*, above.

Acclaim (+6 CP, requires *Mass Influence*). Your art may focus the combined magic of your audience into various effects. In general:

1) The effect always involves the entire assembly, although the artist may exempt him- or her- self.

2) The audience must number at least 500. Audience members who have participated in a similar performance within the last three months do not count.

3) The effect must be something which the audience wants. Most commonly this means:

- Escape, ranging from simply following the artist along a mysteriously-appearing safe path on through everyone being *Plane Shifted* or *Teleported*.
- Protection, such as a huge *Wall* (or *Sphere*) of *Force*, a *Hallow/Protection from Evil* effect, or simply dousing the fires burning throughout the city.
- Healing, most commonly *Cure Disease* although effects up to *Heal* are possible.

Small audiences occasionally get effects such as Cure Blindness, Heal, and Raise Dead to work on single individuals.

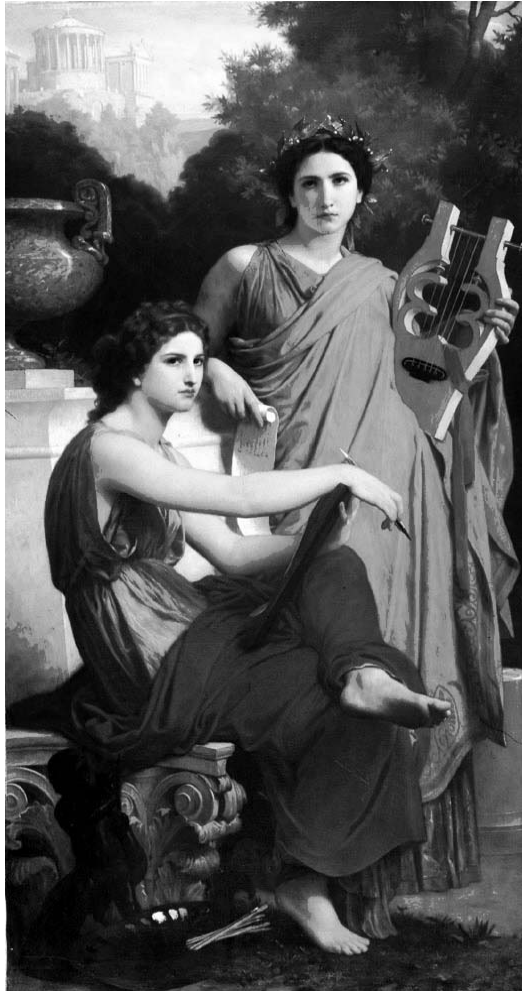
- Environmental changes, such as banishing a drought or hurricane, making plants grow in an icy waste, or simply blessing the flocks and fields. Such changes will usually affect a radius of several miles for 1d6+2 months.
- Summoning something (usually a protector or guide). This usually equates to a *Planar Ally* spell, although no payment is required and non-outsiders are available.
- Destruction, most commonly in the form of blasting the surrounding area with a *Holy Word*, *Unholy Word*, or simple wave of elemental force. This isn't enormously powerful (Caster Level= ½ the performer's Caster Level) and is pretty unusual unless the area is occupied by a hostile force. Most audiences don't want to blow up their homes.

If the audience is simply there for the show and has no purpose in mind, a result check of 20+ grants the artist access to a *Limited Wish*. Artists can save *Limited Wishes* for later use, but they dissipate if

not used within a year, the artist must pay any excess XP cost, and no one artist can save more than (Cha Mod + 1) *Limited Wishes* at a time.

Static media and compositions created with *Acclaim* must have their effects specified at the time of creation.

Song of Power (+6 CP, requires *Acclaim*). You create a work of art with the power to alter reality - once, when it's first shown, played in full, or otherwise displayed. In effect, it's imbued with a single Godfire Point (see page 76 for more information). Song of Power may be taken





once per decade at most and costs the full 6 CP and a month to compose each time.

Touch the Soul (+6 CP, requires *Song of Power*). The power of your arts may touch the world, resonating thru the hearts and souls of every sentient being. You may apply the effects of *Influence* throughout the world. Once per year you may attempt to use *Acclaim* on a global basis, either affecting the entire world or gaining a full *Wish*. Once per millennia you may *Call the Assembly* (page 149).

The Path of Whispers

Subliminal (+6 CP). Targets must make a DC 24 Int check to notice that they are being influenced by your art.

Conditioning (+6 CP, Requires *Subliminal*). Long-term exposure to your art will have deep effects on the mind. Static art normally induces a particular belief, obsession, or compulsion. Performance art allows complete mental reprogramming, altering the victim's attitudes, alignment, and beliefs pretty much as desired as well as instilling compulsions, mental triggers, and split personalities, or wiping memories. Unfortunately, this requires months or years (for higher-level targets) to complete and can be temporarily resisted or overridden with Will Saves.

Compelling (+6 CP, Requires *Subliminal*). Your art forces those exposed to it to behave in some fashion, ranging from joining a festival to starting a bloodbath. The user may provide a general direction, such as "Riot!" or "Dance!", but the details are up to the individuals affected.

Immersive (+6 CP, Requires *Compelling*). Your arts can convey memories and/or experiences to those exposed. This can be used simply to let people experience tales and myths or as an adjunct to other art to add meaning and depth, but it can also be used to grant those exposed XP equal to the skill check used up to a maximum of once per week and a lifetime limit of 3000 XP for any given target.

Undertow (+6 CP, Requires *Immersive*). Your art shifts reality, altering the nature of the setting within its compass - for example, from Horror to Comedy or from a City setting to a Wild Jungle. The behavior of objects, creatures, and the world itself are all transformed. This does not affect the underlying reality; it does affect what conventions and implicit rules people follow. Fantasy dwellers suddenly within a Western theme would still use magic swords and *Fireball* spells, but would start settling disputes with duels in front of the saloon at high noon.

Worldgate (+6 CP, Requires *Undertow*). You may carry those affected by your art into another realm, essentially plane-shifting them into a world you describe. While fine details are beyond your control, you can carry a group into a historical setting, a myth, or a popular tale. Those affected are generally given a general role to work with but are not obligated to follow the plot. The artist may accompany the group affected, but need not do so. Once the plot is complete or utterly disfigured beyond all recognition, they all are released back home again. Characters with their own dimension-hopping abilities can escape at any time.

The Chords of Fate

Harmonics (+6 CP). Your art affects beings of some type which are normally immune, such as the Undead. This may be taken repeatedly, each time adding a new type of normally-immune creature to affect.

Spirit Summons (+6 CP, Requires *Harmonics*). You may add your art skill to your Diplomacy skill check when attempting to negotiate with, or obtain favors from, any entity you can affect. Your art will also tend to draw out the creatures you're targeting if they're in the area. You could thus play in the forest to try and get a favor from the fey, for a dragon, or even at the gates of the Abyss. (Hopefully, your artistic and diplomacy skills are both *very high*).

Spirit Channels (+6 CP, Requires *Spirit Summons*). You may create artistic works which can store one use of a spell, spell-like, or supernatural ability supplied by the artist or by some other, willing, entity. In the case of performance arts, the ability will be unleashed the next time the artist performs that piece (it's best to use minor variants for this to avoid accidentally triggering the ability). The user may store a maximum of (Wis Mod + 1, 1 minimum) such effects at any one time.

The Great Summons (+6 CP, Requires *Spirit Channels*). Your art transcends the barriers between dimensions, allowing the artist to affect any or all coexistent planes at his or her option. If this is combined with Greater Summoning (Manipulation 30), Great Projection, or some other long-range technique the effect may be projected to a desired target on any plane.

Yes, you can try to call or manipulate gods, powerful demons, and similar creatures. Even if you get it to work it probably isn't a good idea. Still, who knows? They might find it amusing.

Sense Harmony (+6 CP, Requires *The Great Summons*). With Sense Harmony, the character notices awesome occult disturbances of the cosmos (i.e., changes in trans-planar wars or the birth of a new deity), in both this and higher realms.





The Celebrated Way

Fame (6 CP). Fame grants you fame, naturally enough. With this, you're a celebrity, are recognized as a great artist in your own lifetime, get invited to all the best parties, have many close friends you've never met, and may often obtain safe passage into restricted areas to show off your art. Fans constantly ask for autographs or whatever passes as the local equivalent.

Wealth (+6 CP, Requires *Fame*). You are supported by your patrons, and may ignore normal monetary needs. You are considered to have an excellent lifestyle and can readily obtain fine food, housing, clothing, servants, and vehicles in any civilized area. You can even tow along your freeloading friends.

Bardic Immunity (+6 CP, Requires *Wealth*). Like many celebrities you can get away with outrageous behavior. You may escape moderate legal troubles, dress, act, and speak in wildly obnoxious ways, and commit huge social faux pas without long-term repercussions. A character with Bardic Immunity can easily get away with wearing the wrong clothes or carrying a bunch of magic weapons to a noble's dinner party. The character could not attack people safely, however - at least not with lethal weapons. Occasionally punching critics is virtually expected.

Touch of the Fey (+6 CP, Requires *Bardic Immunity*). Major mystical beings will commission the character's services for bizarre rewards. This feat is limited only by the strange artifacts, weird powers and problems, or extra-dimensional materials the GM wishes to saddle the character with.

Hint: Don't take this feat unless you are very certain of your character's abilities. You do not want to have your latest symphony flop at a dinner party hosted by the Lords of Chaos.

The Path of Dissonance

Note that Dissonance-based effects never affect the artist. For +6 CP the character may learn to selectively target dissonance-based effects against up to (Cha Mod + Level/3) specific targets within range. Otherwise they're either single-target or affect the entire area as described. Mystic Artists specializing in Dissonance are rarely popular.

Distracting (+6 CP). Your art is profoundly disturbing. Those exposed have great difficulty focusing, and must make Concentration checks (DC equal to the mystic artist's skill check) to focus on their tasks, including spellcasting. While this normally affects an area, artists may opt to target a specific individual within range.

Disrupting (+6 CP, Requires *Distracting*). Your art can disrupt other effects, or even life (or Unlife) force. You may expend an art attempt to create a *Dispel Magic* or *Dispel Psionics* effect or to inflict (art check result/2) points of damage to all living and/or undead creatures within range save yourself. For an additional +6 CP you may upgrade to *Greater Dispelling* and (art check result) damage.

Stunning (+6 CP, Requires *Disrupting*). Your art overloads the senses. You may expend a use of your art to attempt to Stun all those exposed for 2d4 rounds.

Maddening (+6 CP, Requires *Stunning*). Your art can undermine sanity. Those exposed briefly must resist or become confused, as if affected by the *Confusion* spell, for as long as the art continues plus one round per level of the artist. Long-term exposure (at least ten minutes worth for performance arts, usually hours or days for static arts) requires another save to avoid becoming *Feebleminded* as well.

Banishing (+6 CP, Requires *Maddening*). Your art can drive out various types of spirits and/or creatures, creating effects equivalent to an *Antipathy* or *Dismissal* spell.

Shattering (+6 CP, Requires *Banishing* and minimum skill level 20). Your art is ultimately disruptive, capable of damaging reality directly. You may expend a use of your art to generate the effects of *Circle of Death*, *Undeath to Death*, or *Disjunction*. You may also simply opt to inflict (art check result) damage to any and all inanimate objects within range.



Even the weather hates Angus's disruptive piping.



The Art of the Occult

The Hidden Way (+6 CP). The Hidden Way allows a character to cast a spell simply by creating a piece of art or playing music. This not only drastically increases the Spellcraft check (+10 DC) to determine what is being done, but usually won't be noticed as spellcasting at all!

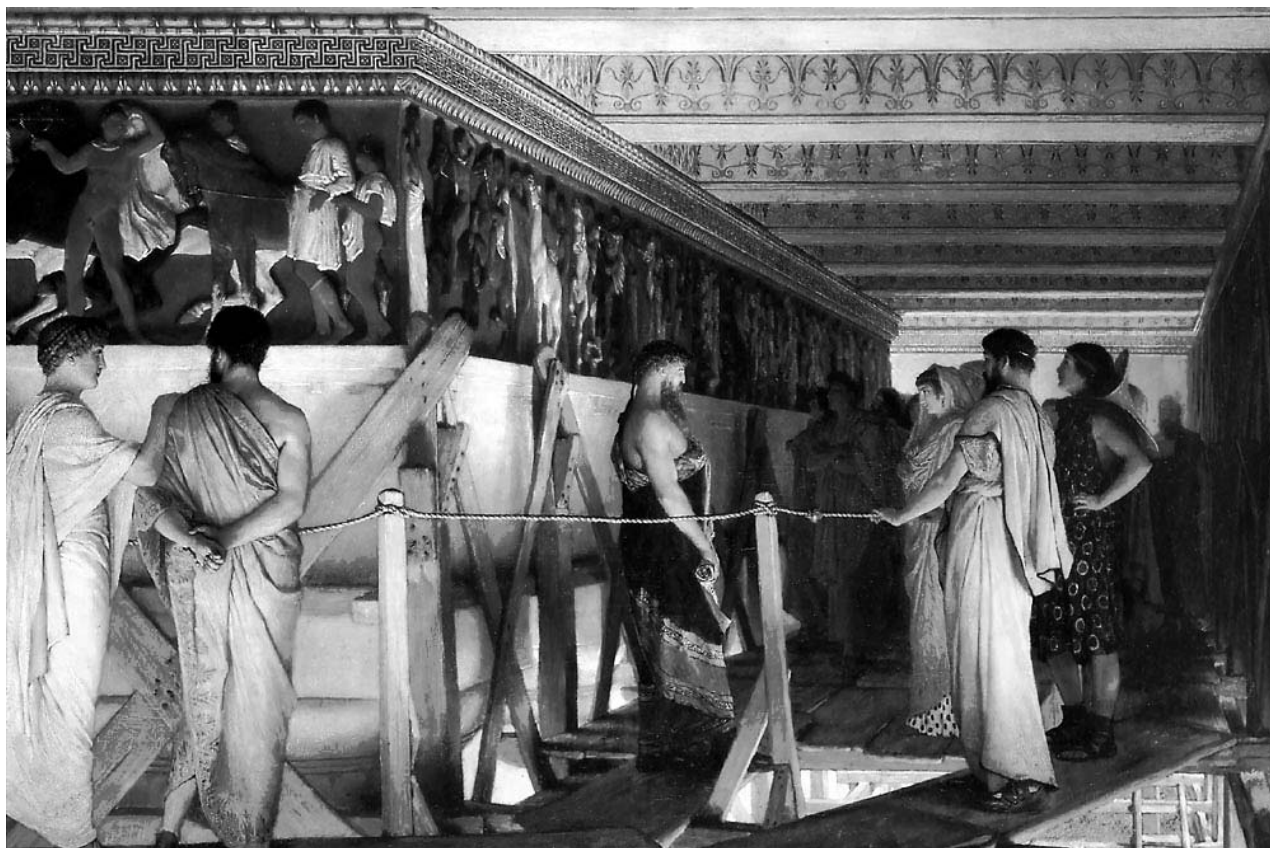
Spellweaver (+6 CP, requires *The Hidden Way*). Every minute you spend using your art in a normal fashion (without invoking any magical effects other than the use of mystic artist to activate this ability) allows you to add +1 spell level's worth of metamagic to a spell you cast immediately after you stop using this ability. You cannot add more spell levels in this manner than you have points of Charisma Bonus, but you need not actually know the metamagic to be added.

Sphere of Mastery (+6 CP, requires *Spellweaver*). Your art carries you out of the world. Performers can still be seen and heard for the duration of their performances, but they and the area immediately about them (a 5 foot radius) exist in a pocket dimension of their own. Nothing can enter that area or interrupt the performance unless it can cross dimensional boundaries

or the artist permits it. Static artworks can be set into their own pocket-realms, although the artist can leave up to (Int Mod +1) routes open to reach them through.

One Gesture (Varies, requires *The Hidden Way*). You can unleash minor, pre-prepared, "art-related" magics with a single gesture, note, etc., as a Move-Equivalent Action once a round. This is simply a version of Power Words (page 39) with Corrupted effects restricting it to a particular theme.

Numerous other special abilities can be created by simply buying the ability and requiring a use of mystic art to invoke it. For example, a harper who wanted to be able to enhance a spellcaster's abilities could buy Mana and Blessing (Specialized: Requires a use of mystic artist to invoke) so as to be able to power other character's magic with art.



The inspiring architecture of the temple would aid the defense of the city for many centuries to come.

The Path of the Dragon

Steeped in ancient mystery, the Dragon Path offers great power to its students. The cost may be equally great. Freed from many of the burdens of mortality, practitioners often come to rely on magic, losing touch with normal life. As their power grows they too grow more distant from mortal concerns. Whether this is transcending or abandoning humanity remains an open question.

Perhaps fortunately, it's almost impossible to master the entire Path of the Dragon; most students stick with one or two sequences of abilities. Nevertheless, the choice is ultimately up to you.

The Path of the Dragon is very flashy and isn't at all mysterious. It's at its best in high-powered, comic-book, or "kick in the door" style campaigns. It probably won't work well in more subtle, grim-and-gritty, or low-level campaigns.

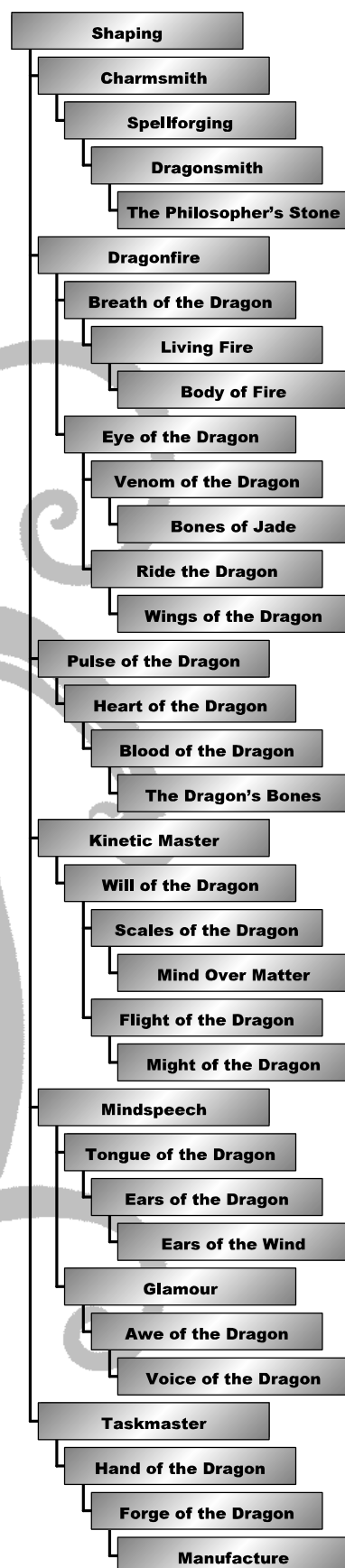
Shaping (6 CP). Shaping is the art of channeling ambient magic into effects. It allows the user to create effects like those produced by *Prestidigitation* at will. The character may not use cumulative effects or grant noticeable bonuses to anyone but may perform an immense variety of minor tricks for comfort, convenience, and amusement. As shown on the chart, learning Shaping is the first step along the dragon path.

The Way of the Artificer

Charmsmith (+6 CP, requires Shaping). Charmsmith allows a character to enchant an item with any specific Shaping effect at a cost of 12.5 GP and 1 XP. Such items include everfitting boots, self-repairing clothing, waterproof cloaks, mood rings, rods of cleaning, self-heating teapots, no-slip grappling hooks which nevertheless come lose with a simple tug, and thousands of other convenient, but unimportant, items. They usually sell for 25-50 GP.

Spellforging (+6 CP, requires Charmsmith). Spellforging allows the user to imbue items with minor magical properties. He or she can make items other than scrolls worth up to 4000 GP. Mundane costs for masterwork items or materials are irrelevant; only the magical costs matter when computing this limit. The user must fulfill any prerequisite requirements other than the usual Create Item abilities.

Spellforgers usually make "Talismans" instead of "Potions," but they work the same way.





Dragonsmith (+6 CP, requires Spellforging). This actually represents any one Create Item ability; a character is automatically considered to have this if he or she already possesses an item creation ability. It's listed here because an item creation feat is required to achieve the next ability.

The Philosopher's Stone (+6 CP, requires Dragonsmith). The magic of the True Philosopher's Stone, long sought after by alchemists and laymen alike, allows the enhancement of the body. With this talent, a student of the Dragon Path bind magical energy into flesh, enchanting living (or unliving) beings as if they were items. Additionally, the character may directly convert experience points to rare metals, gems, and other valuables at a rate of 2 GP per 1 XP.

The Way of Inner Fire

Dragonfire (+6 CP, requires Shaping). Dragonfire enables a character to convert spell levels into flame attacks, shields of energy, and the channeling of raw magical power into other beings or items as a Standard Action. Attacks do 1d6 fire damage/spell level sacrificed to a 30' radius area or 2d6/spell level to a single target.

Shields cancel a total of 4 points of damage per spell level sacrificed; a character may leave a shield up and do other things, but it lasts only 1 round per spell level. Shields may be used on other characters at ranges of up to 120 feet, provided that the user can see them.

Channeling energy into creatures and objects is on a 1-to-1 basis. Characters converting spells for this purpose can only sacrifice one spell, regardless of how many levels it has, per round.

Breath of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Dragonfire). While Dragonfire is normally fire-based, with Breath of the Dragon the character may make it into any energy type he or she knows of other than "divine" or "infernal" energy (unless the character happens to actually be a deity). Holy, Unholy, Lawful, and Chaotic energy forms usually require an appropriate alignment.

Living Fire (+6 CP, requires Breath of the Dragon). With Living Fire, a character may create a Dragonfire construct and use selective targeting effects. A Dragonfire Construct can be treated as a fire elemental or Astral Construct. Simply channel sufficient spell levels using the Dragonfire feat to match a chosen level of *Summon Monster* or *Astral Construct*. While the "fire elementals" are automatons, and hence are immune to mental attacks, they otherwise act just like a normal summoned being.

The user may also selectively target creatures using Dragonfire attacks, so that area effects ignore allies. Aside from combat uses, the character can destroy toxins, diseases and parasites by wielding a Dragonfire blast targeting only the foreign element.

Body of Fire (+6 CP, requires Living Fire). Once the true Fire burns within the body, a character may create a Dragonfire construct (above) and then become one with it, taking on its physical statistics and powers and adding its hit points to his or her own. This also extends the duration to minutes rather than rounds.

Eye of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Dragonfire). With Eye of the Dragon, a character may absorb up to (Int score) incoming spell levels each day. He or she may only store a maximum of (2 x Con score) at any one time, however. Spell levels may be expended on other Dragon Path disciplines or, for +12 CP, to power spells as per a Rod of Absorption. Unlike the Rod, a master of the Eye of the Dragon may absorb any spell which would affect him or her, regardless of whether or not it has an area effect. Eye of the Dragon may be taken up to (Wis Mod+2) times and stacks with itself.

For +3 CP the user may learn to absorb magic from items. Charged items yield 1 spell level/charge drained. Permanent items yield (Caster Level/2) spell levels but are negated for 24 hours.

Spells generally cannot be partially absorbed, but if the Game Master allows this it results in a proportional chance of spell failure. For example, absorbing 2 spell levels from a 7th level spell results in a 2-in-7 chance of failure (in this case use a d8 and reroll 8's).

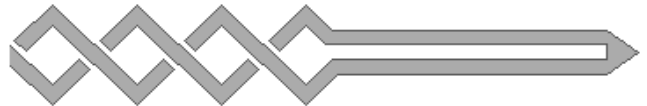
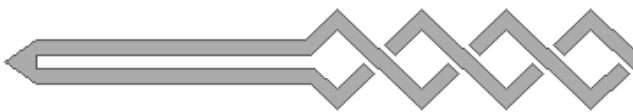
Venom of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Eye of the Dragon). Venom of the Dragon allows a character to store up to (Int score) levels of actual spells thrown at them, which they may release and use as a Standard Action even if they couldn't normally cast those spells. This only applies to "friendly" incoming spells, cast by an ally for the explicit purpose of absorption. Like Eye of the Dragon, Venom of the Dragon may be taken up to (Wis Mod +2) times and stacks with itself. The absorption limit of the Eye of the Dragon.

Bones of Jade (+6 CP, requires Venom of the Dragon). This allows a character's Venom of the Dragon ability to absorb hostile spells as well as friendly ones, allowing the user to "catch" incoming spells and throw them back. The Eye of the Dragon limit still applies.

Ride the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Eye of the Dragon). A character with Ride the Dragon may channel their Dragonfire energy into actual spells. The character may choose 10 spell levels' worth of spells of up to level 4 and channel Dragonfire energy into them as a standard action, casting them as spontaneous spells. Ride the Dragon may be taken up to (Wis Mod +2) times to gain additional spells.

Wings of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Ride the Dragon). The character adds a level 5 or 6 spell to his or her Ride the Dragon spell list. Wings of the Dragon may be taken repeatedly to gain additional spells.





The Way of Hosting the Essence

Pulse of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Shaping). Pulse summons magical energy from the area, but is limited to 1 spell level per round. It grants no ability to store such energy on its own. For another +12 CP the character can summon two spell level's worth of energy, and for +24 more CP (42 total) he or she can summon up three per round. This is the limit of the process; beyond this point the magic begins to discharge at random.

Heart of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Pulse of the Dragon). With Heart of the Dragon, the character may use the Shaping feat for higher-level spells. The basic feat allows the character to use all level 0 spells as desired, although those with cumulative effects, such as *Cure Minor Wounds*, lose potency after 2d6 applications to any one creature in a day. Using cantrips in this manner requires no external magical energy.

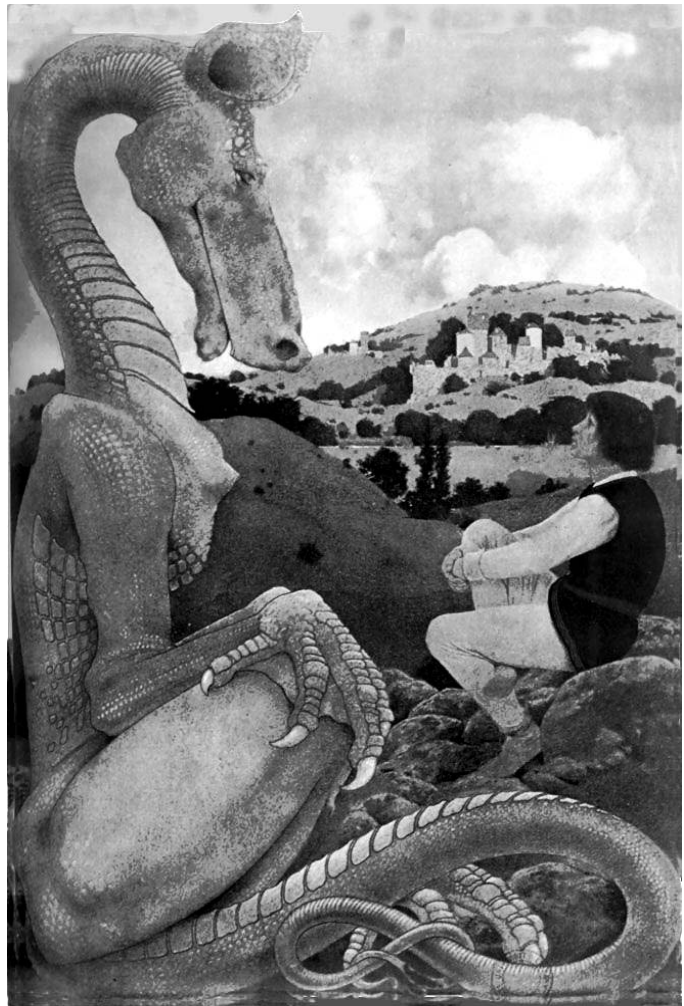
For +12 CP, the character can cast level 1 spells, but this suffers from the same usage restrictions and requires that character have a level 1 spell available to substitute, or another method of gathering the energy (Pulse of the Dragon combined with Eye of the Dragon works nicely). The cost doubles for every spell level thereafter: for a further +24 CP, the character can use level 2 spells, then he or she would pay another +48 CP for level 3, +96 for level four, and so on.

Blood of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Heart of the Dragon). Once the power of the Dragon enters the Blood, the character becomes a living source of magic. The character can expend up to (Cha Mod) spell levels each minute on Dragonfire, Breath of the Dragon, and Shaping effects without personal cost and without drawing on any other source of magic. The character also becomes a valuable resource for other spellcasters, enchanters, and anyone else who could use a powerful source of magic - or some pieces thereof.

The Dragon's Bones (+6 CP, requires Blood of the Dragon). With this, a character may sustain up to (Int Mod) spells without effort, avoiding the need to concentrate on spells which normally require it and extending the duration of other non-instantaneous spells until he or she ceases to maintain them.

The Way of the Wings of Fire

Kinetic Master (+6 CP, requires Shaping). A mainstay of minor telekinetic talents, this allows the user to manipulate objects within 60 feet with an effective Strength of (Int/3). Unfortunately, skills like Sleight of Hand, which require tactile or close-up visual feedback, suffer a -10 penalty when used at range in this fashion.



Will of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Kinetic Master). This talent boosts the effective telekinetic Strength of Kinetic Master by +3. It may be taken more than once, but the character's effective telekinetic Strength cannot exceed his or her Intelligence.

Scales of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Will of the Dragon). This personal armoring talent adds +2 Natural Armor and DR 5/Magic. It stacks with itself up to a maximum of +10 natural armor, and DR 15/Magic.

Mind Over Matter (+6 CP, requires Scales of the Dragon). Characters with Mind Over Matter may spend spell levels as needed to resist special attacks, even during other character's turns. They may sacrifice 2 spell levels per Negative Level, 1 spell level per point of attribute drain, or 3 spell levels against Paralysis. GM's may allow other, similar attacks to be resisted and set their own prices.

Flight of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Will of the Dragon). With Flight, a character may zoom about at will as if under the *Fly* spell. This is basically a telekinetic effect, but special effects are optional.

Might of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Flight of the Dragon). A favored trick in Superhero universes, Might enables characters to add their Int Bonus to their Strength score (not Strength Bonus).

Some GM's may opt to allow character to pretend their Int mod is positive if it's negative for the purposes of this feat only and only when the user is in a berserker rage. We don't really recommend this, but who are we to resist the power of a stereotype?

The Way of the Dragon's Speech

Mindspeech (+6 CP, requires Shaping). This is identical to the Mindspeech ability on page 37 but, with a bit of shaping, the base range can be extended to line-of-sight rather than 60 feet.

Tongue of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Mindspeech). Using subliminal telepathy, a user of the Tongue enjoys enhanced persuasive powers and may insert thoughts into people's minds. This increases any Charisma-based skill check by +2, allows the user to say one thing and pass a hidden message to one particular target, lets the user make ideas occur to people (this is no more persuasive than whispering it to them, but they'll have a hard time distinguishing such an idea from a passing thought of their own), and allows the character to use *Suggestion* a number of times per day equal to his or her Cha Mod.

Ears of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Tongue of the Dragon). This "receptive telepathy" helps people sense other's feelings. This grants a +4 bonus on Sense Motive, a continuous *Detect Thoughts* effect, and allows the user to reach into the minds of weak NPC's (in game terms, anyone with 1/5th or fewer of the character's levels) and search for information without making a roll.

Ears of the Wind (+6 CP, requires Ears of the Dragon). With Ears of the Wind, the user may hear a snippet of conversation every time he or she is mentioned anywhere in the plane. The user can turn this ability off. This is identical to the Dominion ability, but does not meet any other prerequisites for the Dominion ability chains.

Glamour (+6 CP, requires Mindspeech). Glamour is a sort of illusion magic. It alters how people interpret what they see, but not the physical nature of it. It can make a just plain ugly person look roughly distinguished or a poorly-dressed person seem fashionably apathetic about fashion (in the way only the super-rich might be able to get away with). There is no save; the user simply gets to describe him- or herself, and those in a 15-foot radius, in his or her own words.

Awe of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Glamour). Awe of the Dragon allows a character to project emotions or feelings across an area. This can increase or decrease any appropriate attribute or statistics (such as BAB, Caster Level, AC) by +2, and may have other effects, such as swaying crowds or inciting riots. Normally, this is not selective and affects a 100' radius. Common examples include: Rage, +2 Strength; Calm, +2 Will save; Fear, -2 Will save (and may *frighten* weaker characters); and Love, additional +2 when using "Aid Another." A Will save at a DC of (10 + Level/3 + Cha Mod) will negate the effects.

Voice of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Awe of the Dragon). A character with Voice of the Dragon gains enormous telepathic "volume." He or she may:

- Project the Awe of the Dragon over a 1000 foot radius
- Project the Awe to another location he or she can see or scry. Even characters not sensitive to psychic or magic powers will sense this anywhere close to the area.
- Attempt to Stun (for 1d4 rounds), Fascinate, or Panic those affected by the base radius of the Awe.
- Attempt to disrupt any other character's mind-affecting abilities affecting those within the base radius of the Awe. This allows affected characters to make a new saving throw.
- Attempt to Stun, Fascinate, Panic, or free from mind-affecting effects, any one target within line of sight range. A Will save at a DC of (10 + Level/3 + Cha Mod) will negate these effects.

The Way of the Dragon's Craft

Taskmaster (+6 CP, requires Shaping). Hephaestus's pride and joy, Taskmaster decreases the time for small-scale mundane tasks such as using most Craft or some Professional skills, cleaning the house, or splitting and piling firewood. Divide the normal length of time required for such tasks by (Intelligence).

Hands of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Taskmaster). With a variety of minor magical effects (such as personal memory enhancement and focused concentration), the user gains a +3 bonus on all Craft, Knowledge, and Profession skills.

Forge of the Dragon (+6 CP, requires Hand of the Dragon). With this feat, a crafter no longer needs any tools to produce equipment. Mundane tools grant a +2 bonus, while masterwork tools now grant a +5 bonus.

Manufacture (+6 CP, requires Forge of the Dragon). With Manufacture, a character can speed up item creation by a factor of ten. The quality of the character's work does not suffer, and if he or she would normally take extra time to create masterwork of other high-quality items, it does not require that extra time.



Ritual Magic

Occult Ritual (6 CP) is the art of causing singular mystic events through Spellcraft and ceremony. Describe the effect you want to produce; the Game Master then assigns a base DC. You may then consult with the Game Master and describe the ritual and up to seven components thereof. Each of the eight ritual elements (the description and the components) is worth a bonus of up to +5 (as assigned by the Game Master) on the ritual's Spellcraft roll.

Unfortunately, rituals are much less cut-and-dried than spells. They can succeed and fail in varying degrees, and often produce unfortunate side effects. As a rough guide to the DC of any given ritual, figure it at DC (10 + twice the level of the character who would be required to do it normally).

The Description may contain spells to cast, entities to call upon, a specific time and/or place of power where the ritual must take place, and various mundane requirements (assistants, props, expenses, ornaments, clothing, languages to chant in, mystic diagrams, XP costs, and so on).

The value of the ritual Components depends on their relevance to the rite, innate power, and scarcity. For example, the legendary *Staff of the Wind Lords* provides a +5 bonus when used in a ritual to raise a hurricane to devastate an enemy fleet, but aids little in attempting to awaken a volcano.

Sadly, you cannot artificially raise your Spellcraft skill by magic or psionics during a ritual without disrupting that ritual, unless you include such enhancements as ritual components at the usual +1 to +5 set by the GM. Obviously enough, grandiose rites require very special components, which the ritualist must go out and get (thus giving the Game Master a break: it's always nice to get the players do the work of setting up and motivating some adventures).

This is not a combat technique. It's a way to accomplish unique ends. Rites may remove specific curses, break ancient mystical seals, summon unique guardians, and so on, allowing characters to substitute time and effort for raw power and high-level spells. They usually require hours or days, assorted normal items (like candles, chalk, incense, a furnace and fuel) and produce special effects galore (howling winds, raging storms, shafts of light, glowing runes or circles, disembodied voices, etc).

"Mad Scientists" often use "Weird Science" instead of Ritual Magic. While they get to use an engineering or science skill instead of Spellcraft, they generally can't get any credit for location, calling on beings of power, or similar modifiers.

Ritual Results

DC+20 or more: Spectacular Success. The event occurs. Side effects are minimal or nonexistent, and the results are often better than the user anticipated.

DC+10-19: Success. The event occurs with minimal side effects and only moderate fatigue for the caster.

DC+5-9: Marginal Success. The event occurs, but its side effects are likely to be a bother and the user needs a day's rest to recover. Until then, he or she becomes Fatigued.

DC+0-4: Minimal Success. The event occurs with various drawbacks and annoying side effects. A non-legendary component may be destroyed even if this isn't required by the ritual or a legendary one may wind up tied into the event, either permanently (in the case of long-term enchantments and effects) or by shaping the nature of the event according to its own nature and purpose (for short-term or instantaneous events).

DC-1 to -5: Marginal Failure. A minor blunder. The side effects may be bothersome - but a week or two of research may reveal where the user went wrong, allowing another try.

DC-6 to -15: Ordinary Failure. It doesn't work. Side effects are troublesome, non-legendary components may be destroyed, and at least three ritual components were wrongly chosen. They must be replaced with new ones before the user may try again.

DC-16 or Worse: Spectacular Failure. Things go very, very, wrong. Bizarre events may occur, side effects run rampant, and the results of the ritual become grossly twisted. The ritual design was severely in error. Any further attempts must start over from the beginning.

"So by the time we'd gotten the Rod from that old tomb, located the Scroll of Tethis, gotten the Sigils embroidered on the newly-woven Ceremonial Robes, lured up a Seaworm and defeated it to get its Ichor, had the Cauldron blessed by each of the high priests of the Element Lords, built a boat without the use of iron or steel, had an astrologer determine the best day for it, and run that little mission to earn the blessing of the Dragon Lord of the Eastern Sea, we'd just about forgotten why we wanted to sail in and out of the great vortex in the first place! Well worth it, though. Those of use who survived could afford to retire after that trip. Two thousand years' worth of wrecked ships to plunder - and two thousand years' worth of undead as well.

-Retired Adventurer

Game Masters may opt to include preset rituals with requirements other than Occult Ritual and Spellcraft. In this case committing such a ritual to memory (at the cost of one skill or character point) provides a +5 bonus on any relevant check. In very low-magic worlds such preset rituals may be the only way to work magic at all.

Rune Magic

Rune Magic allows characters to develop skills in very specific fields of magic, such as Illusion, Light, Exorcism, or Transmutation.

Runecasters are free to try and create any effect within the limits of their skills and power reserves. While the level of a proposed effect must be set by the Game Master, he or she should remember that more specific spells are often easier. The chart under Hexcrafting (page 79) works nicely.

Sadly, skill-enhancing items grant only half their usual bonuses to Rune Magic skills; their magical nature interferes. Short term skill-enhancing spells, powers, and abilities do not work at all. Feats and specialties work normally.

Active Rune Magic requires both the Casting and Mastery skills for the rune in question. The armor check penalty reduces the skill ratings with respect to spellcasting; thus reducing both the Casting Level and maximum spell level of the user's magic. These skills may be based on Int, Wis, or Chr, depending on the user's spellcasting style. Once made, the choice applies to all Rune Magic skills taken.

[Rune] Casting (Varies, Trained Only, Armor Check Penalty) measures your skill in manipulating the actual energies of a rune. It may be used in place of the *Spellcraft* skill with regard to its field of magic. This skill/2 is your effective Caster Level when casting Rune Magic spells in this field. It's also occasionally rolled for spellcasting under poor conditions. Having [Rune] Casting 5+ provides a +2 synergy bonus on Spellcraft with related rolls.

DC	Task
15	Cast spell on fringe of field
15	Cast spell while restrained OR unable to speak
25	Cast spell while restrained AND unable to speak.
-5	Taking ten minutes to cast spell.

[Rune] Mastery (Varies, Trained Only, Armor Check Penalty) measures your level of knowledge of a

particular rune. It may be used in place of *Knowledge: Arcana* with regard to the fields of magic linked with the selected rune. The maximum level of spell that may be cast using a rune equals the relevant [Rune] Mastery skill/4.

Having (Rune) Mastery 5+ provides a +2 synergy bonus on Knowledge: Arcana with related rolls.

Runecrafting draws on Mana for power, but is relatively inefficient; it costs one point of Mana per level of the spell to cast a Runespell.

Characters may buy a Base Caster Level for Rune Magic at +3 CP/level and add it to the base provided by their skills, but this may not raise their effective Caster Level above their base level.

Casting a rune spell is a Standard Action.

For example, if Cerdwyn has Ice Mastery 15, Ice Casting 14, and 16 Mana, he can cast ice spells of up to level 3 at Caster Level 7, totaling up to 16 spell levels. He can complicate this with modifiers such as Hysteria, Skill Focus, or wearing armor with a skill penalty if he insists.

Minor abilities related to Rune Magic include:

* **Magician** (+6 CP). You may use the bonus spells from your spellcasting attribute to power Rune Magic.

* **Runic Ritual** (+6 CP). You may reduce the effective level of a spell (for casting purposes) by 1 using a dramatic invocation, an extra round, and relevant physical components, by 2 using a multi-hour ritual with assistants, mystic diagrams, and suitably expensive props, and by 3 for enacting the ritual at an appropriate time and place of

power. The player must supply the necessary details for this to work. This is the runic version of the *Compact* metamagic (Page 57).

Rune Magic can be used for general spellcasters, but it really works best for characters with narrowly specialized abilities. If your northern wilderness scout wants to dabble in Ice Magic, he or she can simply buy a bit of personal Mana and put some skill points into Ice Casting and Ice Mastery without having to develop broader magical skills. Similarly, NPC's using Rune Magic can provide specialized services without overshadowing the player characters.



The polite term is "Living Impaired," buddy.

Spell Storing

Spell Storing (6 CP). You may store one-use spells activated by spell completion in some type of inanimate object chosen when this ability is gained. Common types include powders, scrolls, gems, bones, wands, staves, and knots. Doing so costs (Spell Level x Caster Level) x (12.5 GP and 1 XP) plus any special costs of the spell in question. L0 Spells count as level “½” for this calculation. The minimum Caster Level is whatever allows the user to cast the spell.

On the market, such items have a base sale price equal to the base cost plus 5 GP per XP invested plus any special costs of the spell.

Classically, scrolls are the most common form in which spells are stored. Especially awkward and bulky media reduce the cost by one-third. Immobile media, such as stone circles, reduce the base cost by one-half - although few characters specialize in such media to start with.

Upgrades cost +3 CP each and must be taken in sequence. Sadly many of them make spells more expensive to store. Unlike most multipliers, cost multipliers for spell storing upgrades are directly cumulative. Using a x2 and a x5 multiplier on a single item results in 10x the base cost, not 6x. Similarly, if more than one upgrade that limits the level of spell which can be stored is applied, the most restrictive limit takes precedence. Characters may freely mix and match all their upgrades.

Improved Activation Methods make stored spells easier to use.

- **Magical Lore** (+3 CP). The spell can be activated as spell completion or with a successful Spellcraft check at DC (10 + 2 x Spell Level). Applying this upgrade limits the maximum level of spell which can be embedded to level five and doubles the base cost.

- **Minor Ritual** (+3 CP). The spell can be activated via a complex, but still physical, procedure requiring 2d6 or more rounds, such as a dance, singing a song, burning incense and gesturing, or drawing an intricate diagram. In general, this requires precise instructions or even a skill check. Applying this upgrade limits the maximum level of spell which can be embedded to level four, but does not affect the base cost.

- **Simple Action** (+3 CP). The spell can be activated by some simple physical procedure, such as rubbing a gem, holding out a talisman, speaking a command word, or making a gesture. Applying this upgrade limits the maximum level of spell which can be embedded to level three and doubles the base cost.

- **Thought** (+3 CP). The spell can be activated either by simply using the item in some practical way (e.g., swinging a sword) or as a Move-Equivalent Action.

Applying this upgrade limits the maximum level of spell which can be embedded to level one and triples the base cost.

- **Programmed** (+3 CP). The spell is self-activating. It has senses equal to the creator’s base senses and is always aware of its bearer’s physical condition, but has no special senses or sensory skills otherwise. It may be given up to 25 words’ worth of instructions as to when and how to activate. Programmed magic is reasonably sensible, and can count, but cannot make complex value judgements. This upgrade can be applied to spells of any level, but increases the base cost by a factor of five.

Multiple Embedment allows you to fashion items with more than one charge or to make multiple single-use items at the same time. There are at least three, and possibly more, levels of this upgrade available.



OK. Which of you clowns coated my staff with Sovereign Glue?

- **Level I** (+3 CP). This allows the user to imbue an item or items with a total of up to 10 charges as a single enchantment. Multiply the base cost by (1 + Total Charges / 2). Applying this upgrade limits the maximum level of spell which can be embedded to level five.

- **Level II** (+3 CP). This allows the user to imbue an item or items with a total of up to 50 charges as a single enchantment. Multiply the base cost by (5 + Total Charges / 2). Applying this upgrade limits the spells which can be embedded to a maximum of level four.

• **Level III** (+3 CP). This allows the user to imbue an item or items with a total of up to 250 charges as a single enchantment. Multiply the base cost by (20 + Total Charges / 5). Applying this upgrade limits the spells which can be embedded to a maximum of level three.

Higher multiples may be possible, but it's rare for anyone to bother.

Optionally, the Game Master may opt to charge an additional 3 character points for the ability to split charges between multiple items. For example, a character with Multiple Embedment III could elect to brew 250 doses of Cure Light Wounds potion, 25 ten-charge talismans, or one 250 charge staff for the same cost.

Additional Media. This simple upgrade allows the user to embed spells in an additional type of item. Likely "types" include weapons, gems and jewelry, candles, compounds (potions, dusts, salves, and oils fall into this group), bones, rods, knots, paper, and many more. Each additional type costs +3 CP.

While it is possible to learn to embed magic in living creatures, this is a two step process. The operator must first learn to embed spells in him- or her-self and then may upgrade again to learn to embed spells in other creatures (familiars are popular choices). In any case, living creatures may not carry more than (2 x Con) total spell levels. Creatures without a Constitution score, such as undead and constructs, cannot be imbued with spells.

Maximum Level Increase. This upgrade

relaxes the spell level restriction imposed by many other upgrades. Each time you take this upgrade, apply a +2 bonus to the stated level limits, at the price of increasing the GP cost multiplier (not the XP multiplier) by a factor of 3, 6, 10, and 50 for increases of 1-2, 3-4, 5-6, and 7-8 levels. Once a character can store ninth level spells with a particular option, he or she has mastered the technique, and so can use it to store spells of any level.

Multiple Formula. This upgrade allows the user to imbue an item with multiple channels for the pool of mystical power it contains, allowing that power to be used in more than one spell. Each such spell must have

the same Caster Level and must cost at least one charge (if they cost more than one charge, the cost of the spell is divided by the number of charges used). Since they all draw on the same pool of charges, the most expensive spell costs full price, the second most expensive spell only costs 75% as much as usual, and any additional spells only cost half as much as usual.

For example, a *Wand of Fire* with Caster Level 7, which casts *Fireball* (L3), *Wall of Fire* (2 Charges, effective L2), *Flaming Sphere* (L2), and *Burning Hands* (L1), has a base cost of (3 + 1.5 + 1 + .5 =) 6 x 7 x whatever charge number multiplier is used x (12.5 GP and 1 XP).

• **Level I** (+3 CP). Allows an item to be imbued with up to four related spells (e.g., Fire spells, teleportation spells, summoning spells).

• **Level II** (+3 CP). Allows an item to be imbued with up to a dozen related spells.

• **Level III** (+3 CP). Allows an item to be imbued with up to four totally unrelated spells.

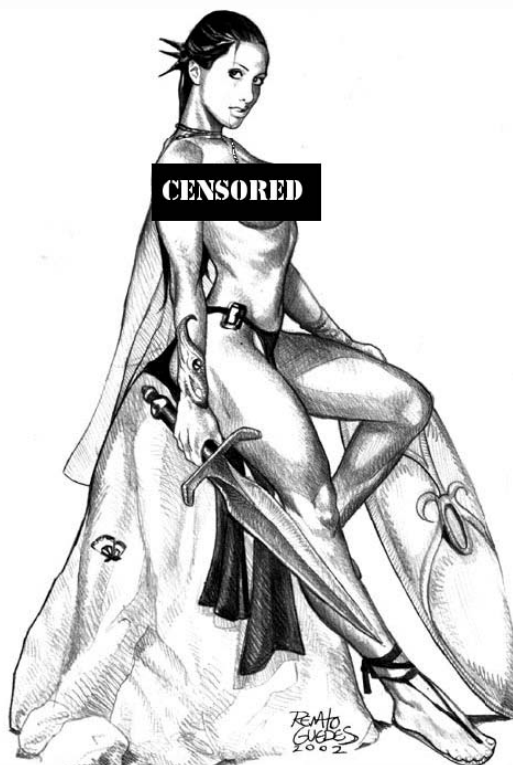
• **Level IV** (+3 CP). Allows an item to be imbued with up to a dozen totally unrelated spells.

Focusing. These upgrades allow the creation of rechargeable items, capable of absorbing additional magical power to supplement their original reserves. Sadly, an item has to have at least one charge left to function. If all of its charges are expended, any powers dependent on charges permanently cease to function.

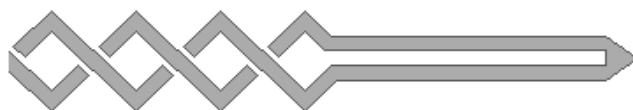
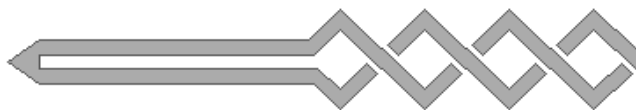
• **Occult Focus** (+3 CP). These items have a built-in version of Empowerment, allowing the user to power

them with magical or psychic energies of his or her own. If the user pays the costs of the spell, no charges are expended. Applying this option divides the total number of charges in the item by three.

• **Rechargeable** (+3 CP). The item may be recharged by simply throwing appropriate spells at it with the intent of recharging it. Applying this option divides the total number of charges by ten. *Self-Charging* items are a variant which have been imbued with a relevant user-per-day spell devoted to recharging the item via *Create Item*. *Absorbing* items are simply rechargeable items with a more or less specialized Absorption spell effect (usually level 9) built into the via *Create Item*.



No one ever did figure out where she kept her spell components.



Thaumaturgy and Dweomer

Thaumaturgy and Dweomer use a complicated system intended for advanced players. It's fun and versatile once you get the hang of it, but you need a good grip on the rules.

Dweomer and Thaumaturgy employ primitive – or more accurately, *primal* – methods of creating magical effects. The practitioner uses his or her personal energies to focus and direct external forces, manifesting various effects without benefit of formal spells or disciplines. While this intuitive approach offers great flexibility, it is unreliable and demands exceptional levels of skill.

Thaumaturgists focus on particular magical themes, such as Shamanism, Animal Magic, Weather, Ocean or Water Magic, Necromancy, or even Hyper-speed. Such themes are usually related to the natural world, and are often seen as primitive magic - precursors of the later magical schools.

Dweomer evolved much later than Thaumaturgy. Although similar in principle, Dweomer revolves around the myriad ways of using a particular technique or scientific concept. It is organized by the tool, not the goal, and is usually considered a precursor to psionics. Most Dweomer users hail from magically and scientifically advanced cultures, wielding their power to explore the limits of possibility.

Mechanically, both powers are identical. Dweomer is an artistic science. Thaumaturgy is a scientific art.

In contrast to Thaumaturgy and Dweomer, “modern” arcane magic relies purely on external energies, channeled into well-practiced intrinsic spells or bound into the structure of prepared spells. Divine magic is similar, though the power comes from a deity. While arcane casters, tapping into primal energies directly, have more raw energy available than divine casters, whose magic comes channeled indirectly, that very indirectness allows divine casters to use more refined spells. Reliable but inflexible, modern magic also pays in that it can easily be counterspelled or blocked by various countermagics, although it demands little from the wielder except practice.

Psionics discards external energy entirely, but still relies on the use of refined, developed powers, which means they are similarly inflexible. Their reliance on internal energies offers superb control and grants a user the ability to channel energy into powers as needed. This sometimes opens a user up to manipulation by similar energies (old Psionic Attack modes), and can't match the sheer power available to spellcasters.

Thaumaturgy and Dweomer, unlike modern magical techniques, leave much of the detail unsaid, relying on unconscious and reflexive forces.

Weaving Effects

Both Dweomer and Thaumaturgy consist of a series of feats which offer access to the skills in a given field; such skills are NOT usable unskilled and have no governing attribute. The (usually eight) skills in the field are now considered “relevant” provided they fit the character's concept.

Some sample listings of skills and fields are included below - but these are not a comprehensive list. Indeed, even two users of seemingly-identical types of magic will not necessarily have the same skills.

Using Dweomer or Thaumaturgy is also relatively simple; the user decides the effect to be produced and the method (fields, skills, and modifiers) to be employed. The GM may suggest modifications and assigns a DC for the rolls required. The would-be user is entitled to change his or her mind before rolling at this point. If not, he or she pays the cost of the attempted spell and rolls. For combat, try having a few spells jotted down on your character sheet so you can toss them off without slowing everyone else up.

On a success, the effect occurs more or less as desired. The effects of a failed roll are unpredictable, but usually involve getting a partial effect or simple failure. Full-scale backfires and wild magical effects are normally reserved for truly spectacular fumbles, where the user misses the target number by a large margin (10+).

Effects are broken up into seven basic categories, ranging from trivial enchantments to epic feats of magic. Typical equivalents are listed as a general rule of thumb for the Game Master.

The base suggested DC for various effects is listed in the *DC* column on the chart below; characters cannot “Take 20.”

The second DC entry is for saves against the effect. Add the caster's Con Mod to the save DC.

Cost lists two numbers; the first is the cost in psionic power, the second is the cost in generic spell levels. Characters may substitute Mana at the usual rate; 1 Mana = 2 spell levels *or* 4 Power *or* 1 spell level *and* 2 Power. No feat is required to do this.

Cost Modifiers from Levels

Even if a character can manage the skill required, they still need a sufficiently high level to channel the flow of energy properly. A low caster-level character simply doesn't have the necessary ability to pour energy through themselves. Even if they can come up with enough bonuses to manage the spell, a low-level caster will expend more energy than a high-level one. On the other hand, high-level characters find it increasingly easy to use low-level magic.

Thaumaturgy and Dweomer use the standard Base Caster Level, at 6 CP each. Caster levels for these abilities only are Specialized or Corrupted as usual.



Thaumaturgy and Dweomer

Effect is...	--DC--	--Cost--	Typical Equivalents
Trivial	10 / 10	Sp*	Cantrip and L0 effects
Easy	15 / 12	2 & 1	L1 and L2 effects
Average	20 / 14	4 & 2	L3 and L4 effects
Difficult	25 / 16	6 & 3	L5 and L6 effects
Amazing	30 / 18	8 & 4	L7 and L8 effects
Grandiose	35 / 21	10 & 5	L9 and L10 effects
Epic	40 / 24	12 & 6	L11 and L12 effects

*Trivial effects cost either 1 Power OR ½ spell level.

Effect is...	Character Level Cost Modifiers				
	01-05	06-10	11-15	16-20	21+
Trivial	---	---	---	x½	x½
Easy	---	---	---	---	x½
Average	---	---	---	---	---
Difficult	x2	---	---	---	---
Amazing	x2	x2	---	---	---
Grandiose	x3	x3	x2	---	---
Epic	x4	x3	x2	---	---

Various items, personal abilities, feats, specialized spells, sacrifices, skills, and environmental sources can contribute towards the cost, at least if the user knows how to use them. For these purposes:

- 1 Point of Temporary Attribute Damage = 1/2 Spell Level or 1 Power (requires the Body Fuel feat).
- 1 Spell Level = 2 points of Power (requires the Unity feat).
- 2 Power = 1 Spell Level (requires the Unity feat).
- 2 Points of Hit Point Damage = 1/2 spell level or 1 Power (requires the advanced Body Fuel feat).
- A user may also channel spare psionic Power or spell levels into Thaumaturgy or Dweomer directly. Some techniques in the Path of Dragon help considerably.

DC Modifiers

Expertise. Having sufficient mundane skill in something may make magical methods much easier. For example, creating a mighty fortress would usually fall under the Grandiose or even Epic difficulty. For a character skilled in architecture, the effect might only be Amazing. GM's must play this one by ear, but in general mundane skill can reduce the DC by one or - at the very most - two levels.

Restrained. If the character cannot move or speak freely, increase the level of effect required by one step. If he or she cannot speak or cannot gesture at all, increase it by two levels. If he or she cannot do either at all, increase it by five levels. Note that Metamagic and Metapsionic feats do not apply to Dweomer and Thaumaturgy.

Ritual Casting. Each ritual component used modifies Thaumaturgy DC, with the GM deciding just how much any one component can help (usually -0 to -2). The possible modifiers include:

Place. *An appropriate location, such as a crossroads for travel magic.*

• **Time.** *During a lunar eclipse, at the stroke of midnight, during a relevant astronomical conjunction, or whatever fits the effect.*

• **Components.** *Candles, mirrors, sandpaintings, altars, obelisks, and all the other paraphernalia of ritual magic.*

• **Ceremony.** *Taking lots of extra time, usually hours or even days, to spend chanting, tinkering with components and waving your arms around.*

• **Invocation.** *Calling on a greater entity or spirit with relevant powers. Please note that this does run some slight risk of actually being noticed by the entity in question.*

Many Knowledge skills (such as Arcana, History, and Religion), Spellcraft, Auto-Hypnosis, and Profession: Herbalist or Alchemy may prove useful or necessary in ritual casting.



Cost Modifiers

Environmental Conditions. Special locations often offer special bonuses to Thaumaturgy. When the user's will coincides with a magic-rich environment or one in harmony with the sort of power he or she wields, the flow of energy comes much more easily. A good environment, such as Pyramids built to focus Celestial forces or Stonehenge for Earth magic, reduces the cost by as much as the GM feels like allowing. This may even reduce the DC check.

Skill and Luck. For every five full points by which the user's roll exceeds the DC of the effect he or she is trying to produce, the user may reduce the net cost by 1 Power point OR by 1/2 spell level to a minimum of 0.

Special Benefits

Knowledge and Saves. Studying Thaumaturgy or Dweomer is not confined to merely tossing off spells. True masters must understand the flow and feel of those forces she controls. This grants a bonus of (Skill Rank/5) on related Knowledge checks and saving throws against such effects. A character may only use one skill in a given field.

For example, a skill-18 user of Negative Energy gains a +4 bonus on Knowledge checks (and Spellcraft) related to Negative Energy, and a +4 bonus on saving throws against those effects.

If a character has multiple applicable skills from

different Thaumaturgy or Dweomer paths, he or she may use up to one skill from each for the purposes of this ability, adding the ranks together. Since it is rarely cost-effective, this isn't a common situation, but it does exist.

Special Options

While the normal system of feats, skills, personal mana, and magic levels normally suffices to provide both Power and spell energy for would-be Thaumaturgy masters to work with, GM's may decide to include one or more of the following options. GM's may choose to split these bonuses into Power and spell levels instead of just raw Mana. In that case, each point of Mana becomes 1 spell level and 2 Power. Even using all of these together won't normally unbalance a character; it never outshines all other magic or psionics, though we recommend using only one of Attribute Base and Skill Mana.

- Attribute Base. Characters gain a base level of Power points equal to their (Cha Score/2) and generic spell levels equal to their (Con Score/3). Note that, if this option is used, it should probably apply to all characters - whether or not they ever learn to use their potential.

- Body Fuel. Whenever characters take a Thaumaturgy feat, they gain a limited form of Body Fuel for free, which they may only use to pay for Thaumaturgy.

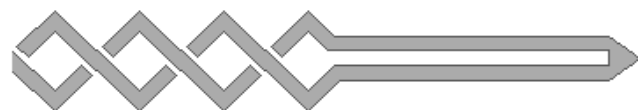
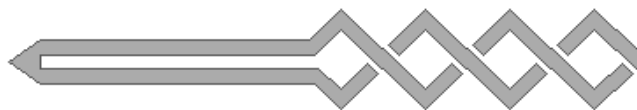
- Bonus Mana. With this, all characters receive Mana. Appropriate for high-magic worlds where everyone has at least some magical connection or potential, this grants characters 1d6 Mana as a base. Very high magic worlds

may even allow this to increase by one point every three levels.

- Automatic Mana. Each time a character takes a Thaumaturgy or Dweomer feat, they gain 1d3 Mana.

- Skill Mana. Here characters gain bonuses to Mana for having high skill. Characters gain (total Thaumaturgy and Dweomer skill levels/8) Mana. This can amount to quite a lot at higher levels, but rarely allows even a dedicated character to exceed the number of spells available to normal spellcasters.





Thaumaturgy Sample Fields

Necromancy

Students of the ways of life and death, Necromancers have a bad reputation. Though most evil practitioners are actually Wizards or Clerics, the stigma remains. Thaumaturgic Necromancers more often tend to the dead and assist the living in the frightening process of dying. Of course, the ability to actually look into the afterlife and say "Hello" to the ancestors makes this easier.

The discipline is still open to abuse, and the creation of undead remains a potential talent. Not all cultures consider this evil in itself, but it only takes a few madmen unleashing horrors on the common folk to fuel widespread fear. The skills of a Necromancer include:

- **Channeling.** Positive Energy Manipulation is a useful discipline. With effects similar to Channeling this allows healing, blasting undead, powering mechanical or electrical objects, generating light, dispelling negative energy effects, and the creation of new life.
- **Darkness Mastery.** Also known as Negative Energy Manipulation, this covers creating and manipulating simple or tangible darkness, negative energy effects, disintegrations, and countering positive energy effects.
- **Entropic Manipulation.** The manipulation of age and decay. While an effective attack when used to speed up such events, Entropy may also be reversed to repair things. It can be used to reassemble ashes into a book, cause someone to age and rot as they stand, or induce, hasten, slow, or reverse the ravages of time. It can even recreate fallen castles at the highest levels.
- **Gates of Death.** This interesting skill allows the user to enter and leave the realms of the dead, to tap into the powers of the dead via their relics, extend his or her senses into afterworlds, lay unquiet spirits, communicate with the dead, create undead, and even raise the dead.
- **Life Force Transference.** The ability to transfer and manipulate the energies - and even the spirits - of living creatures is a dangerous and often corrupting path to walk. Transference is useful in draining or temporarily transferring hit points, attribute points, and muscular energies, in transferring spirits from one body to another - even into inanimate objects - and in bringing inanimate objects to temporary or permanent life.
- **One With Death.** One classic method of bypassing the inconvenience of death involves transcending the limitations of the mortal body by infusing it with positive or negative energy. Uses range from seeing in the dark and holding your breath on up through countering poisons, "grafting" bones or parts of corpses to yourself to tap into their power, intangibility, resisting the powers of the undead, and becoming a spirit or undead being yourself.
- **Spirit Binding.** As the name suggests, this includes the ability to lay compulsions on and command the living and the dead. Commonly used to frighten people, steal

spirits, or induce silence, characters can also make very convincing "requests" of spiritual beings.

- **Summoning.** A relatively straightforward ability, this allows the Necromancer to call up spirits and magical beings. This does not necessarily indicate that the user can control them! (See Spirit Binding, above.) Necromancers deal with the spirits of the dead and the other inhabitants of the afterworlds - typically "Angels" and "Demons," rather than pure elementals.

Weather Control

While it's not the most powerful field to start with, Weather Control is vital to every farmer, making it one of the most popular. Sadly, a powerful weather-worker is likely to be blamed for every storm for miles around.

- **Cold.** Ranging from a cool breeze to a frigid arctic blast, cold enables the user to create freezing attacks. It also allows the caster to create ice in whatever forms and locations he or she desires.
- **Heat.** Hold the power of the roiling deserts in the palm of your hand! While not as flashy as a wizard's *Fireball*, Heat magic enables the user to summon up blasts of scalding wind to strip the bones from their enemies' soon-to-be desiccated husks, and is about as effective.
- **Lightning.** Straightforward and usually destructive, this covers all lightning-based spells. Some users take it a step further, using it to manipulate electricity at smaller scales - even in their own bodies.
- **Ocean Control.** Ocean currents are a form of weather, too. This allows the user to manipulate bodies of water, tides, whirlpools, and to create and control hot and cold currents to use as underwater attacks or simply to enable fast travel. Sauna creation is very popular magic, but Red Tide creation is less so.
- **Personalization.** Personalized effects allow a caster to fly, resist similar weather magic, and even become a weather spirit at higher levels. In essence, this takes the power of other Weather Control skills and turns it inward.
- **Rain.** Start singing in the rain. This allows the user to summon, dismiss, or manipulate rain over large areas. It can ensure the proper amount of rain for a region, cause country-wide flooding at higher levels, or dry up a whole nation. The user can create blasts of water for combat purposes; while these do relatively little damage they can knock opponents down quite effectively.
- **Weather Sense.** Not normally taken to high levels, Weather Sense allows the user to determine what the weather will be like tomorrow. Higher levels do let the user peer farther into the future, see the currents of solar radiation across the cosmos, and look at the weather for a whole plane, but this is rarely worth the effort.
- **Wind.** A master of wind may direct blasts of it, control the direction of air flow, or even choke an enemy to death. While a subtle tool in the hands of a cunning caster, "telekinetic" tricks require higher level effects.



Dweomer Sample Fields

Psychokinesis

The ability to manipulate matter and energy through the application of force is a versatile discipline, favored by scientists and researchers. While it's also possessed by wild talents, who predominantly focus on the brute-force applications, this powerful technique offers unlimited possibilities for matter reconstruction. Psychokinetic skills include:

- Capacitance. This covers absorbing, storing, and discharging various types of energy, as well as converting energy from one form to another.
- Electrokinesis. Some people like it small. With this, users may manipulate electrons, photons, and electromagnetic fields. While extremely versatile, only those knowledgeable about scientific matters (or the fantasy equivalent) can use it to full effect.
- Nucleokinesis. Nucleokinesis allows characters to manipulate atomic nuclei, protons, neutrons, mesons, quarks, and other tiny particles. This covers generating or neutralizing particulate radiation, catalyzing nuclear reactions, and transmutations. While useful in experimentation at low levels, the high-level effects allow for truly stunning creations.
- Pyrotics. Heat is just a form of movement. Pyrotics grants the ability to alter molecular energy states; heating or cooling material, catalyzing or inhibiting reactions, and selectively affecting particular types of molecules.
- Reconstruction. The ability to rebuild molecular structures allows for vast increases in the quantity and quality of compounds available. Aside from chemical modifications, this includes forcing material into unnatural states - like incandescent liquids or making iron liquid at room temperature. This allows shattering, extraction, purification, and friction manipulation. While it is theoretically possible to rebuild complex things, including living creatures, by Reconstruction, it's usually much easier to do it some other way.
- Stasis Fields. Stabilizing matter is a handy talent. Aside from making unstable forms of matter more permanent, at least for a while, this covers force fields (by stabilizing air), preserving objects, holding an unstable rock face together, the creation of temporary objects from air, and paralysis effects.
- Telekinesis. A direct application, this covers the manipulation of matter in relatively large chunks. Characters can also compensate for inertia, fly, and amplify their own muscular force.
- Vibration. This covers sound, earthquakes, shattering effects, and whatever "Vibratory Powers" the user can talk the GM into letting him or her get away with.

Please don't send us any ideas. We *really* don't want to know.

Telepathy

Telepathy is a subtle, and widely feared, ability. Who doesn't have a few things in their heads they don't want anyone else to know?

On the other hand, are you sure that you want to?

- Astral Form. A classic application, this allows the user to see or even travel into the astral realm for increasingly long periods of time in relative safety. Disrupting such a voyage violently from inside or outside the Astral is not fatal, though it may cause shock. The ultimate expression of this allows the character to physically enter astral space or to survive physical death as a free spirit.
- Constructs. This allows a caster to create psychic constructs, essentially like a *Summon Monster* spell or *Astral Construct*.
- Disruption. Disruption simply involves a massive psychic blast. By striking at an enemy's nervous system, the caster stuns them, causing subdual damage or inflicting various negative status effects. At higher levels this can induce paralysis, inflict various disabilities, or even kill.
- Illusion. The creation of mental illusions is a versatile discipline. These illusions become more realistic and affect more people as the spells increase in power. While they can't hurt people physically, they can frighten, lure people into danger, render subjects unconscious or even, like *Phantasmal Killer*, kill.
- Links. This ability can create psychic links between people or objects, allowing one to communicate or perceive through the eyes of another. At higher levels, this can create links upon which magic might flow, allowing one spell to empower two characters. Subtle links allow various forms of mental probes and scans.
- Presence. More subtle than most Telepathy, Presence creates an aura of glamour, mystery, or empathy around the character. Aside from its utility in quiet *Suggestion*-style spells, it can create area-effect attention-gathering magic and multiply the character's force of personality.
- Projection. Sending one's thoughts into another's minds creates, at low levels, mere one-way telepathic effects. This quickly evolves into mind control of various flavors and powers, from the subtle to the brutal. At its ultimate peak, this might even allow the caster to command an enemy to commit suicide, to instantly imbue others with his or her own skills, or to completely rewrite a victim's memories and personality.
- Void. Void represents the negation of the mind. At the most basic this is a simple defensive technique that empties the caster's mind of all active thought, allowing him or her to defend against telepathic attack. This can grant bonuses on saves or damage from telepathic or psionic attacks as well as canceling mental states. More actively it can be used to wipe away memories and perceptions, to negate psychic constructs, and to suppress emotions.

While Thaumaturgy has an almost unlimited number of variants, Dweomer masters tend to be less varied. Other common fields from our games include:

Warping

Warping covers the manipulation of space, time, and dimension. It's a dangerous and destabilizing discipline.

- Dimensional Warping covers extradimensional travel and gates, banishing things, and tinkering with extradimensional spaces.
- Gravitic Warping covers changing to local gravity, "telekinetic" effects, antigravity, and even the creation of gravitational weapons, such as tidal effects, cosmic string, and singularities. Be very afraid.
- Overlay covers forcing two regions into congruence. It's used with one of the basic skills above to allow things in different places, times, and/or dimensions to interact or to alter planar traits in a localized area.
- Spatial Warping covers redefining "straight lines," altering distances, and teleportation.
- Stabilization covers closing down gates and rifts, keeping other people from tinkering with space and time, and maintaining your own existence when someone alters the past. It's a *good* thing.
- Temporal Warping covers accelerating or decelerating the flow of time, stasis and "force" fields, pre- and post-cognition, and time travel. It's best used with extreme caution.
- Transference covers shunting matter and energy into

and out of the dimension you're occupying. It's probably the safest way to use warping to attack or defend.

- Warp Detection simply allows the user to sense and analyze spatial, dimensional, and temporal disturbances.

Healing

Healing covers putting things right - implying that there is a natural way for things to be - as well as simple biophysical manipulations. It's also one of the most popular magical fields around.

- Environmental Healing allows the use of the basic healing skills on a wider scale and restores the natural order - allowing the user to heal dimensional rifts and disturbances, unnatural magical disturbances, expel most outsiders, and deal with any similar difficulties.
- Life Transference covers donating or draining away life energy, healing negative levels, moving souls from body to body, and raising the dead.
- Mental Healing repairs insanities, feeble-mindedness, confusion, and amnesia.
- Physical Healing repairs bodily injuries and eliminates poisons, diseases, and drugs. It can also be used for cloning and to repair congenital problems.
- Shapeshifting covers whole-body transformations, and can be used with the basic Healing skills to transform other aspects of a creature as well.
- Spiritual Healing repairs emotional wounds, inspires and aids, expels possessing entities, and dispels various compulsions and geasa.





- **Stabilization** allows the user to maintain and enhance life. It can be used to resist aging, enhance attributes, hit points, and toughness, to resist physical needs, and to keep creatures alive and functioning long after they ought to be dead.
- **Transformation** allows the modification of bodies and life processes, including tinkering with the metabolism, modifying or adding organs, and genetic engineering. A through knowledge of biology is recommended as well.

Extra-Sensory Perception

ESP covers methods of extending and enhancing the senses as well as information-gathering in general.

- **Analytic Probe** lets the user examine the structure of matter, whether on the scale of how a fault line works or on the atomic level. More directly, this can examine the mechanisms of locks and traps, check for internal injuries, locate hidden passageways, or work in the dark.
- **Aura Sight** covers the ability to detect and analyze energy fields, including magical energy fields, life energy fields, and simple physical fields.
- **Awareness** covers sensory integration and perception. It allows the user to enhance his or her sensory skills, to pick out the important elements in what he or she perceives, to integrate minor clues (for example, putting together the tiny indications that will reveal if someone is lying), and keep detection effects running while he or she is distracted, sleeping, or even unconscious.
- **Clairsentience** allows the user to extend his or her senses elsewhere in time, space, and dimension.
- **Dowsing** covers basic *Detect* effects, revealing the presence and general location of something.
- **Hypersenses** covers adjusting your senses' sensitivity as well as extending them, allowing the user to track like a bloodhound or see into the radio spectrum.
- **Intuition** allows the user to pluck information out of the universe at large, seeing large-scale patterns, future trends, and simply "knowing" things that he or she has no right to know. Unfortunately, Intuition-based effects tend to be of higher level than information gathering by more direct means.
- **Psychic Awareness** covers the ability to detect and analyze the mind and spirit, noting thoughts, memories, lies, possession, and all forms of mental instability.

Mysticism

Mysticism covers the manipulation of special abilities themselves. It's usually combined with another field.

- **Amplification** allows the user to enhance mystical abilities, increasing their raw power, extending their range, or penetrating various countereffects.
- **Bestowal** allows the user to transfer Power and other mystical energies to other people and to give mystical abilities to others, usually on a temporary basis.
- **Imbuement** covers storing mystical energy and powers in objects or imbuing them with special properties.

- **Linking** covers just that; creating mystical links between creatures and/or things. Links can be used for communication, to transfer various energies, or to bind things together so that they share a fate, can be transported to each other, or can be used for travelling.
- **Nullification** lets you negate, dispel, or suppress various mystical abilities, reduce other people's talents, break spells, and severely damage mystical beings.
- **Permanency** allows the creation of permanent power-storing or mystical energy channeling devices and making other effects permanent.
- **Psi-Armor** actually covers warding off and protecting yourself from mystical powers and creatures in general. It's effectively an anchored, ongoing, version of the basic Nullification effect.
- **Willcrystal** allows the user to bind abilities, items, and mental constructs such as thoughts, decisions, and even memories to another creature's life force. It can be used to personalize items, to steal the abilities of fallen foes, to protect thoughts and decisions from external influences, and to carry things with you into astral space or into the realms of the dead.

Practical Considerations

A dedicated Thaumaturgist or Dweomer-master will likely want to spend at least 4 CP on skills (presuming both permissible levels of Adept have been taken), 6 CP on personal Mana (probably Specialized as "only usable for Dweomer or Thaumaturgy"), 3 CP on Caster Level (Specialized in their field), and a couple of CP on other magic enhancements or related fields each level, for a net cost of 14-16 CP per level - as much as a Wizard or a Sorcerer spends on their magic.

Thaumaturgical magic is expensive and requires a lot of work from the player. Therefore, it should be at least as useful as sorcery or wizardry, if not more so. Define fields broadly and make every one useful out of combat, with two or three of its skills useful in a fight.

On the Game Master's side Thaumaturgy works well as a substitute for all other magic. It's flexible enough to have value to dabblers while giving specialists an edge. At the same time, since anyone can vary the specific abilities in a given field, two different characters can have the same Thaumaturgy fields and still feel as if they're not competing. The goal of Thaumaturgy is that a player can enjoy experimenting with a single field for a full year and still feel as though there are many tricks not yet tried, things left undone, and more techniques to explore.

On the downside, if you allow Thaumaturgy, you'll need to be able to think on your feet and deal with the unexpected. Player-character Thaumaturgists tend to come up with an astonishing range of things that never occurred to you.



If the character mimics a standard spell, use the lowest listed spell level for it. Theurgy can have metamagic applied to it either by building the necessary modifiers into the spell directly or by buying the relevant abilities. If the Thurgist buys the abilities, the spell levels applied from metamagic do *not* add to the DC of performing the spell.

Theurgy sometimes gives users access to magic early, but always carries the risk of failure. Aside from that, all of those skills are simply expensive to buy.

Theurgy

Throughout the history of magic, magi have sought to understand the magic of words, symbols, names, and the tongue of creation. Theurgy draws upon that ancient heritage, bringing unmatched flexibility to those few who master it.

Theurgy allows its users to compose spells on the fly by combining their skills in magical verbs and nouns. Each verb allows a particular type of manipulation while each noun covers one of the basic components of reality. Naturally enough, each spell requires at least one noun and one verb.

The mechanic is simple. The user describes what he or she wants to do and the nouns and verbs it will involve, gets a ruling on the level of the task from the Game Master, marks off an open spell slot of the appropriate or higher level (or aborts the spell if it's too high a level), and rolls (1d20 + worst verb skill involved + worst noun skill involved) against a DC of 5x (Spell Level +1). On a success, the spell goes off. On a failure, the spell fails and the slot is wasted. Theurgy is always at least a full-round action.

Magic levels dedicated to Theurgy - with slots which cannot be used for other purposes - are Specialized, and so cost only half the usual number of CP. While Thurgists can fuel their spells with raw Mana or generic spell levels, they still need to buy a Caster Level.

Every noun and verb used in the spell must be considered. A spell that transmutes rock into another form of rock would require both the Transformation and Earth skills. One that transformed rock into air would require Transformation, Earth, and Air. If it then focused and directed the flow of air from the transmuted stone, it would require Control as well.

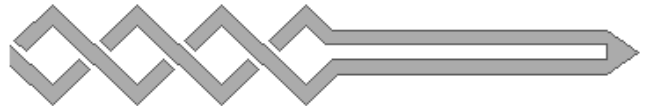
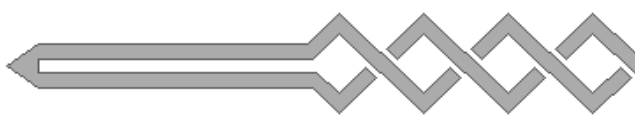
Theurgical Verbs

- Creation (Dagaz, Genis) covers the ability to create objects, materials, thoughts, and energy out of magical power.
- Control (Thurisaz, Fiat) covers position, motion, and animation, as well as making things act within their nature (horses eat grass, not meat).
- Destruction (Eiwas, Perdo) covers damaging things, destruction, uncreation, and negation. While it is all too often used like a sledgehammer, the power of destruction can be as artful as the finest scalpel.
- Healing (Uruz, Medi) covers the ability to heal, repair, and maintain things by stabilizing their structure.
- Transformation (Kenaz, Muto) covers the ability to reshape and transmute materials, to link things together, and to imbue items with new properties. Like most magic, this skill conveniently glosses over the immense knowledge of biology, chemistry, and physics this would seem to require.
- Understanding (Ansuz, Sapio) covers knowledge, divination, and communication.

Theurgical Nouns

The Physical Elements

- Air (Perthro, Tempest) covers gases, air, weather and wind, as well as sound and electricity. Oddly, Dexterity is also tied to air magic.
- Earth (Jera, Terra) covers stone, soil, and metal. It also covers gravitation and the nuclear forces - although there are few spells or spellcasters who deal with such matters.



- Fire (Naudiz, Flammo) covers heat and cold, flame, energy, and chemical reactions, such as the metabolism. It's easily turned to combative ends, hence a great many Theurgist-adventurers are skilled in Fire magic.
- Water (Laguz, Aqua) covers fluids, syrups, acids, bases, blood, and even most ooze creatures. It can usually control ice as well, at least until it becomes so cold that its internal water is completely locked up.

The Living Elements

- Body (Mannaz, Corpus) covers flesh, bone, leather, and fur, as well as Strength and Constitution. Many of the most useful enhancements fall under body magic.
- Mind (Isa, Mentis) covers thought, emotion, memory, Intelligence, Wisdom and the mind in general.
- Plant (Fehu, Sero) covers plants and all products or materials derived from plants, including ordinary objects like straw hats and derived substances such as tar.
- Spirit (Kano, Animus) covers spirits, death, the dead, incorporeal creatures, astral projection and the alignment energies of the outer planes. Charisma and the "Spark of Life" also falls under the dominion of Spirit magic.

The Hidden Elements

- Illusion (Sowilo, Lux) covers light, darkness, and shadow, as well as the forces of positive and negative energy which lie behind them. Unlike the other nouns, the user must choose between the positive and negative energy aspects when learning Illusion, suffering a -10 on his or her effective score when dealing with the other.
- Magic (Wotan, Lammas) covers pure magical energy, the amplification or suppression of supernatural abilities, charging things with magical energy, and storing magic.
- Space (Raido, Vacus) covers space, dimensions, and location, as well as direction and distance. It is subtle and difficult to master.
- Time (Othala, Tempus) covers time, whether to speed, slow, stop, reverse, or travel through it. Theurgists most easily affect small aspects of time; getting extra time to think is a mere L1 spell, but stopping time to do whatever you want is L9.

Sadly, these skills have no governing attributes.

Sample Theurgical Effects

While the level of a proposed effect must be set by the Game Master (if necessary, consult the Hexcraft chart on page 79), it should be remembered that more specific spells are often easier. For example, *Baleful Polymorph* normally has range and allows a choice of forms. Discarding those features in favor of a specific spell (call it *Porcine Polymorph* with a touch range) will probably reduce it to level three or four.

For a few examples of how to use Theurgy to create spells, some common spell effects are described below.

These are rarely the only way to produce a given effect, but they're usually easiest.

- Analyze [X]. Understand/[Relevant Noun].
- Cure Wounds. Heal/Body.
- Death. Destroy/Body for simple physical death. Control/Liquid or Body to simply keep someone's heart from beating. Destroy/Spirit to make someone really hard to bring back.
- Disintegration. Destroy/[Whatever it is you want to destroy].
- Energy Attack. Create/Fire for simple blasts. Create/Control/Fire to make walls of energy or to shape a blast. Add Spirit to affect incorporeal beings. Add Time to create a spell which goes off later, then add Understand/[X] to create a ward triggered by the presence of [X].
- Flight. Usually Control/Body. Add Understanding/Mind if you want to let someone else control the spell or want it to fly you around without your concentration.
- Induce an emotion or implant ideas. Create/Mind
- Protection from [X]. Control/[X] (to keep it away), Destruction/[X] (to weaken its effects on you), Create/[As appropriate] (to create a counteragent).
- Reverse or neutralize gravity. Control/ or Destroy/Earth.
- Sourceless Knowledge. Create/Understand/Mind.
- Telekinesis. Control/[Whatever you want to move].
- Transform to stone. Transform/Body/Earth. If you want to transform yourself and keep moving you'll need Control as well.

If you want some entertainment from a curse, or a Specialized (and hence cheap) version of Theurgy, make some rune chits to represent your noun and verb skills and draw a couple to use at random whenever you want to cast a spell in a hurry. A sufficiently creative player can usually come up with something to do, but it can be quite amusing to watch someone trying to come up with an offensive spell using Understanding/Plant.

Customizing Theurgy

A given game world might have different natural forces and powers. Perhaps Communication is separated from Understanding, or Darkness and Light form entirely separate fields. Dividing or recombining fields easily allows quick customization. Simply give any new powers a neat name (ours come from the Norse Elder Futhark alphabet and bastardized Latin). Note that spreading the powers too thinly or combining them too tightly make Theurgy very weak and very strong, respectively. As it is, these skills cost 18 skill points to maximize every level. That's going to be expensive even if you take Adept twice. Most Theurgists either specialize or merely dabble, relying on finely-tuned effects instead of raw power.

Witchcraft

Witchcraft is flexible and versatile, but unspecialized and relatively low-powered. It's best suited to low-magic campaigns and subtle players. Its effects are often less strictly defined in mechanical terms, as the personality and intent of the user make a considerable difference.

Witchcraft is driven by its user's internal energies. While this has its advantages, it's a very limited power source, hence Witchcraft is a simple system suitable for minor spellcasters in any game. It won't be a suitable power base for player characters most of the time. Witches are suitable as PC's primarily in low-magic, grim-and-gritty, or horror-style game worlds.

Ordinary people often fear Witches, or at least view them with suspicion. The old village herb-monger probably isn't a threat, but everyone has heard tales of cannibal Witches in the forest, of dark spellcasters who can read your thoughts and curse your children. And in a fantasy world, these things all exist. Pacts can make Witches servants of powers, and sometimes those powers are hostile or callous about human life and suffering.

Moreover, since Witchcraft involves few obvious spells, it's often a secret art. It doesn't require serious study or adventuring to master either. Even a Dark Overlord is likely to be more controlled and disciplined than a village Witch, and that makes people nervous. Those same Pacts can give people with a loose grip on sanity tremendous power from the perspective of an ordinary person. The most petty and foolish individuals can still make dangerous Witches.

At best, ordinary people often seem somewhat nervous about, and gratuitously respectful of, Witches they know, trust, or like. At worst, they break out the torches and pitchforks.

Witches as Player Characters

Witch player characters probably don't want to spend everything on Witchcraft. In fact, it's best left as a minor talent rather than the focus of the character's powers. Spellcasters probably don't need it, but warriors and Rogues can find many uses for the numerous tricks and talents of the Witch.

In a game where the only magic is Witchcraft, it can wield a very subtle and dangerous power indeed. Witchcraft is versatile and adaptable and gives those who possess it an important leg up. Every player character will probably want to dabble in Witchcraft, unless they have another kind of power available.

Witches as Non-Player Characters

Witches make good contacts for players. They can often perform minor tricks or obtain knowledge the PC's cannot (without stealing the show). As such, they make useful prophets or allies.

Witches make excellent opposition to player

characters. Despite the lack of raw power, Witchery has many abilities suitable for magical sniping. That is, they can hinder, curse, and otherwise impede players' progress. Since evil Witches often bargain with dark powers, good characters have an excellent reason to seek them out and put an end to their wicked ways. Although Witches are unlikely to have vast treasures, they might still have valuable collections of mystical gear or secret lore.

Basic Witchcraft requires no external power source and provides several minor abilities. Any character who spends 6 CP on Witchcraft receives (Str + Dex + Con) / 3 psionic-style Power points. Another +6 CP provides access to three of the basic abilities listed below, and a final +6 CP (18 total) provides an additional four powers from the basic list.

Unwilling targets of a Witch's abilities receive a save at DC 13 + the Witch's (Cha Mod). This is always a Will save unless otherwise noted. All powers used on other people grant saves even if not specifically noted, except indirect effects. Witch abilities have a range of 20 feet plus 20 feet per extra point of Power expended where they pay any attention to physical distance. Witch powers are invisible and generally require no physical components, incantations, or gestures.

Witchcraft isn't all fun and games. Since Witchcraft drains internal energies, a Witch who drains his or her Power pool below 5 points becomes Fatigued. At 0 points the Witch becomes Exhausted.



***Yes, I am a horrible hideous old Witch.
And the price is now 24 CP. Jerk.***



Basic Witch Abilities

- **The Adamant Will.** This talent allows users to spend 2 Power to resist Fear, Possession, Charm, Hold effects, and other forms of mind control. The user may spend the Power each time he or she is affected by such an ability. Ongoing powers, such as Fear auras, are resisted for 10 rounds. The user may make an extra save against mind-reading or “truth” effects by spending a like amount, and may present a false aura to detection spells or ignore pain for 3 power. He or she may pay the Power without spending an action when the effect takes hold.
- **Dreamfaring.** Dreamfaring allows users to enter a trance and project their spirits into the Ethereal and near Astral planes. They may detect and communicate with beings in nearby dimensions without paying power. For 2 Power they may enter the dreams of others to torment or communicate with them wherever they may be, possibly causing them to lose sleep or worse. Traveling about costs 3 Power plus 1 for every three hours and allows for covert meetings with other Witches or for clairvoyance-like effects via astral or ethereal spying.
- **Elfshot.** Elfshot allows the user to lay minor curses. Such curses may reduce an attribute by -2, cause some type of misfortune, penalize a group of checks by -6, hinder activity, induce sterility or miscarriages, and so on. Classic examples include causing cows to go dry, mules and horses to bolt, and pets to bite their owners. Such curses are generally either instant or last until they are countered. Lesser diseases may also be inflicted in this fashion. Curses usually cost 1 Power for quick effects, 2 for lingering curses, and 3 for permanent ones. The *Remove Curse* spell, or any effect which eliminates the symptoms or curse directly, heals the mystical injury.
- **Glamour.** This projective telepathy works much like the Path of the Dragon ability of the same name. It grants a +6 bonus on relevant social skills (1 Power per 10 minutes), the sending of brief messages, emotional influence and hypnotic effects (approximate relevant L0 or L1 spells for 1 or 2 Power respectively). Glamour is at its best combined with Disguise skill and Shadowweave to alter how people see the user. It’s often used with the Inner Eye, below, to allow rapid communications, teaching, and mental probes. For +6 CP the user may expand his or her repertoire to level 2 (2 power) and 3 (4 power) hypnotic and emotion influencing effects (compare to the Sorcerer/Wizard list).
- **The Hand of Shadows** covers basic telekinesis. Minor tricks (like bending spoons) cost no power. Exerting a force equal to what you could physically handle costs 1 Power per minute. Light but rapid work (like sorting wheat from chaff) costs 1 Power per hour’s worth of work done. Minor animations (*Entangle*, *Animate Rope*) approximate the relevant spells at a cost of 2 power, +2 if excessive force or fine control is required.
- **Healing.** This accomplishes a full day’s worth of healing in a mere hour at a cost of 1 Power and grants a

+5 bonus on any relevant checks (against disease or toxins). This is also used to throw off the effects of drugs and intoxicants with a flat duration. In emergencies, Witches may simply heal 1d4 hit points per Power spent up to a maximum of 3d4 hit points per round.

- **Hyloka.** The manipulation of biophysical processes is a rare gift. This can be used to briefly move physical attribute points around (up to 6 points for 1 Power per hour), slip into hibernation (1 power; lasts up to a week), help resist heat or cold (1 Power per hour, this grants 5 points of fire or cold resistance), stop bleeding, delay poison (one hour per power), grow hair or make it fall out (1 power), and to inflict or ease ailments like arthritis (spend 1 power/week to inflict, 1 power/day to ease).

- **Infliction.** Often manifested as phantom force-claws, heart attacks, inexplicable bleeding, and agonizing pain, Infliction causes injury through psychic force. This can include spectacular attacks - throwing fiery balls or thunderbolts or such - but is usually subtle. In any case, it deals 1d4 hit points of damage per character level, to a maximum of 3/5/7 d4 damage for 1/2/3 power. Targets may make a save for half damage, but the save used depends on the form of the attack. Infliction normally affects a single target, but may be expanded to a five-foot radius for +3 power.

- **The Inner Eye.** Thought-sensing can be used to see surface thoughts, to detect the presence of a hidden being, to share a target’s senses, or to read any psychic impressions left behind on an object by strong emotion. This provides a +6 on any relevant Spot, Sense Motive, or Listen checks for 1 Power per 10 minutes.

- **Shadowweave.** Shadowweave manipulates light and darkness to craft minor illusions. Normally 1 Power grants 10 minutes of activity. Effects include will-o-the-wisps, cloaking (+6 to stealth and disguise rolls), various apparitions, spheres of darkness, blinding rays of light and hiding small actions - such as slipping out a dagger, picking a pocket, or a strike in combat (offers a +3 circumstance bonus to the user’s roll). For +6 CP the user may expand his or her repertoire to level 2 (2 power) and 3 (4 power) illusion-casting effects (compare to the Sorcerer/Wizard list).

- **Witchfire.** Molecular-level telekinesis. At its simplest this can create and manipulate heat or cold (1d8/3d6 damage for 1/2 power, +1 if affecting a modest area, -1 if using pre-existing flame), create effects on the “prestidigitation” level (1 Power per turn), extract essences from herbs, and infuse drugs and toxins into objects. Talented Witches sometimes use this for creating mysterious sounds and voices.

- **Witchsight.** Sharpening or expanding the user’s senses is a simple trick. In general, this affects one sense at a time, providing either a +6 bonus on relevant checks or some special capability (Darksight, Scent, etc). As a rule this costs 1 Power and lasts for about an hour. Witches may triple the effect by reducing the duration to a single round, allowing effects such as checking a meal for poison with the slightest taste.

A character who permanently fixes the problems he or she takes on (with the exception of Epic Quest) loses 6 CP worth of Advanced Witchcraft abilities. Sorry, you

Service

- **Spirit**, means the entity will claim the character's spirit upon death. The character can't be *Raised* or *Resurrected* without potent magic (7th level or higher) or the permission of the being involved. This usually, but not always, implies that said entity is either too minor or too unpleasant to get spiritual assistants in any other way. Exceptions include gods who simply like to personalize things, worlds with otherwise "generic" afterlives (such as the Greek mythology), and so on. If the character chooses a specific time limit of life (short compared to his or her normal lifespan), this is worth 12 CP instead of 6!

Vow

- Advertising is a very common vow, and includes recruiting, displaying the power of your patron and the



benefits of entering its service, and making dramatic appeals to your patron when spellcasting. Advertising sort of spoils the “subtle” aspect of Witchcraft and may or may not be a problem socially; it depends on how others feel about your patron.

- **Taboos**, otherwise known as Geasa, consist of actions you must not do; aid an agent of opposing powers, cross a river after sundown, cut your hair, or drink wine. Usually, the character must select three Taboos.

- **Duties** means the character has an obligation to act in some specific circumstance. For example, a character might be required to follow a Healer’s Oath, slay anyone who fells a tree in the Sacred Wood, aid all members of the coven who need it, teach the faith to children, or spread plagues in large cities.

- **Rituals** require the character to regularly perform a major ritual. It is an ongoing nuisance which takes up the character’s time and energy. Common rituals include three-day celebrations at the passing of each season, invoking the gods before each and every meal, or long morning meditations.

- **Exclusion** means the character must not willingly draw upon any other source of power, including items enchanted by those following other patrons or none at all. While not very popular for adventurers, it is often a good boost for settled Witches. If the character refuses all aid and association with those who use other powers, this is worth 12 CP instead of 6.

Sacrifice

You pay as you go...

- **Tithe** requires that a character surrender at least 20% of his or her gains (in experience, gold, land, or some other valuable resource) to his or her patron.

- **Blood** drains hit points from the character whenever he or she uses Witchcraft, at a rate of 2 HP per Power expended. Some GM’s may allow the Witch to substitute the vitality of an ally - or someone under the Witch’s control - instead.

- **Isolation** requires that the character utterly dedicate themselves to magic. This involves eliminating all friendships, family ties, and everything which might qualify as a social life.

- **Essence** demands the character give up some aspect of themselves for power. As Odin gave up an eye for wisdom, the characters must surrender a part of themselves. It could be their shadow, sense of humor, health (-2 Con Score), a valued skill, or a hand. If they heal the wound (always possible), they lose the gift.

- **Souls** requires the character to commit blood sacrifice, usually but not necessarily of sentient beings, or bring new beings into the worship of his or her master. If the character must sacrifice former loved ones and friends (and eventually make more “friends” to kill) this is worth 12 CP instead of 6. While it’s rare for good entities to demand blood sacrifices, there are a few who insist on a steady stream of converts instead.

Infusion

Witches who take Infusions have instilled magical essences into their very being. This drastic step transforms the character into a minor magical being, and isn’t an easy process. Aside from the granted powers of specific types of Infusions, this always causes problems for the character. He or she might become a lycanthrope, bear a Witch’s Mark which frightens people, upset normal animals, be damaged or driven off by Channeling like an undead, or become an outsider (with all the penalties and gifts thereof). If the GM enforces an especially severe flaw, the character gains an extra 6 CP.

- **Vampirism** means that the Witch no longer regenerates Power by rest, but must steal it from others. A touch drains 1d4 Power (inflicting 1d4 points of damage if the victim has no Power). This ability is much better for opposition Witches than player-character ones, unless there is a *very* friendly Psion around.

- **Gateway** makes you a living nexus for your patron’s power. Whenever you use your power it or its minions may project their powers through you or even use you as an actual gateway to visit the material plane. It’s even possible that other creatures may be pulled through. While this can be both helpful and harmful, it’s probably a good thing that the scale of the gateway is limited by how much power you use.

- **Corruption** gradually transforms the Witch into a fitting host as he or she goes up in level. Aside from the physical transformation, the GM gets 2 CP out of the character’s pool every level to spend on whatever he or she pleases. Fortunately, the GM actually spends 3 CP, meaning the player gets a small bonus overall. Of course, gradually transforming into an alien being makes you stand out a bit.

- **Possession** takes hold of the character at various intervals. On the bright side, the GM can sometimes take actions for the character when he or she’s been rendered unconscious or stunned. On the downside, this causes the character to sometimes take actions he or she doesn’t want to. NPC’s sometimes go mad from the mental strain, but most PC’s are made of tougher stuff.

- **Hunted** means the character is being stalked by an enemy of his or her patron. The Witch has become a prime target in a feud that may be older than his or her species. On the bright side, he or she has a handy party for protection – or the party is the foe and the GM doesn’t have to worry about complications. If the character takes excessively powerful enemies, this grants 12 CP instead of 6.

Energy

Witches can easily gain access to sources of energy which they cannot entirely control or which aren’t all that reliable. These flawed sources come with distinct sets of problems and limitations all their own.

- **Karmic Links** go around and come around. Sadly, in Witchcraft, this is even more irritating. Using Witchcraft linked to Karma means that the character’s powers cause



Sasha relied on the other fighters not wanting to hit her. After the third Resurrection, she got some armor.

as many problems as they fix, especially if used with ill intent. The user should very careful.

- **Backlash** causes curses or uncontrollable power flare-ups on the user! While no single problem is permanent, they keep showing up. The character may be able to shrug off the effect or work past it, but another one will soon come along to annoy him or her.
- **Spell Failure** causes the character's abilities to simply fail against some opponents. "Opponents Shielded by Cold Iron" is the classic, but priests, constructs, or otherworldly creatures are all good choices. Characters may also simply take a 20% failure chance, but this is not really recommended. It's not very interesting.
- **Madness** stems from truly unnatural magic. A character who spends more than his or her (Wis Score) in Power on Witchery each day goes just a little bit nuts. While it starts off as mere eccentricity, this grows a bit towards true insanity each time the character overspends.
- **Susceptibility** means the character take 1 damage per round from contact with some ordinary substance or in some common situation, such as from holy or unholy objects, from large bodies of water (or being doused in it), iron weapons, and so on. Especially common objects, substances, or situations merit 12 CP instead of 6.

Types of Witches

Some of the better-known types include:

- Shamanic Witches are, of course, simply Shamans, and tend to take the Pacts Missions, Duties, and Rituals. Shamanic Witches are usually much more popular than

other sorts, and are considered valued members of a tribe or village. Shamans, however, are often barred from positions of authority. Shamanic Witches speak with the spirits of the ancestors and earth, and may be able to locate information which no living being possesses.

- **Druidic Witches** tend to hide in the forests or other wild places. While they gather in covens and circles, they are equally likely to duel over territory and pride. They tend to be a little touched and respond fiercely to encroaching outsiders. Despite this, they often know secrets of the natural world, and can locate monsters and see the fates of mortal men. Druidic Witches often take the Pacts Essence, Exclusion, Duties, and Guardianship.

- **Infernalist Witches** place their trust in dark forces and evil powers. While not nearly as sensational as popular imagination holds, they often display a viciously callous evil, happily murdering those who get in their way. Infernalists owe much to their Patrons, and protect those Patron's interests out of fear of losing power. They often take the Arcanum, Spirit, Missions, Souls, and Corruption pacts. Infernalist Witches are equally at home in the wilds or cities.

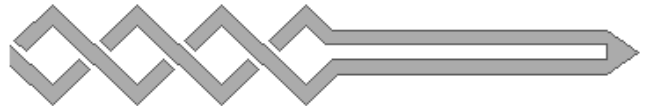
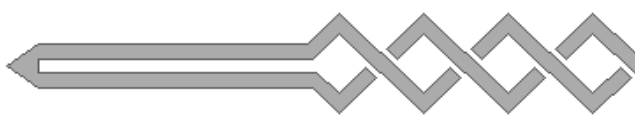
- **Alienist Witches** draw upon strange and eldritch powers which they cannot entirely control. Often curious dabblers who delve too deeply into something they don't understand, these Witches cause havoc with the natural order of things wherever they go. Alienist Witches often take the Pacts Spell Failure, Madness, Vampirism, Gateway, and Essence.

- **Modernist Witches** often begin as the children of upper-crust families from the cities. Wealthy, jaded, and often a bit spoiled, they study magic as much out of sheer ennui as any actual interest in the magic itself. While rarely accomplished on their own, they do commonly take the Karmic Links (without even realizing it), Tithes, Taboos, Advertising, and Spell Failure Pacts. Many Modernist Witches become Alienist Witches or Infernalist Witches looking for further secrets and powers - preferably without any real effort on their part.

- **Houngans** are much like Shamans but embrace the spirits of the Loa. Armed with wild magic and capable of bending the spirits to their will, they command fearsome powers unhesitatingly. A dark mirror to many Shamans, they still offer great wisdom. Houngan often take the Possession, Gateway, Blood, and Arcanum Pacts.

- **Priestly Witches** usually serve minor gods, or gods in worlds where deities don't grant major spellcasting powers. They tend to take the Advertising, Rituals, Tithe, Missions and Spirit pacts. Priestly Witches often deny any relationship to other Witches and are fairly well accepted in most communities.

- **Gypsies** practice ancient magic passed on through their bloodlines. Travelers and (at least in popular imagination) tricksters of the highest (or lowest) sort, they wander from town to town trading goods and services and collecting bits of news and lore. They often take the Spell Failure, Hunted, Taboos, and Guardianship Pacts.



Power Sources and Witches

While not always different from the studies of other spellcasting characters, Witches should still note where or how they learned their talents. This has strong implications on what kinds of beings they will make Pacts with and what they'll use their powers for. Their background affects what powers they should take, what Pacts they might want, and what patrons might demand of them or bargain for.

Most Witches learn powers from an elder Witch, often the village healer or a tribal shaman. The vast majority of village Witches, using only their personal techniques, never make many Pacts or advance beyond the hedge-wizard stage. The few who do become more powerful are either shown the methods of learning Pacts (especially Shaman, Houngan, and Infernalists), are contacted directly by spirits (Druidic or Houngan), or are dabbling in powers they don't entirely understand (Infernalist, Alien, Modernist). A few Witches, mostly Infernalists, actually inherit their powers from an unsavory ancestor, and can expect to be bothered by demons and monsters looking to enforce the old contract by hook or by crook.

While almost any spirit might take an interest in a Witch, some of the most common groups are discussed below. After all, a character's mentor or patron may play a major role in their development.

- **Ancestor Spirits.** Ancestor Spirits are actually a fairly simple bunch. Being dead, they have little use for most things of the mortal realm, but demand that Witches serving them watch over descendants and relatives and protect them from threats, particularly magical ones. Ancestors also enjoy small offerings from time to time, to assure them that mortal beings remember them.

- **Chaos Entities.** Chaos entities tend towards wild humor, massive mood swings, and outright insanity. Witches are advised to be careful about them, but they are usually willing to grant strange powers and accept (or inflict) equally strange Pacts. They don't care at all what powers Witches take or how they use them, except as an individual Patron's current whim. If a Witch later rejects them, Chaos entities might take delicious vengeance or just forget about it completely.

- **Elemental Forces.** Naturally, these promote whatever element they favor. Fire elementals like burning stuff, water spirits like people who protect swamps, lakes, and rivers (oceans are normally fairly safe from mortal interference), earth elementals promote good land management practices, and air spirits like incense, clean energy, and hate pollution. Elementals largely ignore mortals, but don't mind lending powers if properly invoked. If a Witch turns away from them, they are likely to throw minor, annoying curses.

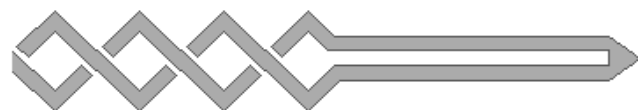
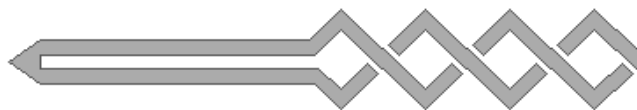
- **Higher Powers.** Various Higher Powers may be willing to grant extra magic. The problem here is that these same powers demand lots of hard work and dedication to the cause. They will scrutinize the Witch's history and personality, and have no compunctions about rejecting him or her. Moreover, they will observe the Witch's behavior, so that he or she never knows when they might be taking accounts. A Witch that leaves behind a Higher Power is unlikely to be attacked unless he or she does something truly vile, but won't ever be able to gain their assistance again unless he or she somehow manages to make amends.

- **Infernal Powers.** Infernal powers will grant anyone magical power, even characters obsessed with goodness and light, but demand that the Witch use his or her power for evil works in addition to anything else. In other words, you can save your village or heal an old man if you please, but they want to see some torment and havoc in exchange for it. Characters who leave the Infernal powers behind will probably get into severe trouble for it. Evil powers are vindictive, and they don't like mortals who mock them. These poor Witches can expect attacks, curses, and severe limitations on their dealing with any further lower planar creatures.

- **Law Guardians.** Law Guardians are simultaneously loose and strict. Usually, in exchange for specified contract services, they are willing to grant almost any useful power. They demand *absolute* and unconditional adherence to the contract, and will cut a character off in a heartbeat if they are toyed with. Law Guardians are very likely to require that Witches use their powers only or always in certain circumstances. While unlikely to begin reprisals against a character who leaves them behind, they will never deal with them again without a great deal of collateral and repayment, magical or otherwise.

- **Loa.** Loa are the spirits of elder Witches who managed to become powerful enough in life to return after death. They build Pacts with current Witches to increase their personal might and become stronger. Loa tend to be mysterious, being half-in and half-out of the realms of the dead, and prone to unusual personality quirks. Loa are not at all amused if a Witch leaves their service, and will likely attempt to use both carrot and (especially) stick to entice them back.

- **Nature Spirits.** Nature spirits run the gamut from near-elementals, hardly aware of the existence of mortals, to minor spirits intrinsic in keeping life alive. Many are simply minor, almost forgotten, spirits, who take care of minor tasks. Most Nature Spirits are at least moderately benign. The wilder ones can become dangerous, as they are feral hunting creatures, but rarely include sentient mortals in their hunts. Different Nature Spirits may react wildly differently when betrayed by a Witch, running the gamut from total disinterest to becoming mad with wrath. They may or may not get over it during the Witch's lifetime.



Advanced Witchcraft

Advanced Witchcraft feats cost 6 CP apiece. While they are collected into Paths, there are no requirements for any of these abilities except that the user must have at least 12 CP in basic Witchcraft feats. The Paths are merely collections of related abilities, not specific progressions - unless the Game Master chooses to decide otherwise.

Optionally, a character who chooses to develop six of the seven abilities in each path may gain the seventh as a bonus.

The Path of Coven Mastery

- **Covenbond.** Covenbond allows the Witch to focus the strength of up to (Int Mod)+3 other Witches, pooling available Power and multiplying range and radius factors by the number of Witches in the group. Only one Witch ability per round receives this bonus. The group leader (whoever uses this discipline first), decides which magic receives the benefit of the Covenbond.

- **Dreamgathering.** This technique summons the astral forms of all coven members (*i.e.*, anyone who agrees to the use of this technique) to a specially prepared safe astral location for 3 Power. For an additional 2, this location has whatever furniture or scenery the user wishes, though it is all merely illusion except to astral forms. For an additional 4 Power, targets need not have the Dreamfaring ability to join in. Those attending must be asleep or entranced. Unwilling participants do receive saving throws as normal.

- **Familiar.** The Witch gains a Companion, usually a familiar or spirit guide. Aside from the normal Companion benefits, one gained from this feat adds 6 points to the Witch's Power pool. If a Witch already has this feat or a Companion, the bonus rises to 9 Power.

- **Master of the Sabbat.** A few Witches are capable of mighty effects. This technique allows one to build up a basic Witchcraft ability over up to 28 days. The Witch uses the powers, but delays the effect, which becomes cumulative based on the Power spent. The target must be reasonably accessible the entire time. At its upper limit, the user can bring down castle walls or stone bridges with Hand of the Shadows, or use Elfshot to lay a massive and terrifying curse.

Master of the Sabbat has great potential, but the Witch must hang around the target for days on end. This often raises suspicions.

- **Master the Elements.** The Witch may enter a trance and travel the spirit realms to seek out a particular spirit and either request a favor or do battle. For example, when confronted with a severe drought a Witch could either seek out and battle/defeat in a contest/appease/negotiate with/command the Drought Spirit responsible, attempt to get a Rain Spirit to bring rain, or seek a

patron's advice on how to deal with the situation. Such advice may range from the eminently practical ("build a dam across the stream and irrigate") on through the utterly mystical ("when mourns the tribe with the mother of thunder, the skies too shall weep"). Either way, this allows the user to personify abstract problems.

Regardless of how long a quest appears to the Witch, it actually requires [1d8x1d8] hours. It generally takes a fair amount of time to prepare for another such quest after the first one is complete, hence a character cannot undertake more than (Cha Mod) spirit quests per month.

- **The Secret Order.** The character gains the remaining 5 basic abilities and an extra 4 Power points per day. As one might expect, this an extremely popular ability.

Unlike other Witch abilities, this requires a teacher or, preferably, joining an actual secret order.

- **Summoning.** Summoning allows Witches to channel their powers into other planes. While this is commonly used with Glamour and The Inner Eye to contact patrons and potential patrons, with Infliction to assault troublesome entities, or with Spirit Binding to try and control spirits, many other abilities can be used in conjunction with it. Opening a link over which to use you powers costs 3 power, opening the way for a spirit to come through costs 7 or more. A Witch can attempt to reach any being he or she knows the name of (or, in some settings, the true name of), including the deceased.

This can bring a spirit of the dead or an extra-planar creature into the world. While Witches can't bring forth bodies (and must procure a "vacant" one or bind a construct with Spirit Binding, below, if the entity wants or needs one) they can still summon a spirit for 7 Power.

Note that this ability grants no power to control or compel the spirit in question, but merely brings it forth. If a Witch wants to control a spirit he or she will have to use other means.

As a side benefit, various entities may be willing to lend the Witch some extra magic, usually (Witch's Cha Mod +3) spell levels worth of any spells or spell-like abilities they possess of up to spell level 3. The bargains the user needs to make obtain this are entirely up to the GM and the type of creature she's contacting. Patrons are more forgiving. They'll provide those spell levels up to (Cha Mod) times before requiring payment, assuming the character uses them to advance the Patron's interests. Entities may either imbue the Witch with specific spells at the cost of 7 Power at the time of imbue or have the user contact them when they need the magic at the cost of 3 Power and two Standard Actions; one to make the contact and request an effect, and one to activate it. While this is far more flexible, it's also far more difficult to use in a fight.

No, characters do not get retroactive spell levels if they later increase their Charisma and item, equipment, magical, or psionically-based bonuses do not count. You cannot repeatedly put on and remove a Charisma-boosting item to get infinite magic this way.



The Path of Spirits

- Seize the Wandering Soul. This vicious ability allows the user to kidnap a wandering spirit for 3 Power, plus 1 per 3 hours it is held. While primarily useful against the very recently dead, it is an effective attack against incorporeal undead, very sick individuals, dreamers having out-of-body experiences, and non-physical astral travelers.

A living character with fewer than 1/5th of his or her total hit points is vulnerable, and if so trapped must make an additional Fort saving throw or die. If they succeed, their body remains comatose for the duration, or until it starves. Spells to protect corpses preserve it undamaged, as does expert medical care. Astral travelers, spirits and dreamers don't need to make saving throws to survive – they're already disconnected.

Unless they possess a special technique usable while without a body (usually including Test of Wills, Witchcraft, and Thaumaturgy) a spirit so trapped is helpless. The Witch may telepathically communicate with it at will, and enjoys a +6 bonus on any Intimidate checks.

- Hag-Riding. Witches don't like spending Power. They still like magic, so some develop the ability to steal Power from other people. This special form of Body Fuel draws Power from a willing victim or from a bound or captured spirit. The Witch may inflict temporary up to 12 points of attribute damage on the victim per day, although no attribute can be decreased below 6 in this manner. Each stolen attribute point provides 1 Power for the Witch.

According to classic, if sensationalist, literature, Witches would seize a sleeping victim's spirit (Seize the Wandering Soul for 3 Power) then ride it, figuratively or not, to the Coven and back (2 Power for holding the trapped spirit for six hours and 4 for the astral trip), leaving 6 points to spend on other magic – at a net cost of only 3 points of their own power.

A Witch with a lot of bound spirits to draw on may have a great deal of Power in reserve. Of course, a Witch who makes a hobby of imprisoning spirits is likely to attract a lot of opposition – and that reserve doesn't recover very quickly.

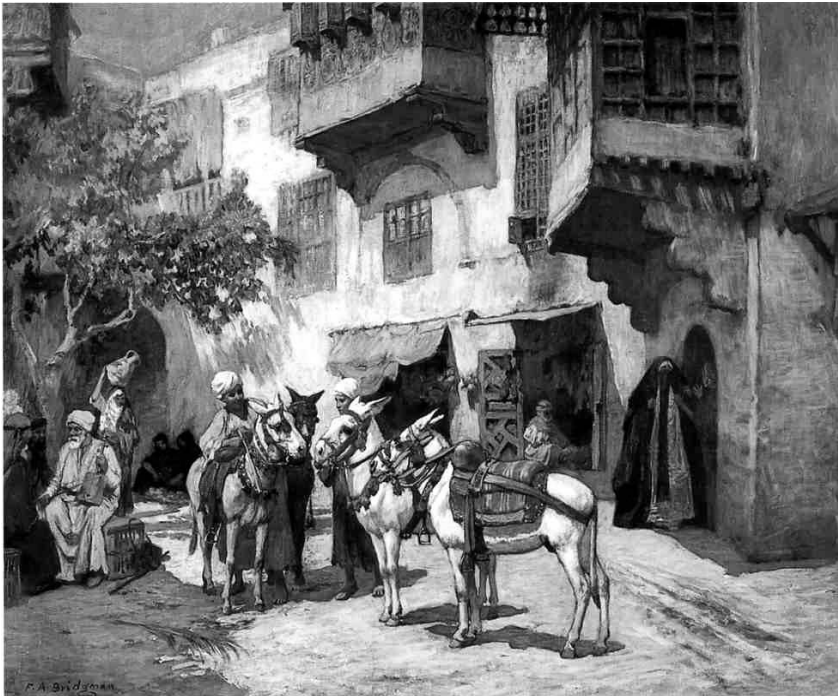
- Spirit Binding. Spirit Binding allows a Witch to entrap spirits in objects (including constructs), areas, or non-sentient animals permanently, or at least until whatever was used is destroyed, slain, or exorcized. First, the Witch must have another ability to get a spirit, either by using Seize the Wandering Soul, having a friendly incorporeal creature, or using Summoning. He or she may then put the spirit in a living but presumably animal or soul-less body for 5 Power or anchor it in an inanimate object or area for 7. The spirit gains control of living or animated bodies, although ones stuck in the form of a lantern or duck likely won't be doing much of use. The spirit's mental attributes remain the same.

Lesser bindings cost 3 Power, and include forbidding certain actions, the classic "love spell," and other compulsions roughly equivalent to a *Lesser Geas*.

As a secondary effect, the Witch may seal a bargain for 1 Power, so that neither party can willingly violate it. A save applies only if one or both parties is acting under duress. The Witch will know if either party attempts to save – and whether or not they succeed.

For +6 CP the user may attempt to simply command a creature to undertake some simple, and relatively safe, action. If the target fails to save it continues to follow directions for up to ten minutes per level of the user. Typical commands include leaving the area, surrendering, renouncing possession of someone else's body, paying no attention to the user, answering some questions, or returning home. It costs 3 Power to target a normal creature, but 5 for spirits, outsiders, and magical beings such as dragons (they're virtually certain to successfully resist anyway).

In some worlds inanimate objects have their own spirits, even if they don't usually pay any attention to mortals. If this is true in your world, Witches with this ability may attempt to command inanimate objects (as per Animate Object) for 7 Power.



If your world really does have gods, or if Witches have real supernatural Patron beings, remember that Seizing and Binding the souls of their followers is a major insult, affront, and travesty. Exceptionally devout individuals, and certainly Clerics and Paladins, will have defenses against this sort of thing. A Witch who tries to take anyone protected by a higher power must make a Fort save against his or her own magic or take 5d4 damage. Protected targets, including normal but strongly religious people, get a +5 bonus on their save.

- **Apparition.** Apparition allows the Witch to manifest a semi-tangible body on the material plane while using Dreamfaring. Such forms are equal to an Astral Construct IV, and while shadowy, appear in whatever shape the Witch desires. The destruction of this form forces the Witch to make a Fort save against his or her own magic or take 1d4 temporary Con damage and 2d6 normal damage (the wound corresponds to the “killing” blow on the construct, allowing alert investigators to note the connection between the apparition and the Witch). This costs 2 Power plus 1 per hour. The user may spend another 6 CP to upgrade to an Astral Construct V, and an additional 6 for Astral Construct VI.

- **Ridden by the Loa.** This ability allows Witches to temporarily gain the benefits of an appropriate Template, with built-in downsides. It may grant a Template of up to +4 ECL and costs 1 Power per hour. Any attribute change from the Template does not affect the character’s Power pool. The Witch may also change his or her Template simply by reusing this ability. The GM decides what “appropriate” is according to the game world.

Unlike normal Templates, however, the character is actually possessed. The character’s basic goals remain intact, but the spirit (of a type related to the Template) is mostly in control and does as it pleases. By spending an additional 6 CP on this ability, the character becomes an equal partner, but the spirit is still able to control much of the affected character’s actions. For a further 6 CP, the character becomes firmly in control. The spirit still has the strength to do minor acts and can keep the character from doing things it doesn’t like.

Game masters who don’t mind improvising may allow characters to host a wide variety of spirits, such as “the spirit of the forest” or “the spirit of darkness.” This usually means gaining access to various supernatural abilities and some extra hit points. Sadly, unique spirits cannot be reduced to less than “equal partners” (gods are always “mostly in control,” but almost never allow this sort of thing anyway). The Witch usually has no idea what powers such a spirit may have anyway.

- **Siphon.** Siphon allows the Witch to bargain with spirits for a reflexive powers - continuous links which don’t need to be invoked before each use. For example, the Witch could borrow a fire spirit’s elemental attack or resistance. There are problems with this ability of course. First and foremost, the Witch must actually find and bargain with the relevant spirit – meaning the GM has

final say over any deal (they’re usually for a limited time, expensive, may or may not cost Power, and restrict how the granted power or powers may be used). The Witch must also spend actions to use the power. Purely defensive powers use Immediate Actions, while offensive ones are Move-Equivalent Actions. Finally, while Witches may bargain with many spirits, they can only have one link active at a time.

- **Possession.** The master of Possession may project him- or herself into another’s person’s body to seize control. The Witch’s body remains in a deep trance for the duration. The initial attempt costs 3 Power, plus 1 Power per hour the effect is maintained. This Power only works on living creatures roughly like the Witch’s own species. Another +6 CP eliminates the maintenance cost and +6 CP more allows the character to abandon his or her own body and eject the old character’s soul (either simply sending it on to the afterlife or forcing it into their old body with Spirit Binding). Finally, for an additional +6 CP, the user may possess dead or alien bodies.

The Path of Darkness

- **Web of Shadows.** Some Witches devote their magic to gaining mundane influence, spinning a Web of Shadows. This allows the character to gain influence in a region or city and support a network of minions or like-minded individuals. Normally evil, subversive, or criminal, these groups always have something to hide and something to hide from. The Witch has general connections with the underworld and may specify 2d4 + (Cha Mod) specific contacts, though the GM can veto any with unbalancing power or utility.

Theoretically there’s no reason why a good or neutral Witch can’t take this to set up an “underground railroad” or group of revolutionaries, found a secretive church or guild, or otherwise put together a conspiracy. It’s just that darkness magic always seems to work better for the bad guys.

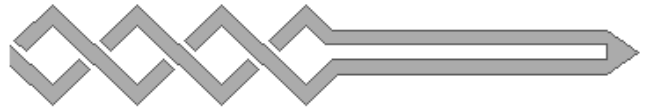
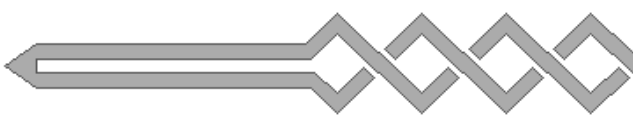
- **The Dark Flame.** The character gains a limited version of Hysteria (+6 Charisma), which requires 1 Power for every 10 minutes of use.

- **Voice of the Dead.** The Witch gains the ability to communicate with the undead and to use social skills on them without penalty. Undead have a base attitude of Neutral towards such attempts.

Witches who want to work extensively with undead would be well advised to pick up some Channeling as well, just in case diplomacy fails.

- **The Umbral Form.** A Witch with this ability may transform him- or herself into the form of a Shadow (the creature, not a generic shadow), expending 3 Power per hour that he or she uses the form.

- **Lure of Darkness.** Darkness’ lure allows the Witch to gather slaves or servants from among those vulnerable to evil or at least vulnerable to temptation. The user gains (Cha Mod) x 2 minor servants, who will serve loyally



almost to the point of suicide, if necessary. The user also gains 1d4+1 apprentices or allies at half his or her character level. The user should define how all of these were attracted: money, addiction, blackmail, insanity, or sheer morbid curiosity are all good choices.

- **Nightforge.** Witches with this ability may create solid darkness for 1 Power per hour per 20 lbs. of material. It is treated as being Adamantine for the duration. This can be used as an attack, to trap someone in manacles or a cage, in which case the victim receives a Reflex save.

- **Tenebrium's Coin.** Your powers bring you a steady income. You gain 1% of your base cash allowance for your current level in common goods or services, albeit not direct cash, every month.

Magic applied to acquiring wealth has major impacts on some campaigns, so be warned.

The Path of Water

- **Brewing.** The fine art of herbs, poisons, narcotics, and other drugs comes into full bloom with this discipline. In general, preparing a brew requires a selection of herbs and 1d4+1 days. This can be reduced to 1d4+1 hours for 2 power. Brews usually remain potent for 1d6 weeks. If a dose is more than a week old roll when it's taken to see if it's still potent.

Using Witchfire can reduce the preparation time to 1d4+1 minutes at the cost of 5 additional power.

Enhancers boost one of the user's abilities by 1d4+2 for one hour, after which the user becomes Fatigued.

Power brews grant 2d4+2 extra Power. Sadly, they're prone to side effects, which continue to apply even if the brew has lost potency otherwise. Roll 1d6 when one is taken; (1-3) no side effect, (4) user cannot regain Power naturally for 2 days, (5) the user takes 1d4 damage to a random attribute, (6) the user's Power drops to zero after an hour and must be recovered normally.

Poisons can be prepared whenever the appropriate ingredients are available. Lesser poisons can be prepared at any time, but must be ingested or inhaled and take hours to take effect. Oddly enough, poisons often remain potent for considerable periods, so roll for months instead of weeks.

Antidotes can be prepared in only 1d4+1 rounds at the cost of 5 power. They grant a second saving throw versus poisons, intoxicants, and other compounds with a +6 alchemical bonus. The creator must specify the poison to be affected when making the brew, although "the one affecting him!" is sufficient when the Witch needs an immediate cure.

Dream Ointment reduces the cost for Dreamfaring by 2 Power and induces uncontrolled astral projection in those without that discipline. This is very dangerous.

Aside from these major uses, Witches can brew many useful potions and drugs to cause hallucinations, treat or cause illness, cause minor magical effects (such as blemish removal, minor alterations to facial features, and

similar herbal magic effects), ease pain, and induce sleep.

- **Dismissal.** Dismissal disrupts and erases extra-dimensional energies. For 1 Power, the user may erase lingering traces of spellcasting or outsiders. For 2, they may deal 3d8 damage a specified class of extra-dimensional being (*i.e.*, all evil outsiders) in a 15' radius or *Dispel Magic*. At 3 Power, the character deals 5d8 damage. For 7 Power, the character may send all such beings within range back to their native plane if they fail their saving throw or attempt to disrupt a dimensional gateway as per *Greater Dispel Magic*.

- **Flesh Like Mist.** Flesh Like Mist enables the character to take on a favored animal form for 2 Power (the user may pick (Con Mod +2) favorites). For a full 5 Power, the character may take on any animal form up to Large creatures. In either case, the user gains the benefits of a full days healing the first time this is used in a day. For +6 CP the user may take on gaseous form (for 3 power) and reduces the base costs by 1 Power each.

- **Spirits of the Deep.** A Witch using Spirits of the Deep infuses the target with wild, celestial, or infernal energy, depending on the target's own nature, not the Witch's desires. This means the GM gets to decide what Template to apply to the target and what influence it has on his or her behavior. It is otherwise similar to Ridden by the Loa. This commonly grants the target the Celestial or Fiendish Template, or induces Lycanthropy, but other results are possible. While the first two are generally useful to the subject, Lycanthropy is considered a major curse by most people. This costs 7 Power.

For +3 CP the user may imprint a mass of elemental energy with a bit of his or her consciousness, creating a minor elemental servant (equivalent to a Mephit) for 4 power. For +3 additional CP the user can make servants equivalent to medium-sized Elementals. In either case such servants last for about an hour and serve willingly.

- **Sympathetic Link.** A master of this discipline may ignore the range limitations of Witchcraft (and possibly of other spells) as long as he or she possesses an appropriate material link to the target or is working through a familiar within range of the target. Hair, nail clippings, dried bloodstains, or family heirlooms are all common links, though for inanimate targets a small piece of their structure will do. Poor links, such as mere scrapings of blood or an old, forgotten piece of clothing grant the target a +5 bonus on their saving throw. A link may only be used 1d4+1 times before the sympathy is exhausted.

Exceptionally good links, such as a piece of a child's placenta or fresh blood, are good for 2d4+2 uses and increase the DC of resisting by 3.

- **Venomed Touch.** The user of Venomed Touch may spend 1/2/3 Power to create a poison capable of inflicting 1d6/1d10/1d12 attribute damage to any one attribute or double that for extremely specific effects, such as reducing Wisdom modifiers with respect to sight only. Delaying the poison's effect for hours or days costs +1 or



+2 Power, respectively. The form is up to the user; the Witch may choose to envenom his or her blood, sweat, saliva, flesh, or other bodily secretion.

- **Wrath of the Sea.** The character gains a limited version of Hysteria (+6 Strength), which requires 1 Power every 10 minutes of use.

The Path of Earth

- **Bones of Iron.** Some Witches call the strength of the Earth into their bodies, enhancing them in a wide variety of ways. The simplest technique knits bone and sinew together more strongly, adding 6d4 temporary hit points for 4 Power. Unfortunately, these may not be renewed until the duration runs out.

The *Iron Fist* variant allows the user to treat his or her fists as maces, through which he or she may also channel Infliction as a Free Action when he or she strikes an enemy once per round. This costs 2 Power.

The *Iron Skin* variant allows the user to gain +4 Natural Armor for 1 Power.

The *Iron Lung* variant suspends the user's metabolism, briefly eliminating the user's need to breathe, stopping any poisons or bleeding, and making the Witch impervious to pain. This increases Fort saves by +4.

The *Iron Flesh* technique provides a +2 enhancement bonus to the users Str and Con for 2 Power.

All these effects last for 10 minutes and are not cumulative with themselves. The Witch may activate one per round as a Free Action.

- **Essence of Earth.** The character gains a limited version of Hysteria (+6 Constitution), which requires 1 Power for every 10 minutes of use.

- **Longevity.** Add 2d6x10 years to the duration of each of the Witch's age categories. Adding 6 CP to this ability allows users to modify their apparent age and any physical details of their appearance at will.

- **Mouth of the Earth.** A vicious assault discipline, this calls upon the dark side of the earth – the grave mother, the mouth of the tomb – to cause severe disruption in the target's life. With this ability the Witch can upgrade the Affliction ability to cause d8's of damage instead of d4's, for +1 Power. An enemy killed by this dies in a spectacular fashion, such as rotting instantly, burning away into ash, or melting into goo. The Witch may also use a Paralyze attack (target must save or be Paralyzed) for 1d4 rounds/hours/days/decades for 3/6/9/12 Power, instantly rot away or render useless inanimate organic material (10 cubic feet per point of power, often used to dispose of bodies or sabotage food supplies), and inflict horrific diseases (as per *Contagion*, for 3 power).

While tales persist of Witches with the power to kill with a glance, most Witches regard them as mere legend. What price the Dark Mother would demand for such a talent (essentially Finger of Death), and how much Power it would take, are matters of speculation.

- **Sleep of Stone.** The Sleep of Stone allows the Witch to enter total metabolic and physical stasis, during which he or she lacks any need for food, water, or air and doesn't age. Diseases, poisons, and parasites all fail to affect him or her during this period. The user can survive wounds up to and including total dismemberment, so long as someone puts him or her back together eventually and uses some healing magic to seal over the wounds. This costs 3 Power to induce.

Alternatively, the Witch may use a healing trance to gain a full day's healing in one hour, and purge any poisons, parasites, or diseases from his or her body. This costs 2 Power.

- **Rushing Blood.** This special variant of Body Fuel allow the Witch to expend both attribute points and hit points to gain extra Power points. All damage taken in this manner must be healed naturally, as the mystic fuel is not easily restored. Each attribute point or 3 hit points so burned becomes 2 Power.

- **True Prosperity.** Some Witches like to help people, or they just like to make nice, big gardens. True Prosperity allows them to enhance the fertility of a wide area, such as the fields of an entire village. Moreover, this effect is selective, allowing the Witch to exclude weeds, focus on just horses, or hinder disease.

Some evil Witches use this ability to enhance the virulence of diseases and plagues, induce birth defects, and otherwise spread desolation. When combined with Covenbond, it can affect an entire city or forest.

The Path of Fire

- **Ashen Rebirth.** In using the magic of fire, some rare Witches discover the ability to transform themselves into beings of pure energy. The user gains DR 10/- and Fire Resistance 10, along with flight (30' per round), a minor fire energy touch attack at 2d6 + (Dex Mod) with a range of 20 feet, and is considered intangible. This costs 1 Power per minute.

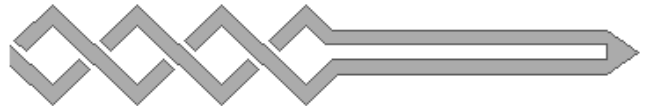
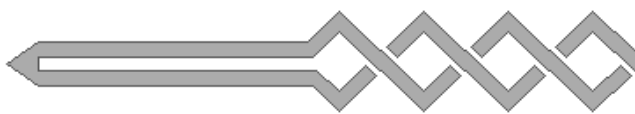
Characters who keep this effect active for more than 1 minute place their forms under considerable strain. The character becomes fatigued. After 2 minutes, he or she becomes exhausted. After 3 minutes, he or she begins taking 1d4 damage per round.

Rumors whisper that a few Witches have found ways to transform permanently. If these are true, it could probably be done by managing to keep the effect going (without dying) for several hours.

For +3 CP the user gains the ability to "jump" from point to point while in energy form by spending 2 Power. This requires an open path, however crooked, between the starting and ending points but is otherwise equivalent to *Dimension Door*. For an additional +3 CP and 7 Power this becomes equivalent to *Teleportation*.

Variants for other energy types are quite acceptable. It's the transformation which makes it a fire discipline.





- **Breath of Puruza.** Witches with this ability may support their life processes with Power rather than relying on metabolic activity. This can override paralysis or agony for 2 Power, or suspend the need to eat or drink for up a week by spending 2 Power per day. A character with appalling injuries, such as a sucking chest wound or with his or her heart ripped out, can survive for a time by spending 2 Power per 10 points of damage beyond what they could normally endure, though this lasts only 10 minutes per Power spent. As a side benefit, they can automatically resist poisons and drugs while their metabolisms are shut down (although they will take effect later) and can pretend to be dead quite effectively by shutting down their pulse, respiration, and production of body heat.

- **Dance of Flames.** The character gains a limited version of Hysteria (+6 Dexterity), which requires 1 Power every 10 minutes of use.

- **Leaping Fire.** A master of Leaping Fire may enhance his or her metabolism. This means the user may add a Move-Equivalent Action in any given round by spending 2 Power or gain a +4 bonus to Initiative for the same price. For 3 Power they may *Haste* themselves for 3d4 rounds. On a lesser level, it can induce rapid healing, allowing the user to heal 1d4 + (Con Mod) hit points per round for 5 rounds for 1 Power. Eliminating fatigue costs 1 Power and eliminating exhaustion costs 3.

- **Grounding.** Grounding allows the user to dissipate energy into the environment. Used passively, this grants a +2 bonus on any saving throw against an energy effect for 1 Power per use. Used actively, the Witch may be able to drain machinery, extinguish fires, or neutralize radiation. The exact cost of active use varies, but normally 1-2 points for minor effects, 3-4 for major ones, or 5-6 for great effects. Usually cutting off a normal fire costs 1, draining an electrical device 3, and canceling a *Fire Wall* spell 5.

- **Birth of Flames.** The Witch gains an Astral Construct (“cast” at level 6) as a permanent companion. It may be healed at a rate of 1d6 HP per Power expended, and takes 2d6 days to restore if outright destroyed. The construct may become material, or be returned to mental storage, for 1 Power.

- **The Inner Fire.** Inner Fire activates all bonus spell slots for one of the Witch’s attributes up to his or her current level. This may seem powerful, and it is, but the magic comes with a vicious price: attempting to use this ability on magic beyond the character’s control leads to nasty side effects. The user must choose a specific type of magic (e.g., Druidic, Sorcery, Wizardry) and a source of spells (e.g., a bargain with a Nature spirit, an infusion of blood from a demon, a tome of ancient spells). The GM, of course, must let him or her get away with it.

The user gains access to six spells of each level he or she can now cast. The Caster Level equals only half the character’s level. The maximum level of spell which he or she may cast safely is equal to his or her level/4, rounded down. Attempts to exceed this require a Will

save at a DC of (12 + the number of levels until the spell could safely be cast). If the user succeeds, the spell goes off, but a failure on the check means that the caster must refer to the table below.

Inner Fire Failure; Roll 1d20+Spell Level

1-3	Backlash damage of 1d6 per Spell Level to the caster; Spell is cast
4-7	Backlash damage of 1d6 per Spell Level to the caster; Spell fails
8-9	1d4 temporary damage to all of the caster’s attributes; Spell is cast
10-12	1d4 temporary damage to all of the caster’s attributes; Spell fails
13-14	Caster loses 2d4x100 experience; Spell is cast
15-17	Caster loses 2d4x100 experience; Spell fails
18-19	Serious wild magic transforms spell into a minor disaster for the party, Spell fails
20-25	Massive wild magic eruption turns spell into a major disaster for the party; Spell fails
26+	Would-be caster is disintegrated, dragged into another dimension, or suffers another horrible fate. Spell fails.

The Path of Air

- **Spirit of the Sage.** The character gains a limited version of Hysteria (+6 Intelligence), which requires 1 Power every 10 minutes of use.

- **Kinetic Master.** Functionally identical to the Path of the Dragon ability, this mainstay of minor telekinetic talents grants the ability to move objects about like a *Mage Hand* spell, but with Line-of Sight range and an effective Strength score of (Int Score/3). Unlike the Path of the Dragon version, this costs 1 Power per minute of constant use; if the user takes frequent breaks, it costs no Power.

- **Whisper Step.** This technique employs subconscious telekinesis to aid movement. The Witch may use this ability to make great leaps, easily handle dangerous or shifting terrain, or walk across the surface of a thick snowdrift. Whisper Step’s primary use is to grant a +5 bonus on any Balance, Tumble or Jump check for 1 Power (its use is a Free Action).

- **The Sight.** This (sometimes uncontrollable) ability allows the Witch to see other times and places, read the future written in the stars, cards, or crystal balls, or otherwise seek guidance by auguries. A reading costs 1 Power, and may sometimes give the Witch a vague idea of whether the future holds danger or peace (*i.e.*, which one the GM has planned today). Using clairsentience costs 3 Power unless it is being used on very close things (like listening accurately through a wall), in which case it costs 1 Power.

Similar effects, such as pathfinding or locating thieves of the Witch’s personal goods cost 2 Power.



- Weathermonger. The Witch may foresee and manipulate the weather in small ways. If relevant to the task at hand - such as in piloting a ship through a hurricane - this provides a +5 bonus for 1 Power.

On an active level, the user can attempt to raise winds. Unfortunately, while a gust of wind will work almost anywhere, there has to be an ongoing electrical storm before one can channel lightning effects. Raising a gust of wind costs 1-3 Power depending on the strength of the gust desired (1 will blow out torches or supply a cooling breeze for a while, 2 can provide wind for a ship for a few minutes or sweep someone off their feet - while 3 can produce a hurricane strength gust equal to a *Wind Wall* spell).

Users may channel existing storms into creating snow, rain, sleet, or lightning. This costs 2 Power. Lightning effects deal damage as per Infliction, but with a maximum range of the entire storm region.

If there are any Witches powerful enough to do it, creating a storm would cost at least 20 Power.

- Breath of Life. This talent allows the Witch to use *Animate Object* on any single object of large size or smaller for 3 Power; the effect lasts for 1 hour.

- Darksense. The user may sense disturbances in the air as well as the use of Power. The Witch cannot normally be surprised in a melee situation (though ranged attacks or spells can surprise him or her) and gains Motion Sense. He or she "sees" anything which disturbs the air around him or her in a 20' radius. This costs 1 Power for every hour the Witch keeps it active.

The Path of Light

- Light of Truth. A Witch with this rare ability may call forth holy energy to drive off evil beings. This deals 3d8 damage and forces a creature to save or be stunned for 1d4 rounds. Neutral creatures can be stunned with this, but not injured, and even good ones can be momentarily blinded. This costs 2 Power.

On a less combative level, this dispels darkness and illusion effects up to 2/3 of the character's level (if the target spell's caster fails the save) and reveals the true forms of shapeshifters. It can grant a +5 bonus to Sense Motive, Spot, and Search. These effects cost 1 Power.

- Inner Light. The character gains a limited version of Hysteria (+6 Wisdom), which requires 1 Power every 10 minutes of use.

- Blessing. The user may bestow a +2/+3/+4 luck bonus to any one of BAB, AC, Saves, a Skill, or an Attribute Roll at character level 3/7/12+ for ten minutes for 3 Power or to all desired targets within range for 7 Power. Witches on their way out of this mortal coil may surrender their life to give this bonus permanently to a favored pupil, child, or ally.

- Aegis. The Protection of Light is a powerful thing. A character with Aegis may spend 1 Power (even while unconscious) per day to effectively be under the care of a skill rank 10 healer at all such times. An infant upon whom the Aegis blessing is bestowed re-rolls his or her lowest attribute (this cannot result in reducing it).

More actively, Aegis destroys all poisons, parasites, and diseases afflicting the target for 3 Power. Sentient or powerful parasites (those written up as monsters) receive Fort saves.

- Sanctify. Sanctify allows the Witch to imbue an area with holy light, warding off evil beings and protecting those inside. A quick ward can be used by adventuring Witches or those in a fight to grant a +2 bonus to saving throws, AC, and attack rolls against devils, demons, undead, and any other creature the GM feels fits the definition of "evil entity." This costs 5 Power, covers a 40' radius, and lasts for 1 hour.

More lasting wards cost less Power but must be powered each day. These cost 2 Power, but increase the above effect to a +4 bonus. For an additional 1 Power each day, the site so sanctified has a cumulative +2 bonus or 10% chance each day of negating most curses or induced disorders, such as blindness caused by the *Blindness/Deafness* spell. These sites purify food and water on the grounds.

- Warding. This deceptively simple ability allows the user to share his or her defenses with others, without reducing them thereby. Protecting those within a 10' radius costs 3 Power, but lasts for at least ten minutes. During this time the user makes a saving throw first, and only if he or she fails do the protected individuals make a check. The user may also opt to share specific saving-throw bonuses, but in this case everybody must save on their own. Bonuses to AC may be shared in the same manner, as may resistances and any other special defense the GM allows. Laying a long-term warding on an individual is possible, but costs 3 Power which can't be recovered until the ward is dropped.

- Divination. The Witch may draw on the powers of light to detect and analyze creatures, forces, and objects in the immediate vicinity. *Detect* effects, as well as spells such as *Locate Object* and *True Seeing*, fall into this category. Simpler scans cost only 1 Power, while detailed analyses or searches cost 2. Piercing countering spells or Eldritch-based magic costs 3. Constant effects are charged every 10 minutes.

Witchcraft cannot match the raw power available to a high-level spellcaster. It simply doesn't offer access to effects of that level.

On the other hand, thanks to their flexibility and efficiency, Witches can be extremely effective if they have enough Power available. The Game Master should probably be wary of any character who's combining substantial psionic abilities or power-boosting abilities with Witchcraft.